



## PROGRESS REPORT

# Legislation and regulation: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-04

Edition of 2026-09-04 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

54 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

DATA PROTECTION LEGISLATION · CYBERSECURITY LEGISLATION · LEGISLATION COVERING DIGITAL ID ·  
DIGITAL PAYMENTS LEGISLATION · LEGISLATION ENABLING DATA INTEROPERABILITY ·  
AI LEGISLATION / REGULATIONS · E-COMMERCE LEGISLATION · STATISTICS LEGISLATION ·  
ACCESS TO INFORMATION LEGISLATION

**Progress values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

*The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.*

## Data protection legislation

| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | PROGRESS  |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Algeria | <p>Law 18-07 stands as amended, its officer and breach-notification duties added by the 2025 amendment.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law was enacted in 2018 and in force from August 2023, and the 2025 amendment added data-protection-officer and breach-notification duties.</p> <p>Nothing amended it further in the window. What moved is enforcement practice rather than the statute: the authority ran a compliance push on officers, processing registers and audit logs, and issued a deliberation treating images as personal data - both under a law whose own text the base does not hold.</p> | No change |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | PROGRESS                                                                                     |
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| Angola       | <p>The 2011 law <a href="#">stands unamended</a>; a revision closed consultation while an amendment opening electoral data was rejected.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The standing instrument <a href="#">has been in force since 17 June 2011, with consent and notification duties, sensitive-data limits and transfer approvals</a>. Three of its provisions matter more than its fines: article 35(6) substitutes a statute or decree for the regulator's authorisation, article 24 does the same for database interconnection, and article 4(2)(a) puts processing under state-secrecy, state-security and judicial-secrecy rules outside the law altogether.</p> <p>2026-06-17 — public consultation <a href="#">closed on a revision adding a data-protection officer duty for high-volume processors, stronger oversight and sanction mechanisms, and fines redenominated into local currency</a>, due at the Council of Ministers and then the National Assembly. No draft text is held.</p> <p>2026-06-25 — parliament <a href="#">rejected in plenary an amendment that would have opened the citizen databases and the electoral registers to parties and citizens, after it had cleared committee in April</a>. The registers stay closed.</p>      | Mixed, a revision consultation closed while an amendment opening electoral data was rejected |
| Botswana     | <p>The 2024 Data Protection Act <a href="#">has been in force since January 2025</a>, repealing a 2018 Act that never commenced; what moved in the window is enforcement.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act came into force on 14 January 2025, repealing a 2018 statute that was never commenced. It did not change in the window.</p> <p>What changed is that it began to bite. The commission that had three contract officers, no premises, no published address and no website in July 2025 issued a determination and enforcement notice against a government directorate in July 2026, reported under the authority below.</p> <p>The one amendment in prospect is the localisation duty reported under policy, which has no draft. No implementing regulations, codes of practice or approved-country list appear on this ledger.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | No change                                                                                    |
| Burkina Faso | <p>A new data protection law <a href="#">was voted on 3 August 2026</a> awaiting promulgation, after the 2021 statute <a href="#">ran five years without its enforcement decrees</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-08-03 — the legislative assembly voted a new law prohibiting and sanctioning processing without consent, indexing administrative fines to turnover and scaling them by gravity, prohibiting transfer of sensitive data abroad, requiring prior consent for commercial prospecting, and leaving private video-surveillance lawful but framed where it faces the public highway, <a href="#">reported the same day</a>. No text, number or gazette reference is held and it must clear conformity review before promulgation.</p> <p>Until then the 2021 law remains the operative text, and it ran its whole life without teeth: the commission was still pleading with the Prime Minister for the implementing decrees in March 2025, and they were never issued in the five years the law ran.</p> <p>The lesson the new law has to answer is its predecessor's: a statute with sanctions and no implementing machinery is not an enforcement regime, and publication of the decrees, or their express abrogation, would settle it.</p> | Advanced                                                                                     |
| Burundi      | <p>A personal data protection law <a href="#">was unanimously adopted on 15 January 2026</a>: eight chapters, an independent authority and criminal penalties, where no statute existed.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-01-15 — the National Assembly <a href="#">unanimously adopted a personal data protection law with eight chapters, an independent supervisory authority and criminal penalties, aligned to the African Union convention, reported the following day as the country's first such statute</a>. No statute existed before it.</p> <p>The sequencing is stated by the government itself: legislation came first in order to enable the biometric identity card, which is reported under digital identity and is technically ready but waiting on its own instrument. The authority the law creates is not on record as operating, reported below.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Advanced                                                                                     |

| COUNTRY                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS                                                                                                                  |
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| Cameroon                 | <p><a href="#">Loi n. 2024/017 on personal data protection is in force and unamended</a>, with no supervisory authority operating.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law was promulgated on 23 December 2024 and is in force, with no supervisory authority operating, a position restated to the National Assembly in April 2025.</p> <p>Nothing in the window amended it. The promulgated text was acquired in July 2026 and is held as a 24-page page-image scan of which pages 15 to 24 are unread, so what the statute obliges beyond its first half is not established from anything on file.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | No change                                                                                                                 |
| Cape Verde               | <p><a href="#">Lei 133/V/2001 is unamended in the window</a>, last changed in 2021 to require designation of data-protection officers.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The <a href="#">general regime closely mirrors the European standard, with administrative fines of CVE 50,000 to 3,000,000, cessation, blocking and deletion measures and criminal penalties up to two years, amended in 2013 to create the commission and in 2021 to require designation of data-protection officers.</a></p> <p>No amendment is recorded in the window. A <a href="#">named analyst argued in April 2025 for aligning it with artificial intelligence and adding mechanisms for algorithmic supervision</a>; no bill is held. The <a href="#">commission's president said in February 2025 that several institutions had not complied with the officer obligation.</a></p>                                                                                                                                                    | No change                                                                                                                 |
| Central African Republic | <p>The data protection law <a href="#">has been in force since January 2024 with no implementing decree</a>, and none appeared in the window.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law was promulgated in January 2024 as a <a href="#">comprehensive regime with no supervisory authority and no implementing decree</a>, and <a href="#">that remains the position</a>. The held text is a scan with a poor character layer, so its wording is legible and individual characters are not reliable.</p> <p>Nothing moved it in the twelve months to 2026-08-26: no decree, no amendment and no first application. The authority the law creates is reported below and does not exist either, so a comprehensive statute has been in force for nineteen months with neither the rules nor the body needed to apply it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                              | No change                                                                                                                 |
| Chad                     | <p>No <a href="#">general data-protection law or supervisory authority</a> exists, the function having been folded into the security agency, while a <a href="#">law on biometric data in judicial procedures</a> was adopted by 138 votes to 1.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>There is no enacted text, number or gazette reference for a general data-protection law, and the function was folded into the security agency in March 2026 (<a href="#">vacuum, finalisation</a>).</p> <p>The biometric-data law was adopted at a plenary in April 2026. Its gazetted text is not held, so retention periods, destruction procedure, oversight body and any requirement of judicial authorisation are unknown, and deputies raised concerns in debate about inappropriate use (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>Legislating the collection of biometric data for judicial use before legislating data protection at all is the sequence, and it is the reverse of the order every other unit in this frame attempts.</p> | Mixed, a biometric-data law adopted by 138 votes to 1 while no general data-protection statute or authority exists at all |
| Comoros                  | <p>The <a href="#">2021 data protection law is in force, aligned to the European regulation, with the national authority still not constituted</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law was enacted on 29 June 2021, is extraterritorial, requires seventy-two-hour breach notification and a mandatory data-protection officer and carries full data-subject rights, with <a href="#">the national authority not constituted</a>.</p> <p>Nothing moved. The authority's non-existence was <a href="#">restated in a procurement notice of 12 March 2026</a>. The statute is held only through an analyst review and is cited as analysis; its own text is not held, so what a Comorian controller must actually do is not checkable from anything on file.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change                                                                                                                 |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS  |
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| Congo         | <p><a href="#">Loi n. 29-2019</a> remains in force, its institutional framework completed by a decree of 31 December 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law was promulgated on 10 October 2019 and stood in force at the window's opening with an incomplete institutional framework and no supervisory authority constituted; a decree of 31 December 2025 completed that framework.</p> <p>The statute itself did not move. Its text is not held, and its number and date reach the base only through a secondary outlet's account of the commission's first session, so what it obliges a controller to do is not checkable from anything on file - including whether registration or notification is required at all.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | No change |
| Cote d'Ivoire | <p><a href="#">Loi n 2013-450</a> remains in force and unamended, with the telecommunications regulator confirmed as the data-protection authority.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law has stood since 19 June 2013, designating the telecommunications regulator as the data-protection authority, and was confirmed in that role after the cyber agency's creation.</p> <p>Nothing in the window amended it. The base holds no text of the law and no implementing decree, so what it obliges a data controller to do is not checkable from anything on file, and the simplified norms the minister names as an advance rest on the same unheld basis.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | No change |
| Djibouti      | <p>The data-protection regime sits inside the Digital Code at 156 articles, with none of its obligations evidenced in operation.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The regime is in force within the Digital Code across 156 articles, providing for seventy-two-hour breach notification, mandatory data-protection officers and a public register, and none is evidenced in operation.</p> <p>Alongside it a tiered prior-authorisation regime for national-identifier and biometric processing is in force, with no authorisation on record for the police body-camera fleet.</p> <p>Nothing amended either in the window: what changed is what is being processed under them, not the law.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | No change |
| DR Congo      | <p>The Digital Code is now enforced on the state's own initiative, prosecutors instructed to open cases without a complaint.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The 2023 framework law was in force at the window's opening, its third book governing personal data, with no data-protection authority operational.</p> <p>2026-08-17 - the attorney general at the Court of Cassation instructed judicial police officers to open Digital Code cases on their own initiative and forward them for summary hearing, and the audiovisual regulator's president is contemplating closing a video platform outright after it did not act on a request to block more than 2,000 accounts.</p> <p>The enforcement now running is criminal rather than regulatory: the law's personal-data book has no supervisor, so what has moved is prosecution under it, not protection through it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Advanced  |
| Egypt         | <p>The 2020 data-protection law was operationalised by Executive Regulations issued on 1 November 2025, enforceable from 1 November 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law had been in force since 2020 and never operationalised, with no executive regulations issued - which is why the Alexandria Economic Court decided a mobile-operator case in February 2025 on tort grounds, more than four years after the law passed.</p> <p>The Regulations were issued by ministerial decree on 1 November 2025 and circulated in December, establishing the approvals model, a separate licence for each cross-border transfer specifying destination, purpose, data categories and safeguards, extra approvals for electronic marketing and certain public-space surveillance, registered data-protection officers, and breach notification within seventy-two hours to the regulator and three business days to affected individuals. The obligations become enforceable from 1 November 2026 at the end of a one-year grace period. The Regulations' own text is not held.</p> | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY           | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS  |
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| Equatorial Guinea | <p><a href="#">Ley 1/2016</a> has been in force since August 2016, giving rights of access, rectification, cancellation and opposition and a sanctions regime to CFA 15,000,000.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>It was gazetted on 22 July 2016 and took effect twenty days later (<a href="#">the law</a>).</p> <p>Ten years on, no implementing decree, guidance or enforcement action under it is held, and the country signed the continental convention on the same subject only in July 2026.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | No change |
| Eritrea           | <p>A verification pass dated August 2026 confirms no comprehensive data-protection law in force (<a href="#">redetermination</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A dated redetermination as of 1 August 2026 confirms the position is unchanged: no comprehensive data-protection law in force, no supervisory authority established and no enforcement decisions published (<a href="#">redetermination</a>).</p> <p>A regional ministerial assessment places Eritrea's data-protection policy area at a nascent stage without legislation or regulatory oversight, grouped with Djibouti, South Sudan and Sudan against neighbours that have enacted frameworks with supervisory authorities (<a href="#">policy matrix</a>).</p> <p>A trade regulatory profile records that Eritrea lacks a comprehensive legal framework for data protection, with no data-protection officer, impact-assessment or retention requirements (<a href="#">profile</a>).</p> <p>This is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one: three independent assessments across four years agree.</p> | No change |
| Eswatini          | <p>The <a href="#">Data Protection Act 2022</a> has been effective since March 2022, and its gazetted text names a Commission while the regulator describes itself as the designated Agency.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act was gazetted and took effect on 4 March 2022. The mismatch between the body the statute names and the body describing itself as designated is recorded rather than resolved (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>The Act is being read in press accounts as exposing online naming and shaming to a substantial penalty; that is an account of legal exposure rather than an enforcement action, and no complaint, ruling or authority statement is held (<a href="#">exposure</a>).</p> <p>A statute whose enforcing body is ambiguous on the face of the record is a limit on everything the protection cells below can say.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | No change |
| Ethiopia          | <p><a href="#">Proclamation 1321/2024</a> has been in force since July 2024, a comprehensive regime with extraterritorial reach and no secondary directives behind it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The proclamation took effect on 24 July 2024 as a comprehensive personal data regime reaching beyond the country's borders (<a href="#">Proclamation 1321/2024</a>).</p> <p>What the base does not hold is any instrument under it: the directives that would give the proclamation operative content were still unissued a year after commencement (<a href="#">a year on</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | No change |
| Gabon             | <p><a href="#">Loi n 025/2023</a> has bound from publication on 15 July 2023, with article 219 setting no grace period and no transitional window.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute was published in the gazette of 15 July 2023 and took effect at once, article 219 allowing no transition (<a href="#">Loi n 025/2023</a>).</p> <p>It repeals contrary prior provisions of the 2020 ordinance, and the base does not establish whether the funding levy that ordinance created was carried forward (<a href="#">the 2020 ordinance</a>).</p> <p>The gazetted text of the founding 2011 statute is not held, so the earlier baseline is read only through the amending instruments.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change |

| COUNTRY        | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | PROGRESS  |
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| <b>Gambia</b>  | <p>The <a href="#">Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2025</a> was enacted after several stalled years, with extraterritorial scope and seven lawful bases.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>It carries a sensitive-data regime covering genetic, biometric and health data, and rights of access, rectification, erasure and protection from solely automated decisions (<a href="#">review</a>).</p> <p>Passage was in October 2025 (<a href="#">passage</a>).</p> <p>No implementing regulation, commencement notice or first enforcement action under it is held, and the commission that would supervise it is not separately constituted on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced  |
| <b>Ghana</b>   | <p>The <a href="#">Data Protection Act 2012</a> is in force and unamended, with a draft replacement published during 2025 and not enacted.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The 2012 statute remains the sole general data-protection law, reaching controllers and processors rather than the data-broker layer an operator names as the source of leaks (<a href="#">the Act</a>).</p> <p>A replacement was drafted and published during 2025 and has not been enacted (<a href="#">draft replacement</a>).</p> <p>Fourteen years after commencement the base holds no amendment, no commencement instrument for a successor and no parliamentary timetable.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change |
| <b>Guinea</b>  | <p>The <a href="#">2016 cybersecurity and data-protection statute</a> covers processing by individuals, firms and public institutions, and is held only as an image scan.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The agency publishes it as a 57-page image-only scan with no text layer, so its provisions are the agency's summary rather than the statute's own words, and no promulgation date is published (<a href="#">the statute</a>).</p> <p>It reached the base through a summit profile rather than through the gazette (<a href="#">profile</a>).</p> <p>No implementing decree, supervisory authority, registration duty or enforcement action under its data-protection half is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | No change |
| <b>Kenya</b>   | <p>The <a href="#">2019 Act</a> is in force, and a court awarded <a href="#">eleven petitioners KES 900,000 each</a> for a sustained compromise of subscriber data.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The regulator is now stretching the Act's cross-border-transfer duties to reach offshore artificial-intelligence processing (<a href="#">the Act</a>, <a href="#">quality standards</a>).</p> <p>The judgment of 13 May 2026 found a sustained and systematic compromise; the telco is not named in the account held and the judgment text is not on file (<a href="#">judgment</a>).</p> <p>On the receiving side, 15 of 224 betting and gaming firms were fully registered as both controller and processor, with 185 unregistered and given 40 days or licence cancellation, and no follow-up is on file after the deadline expired (<a href="#">registration ultimatum</a>).</p> <p>The gambling regulator has an open investigation into three licensees, with the criminal investigations directorate requesting its entire record back to 2018 — the first move against recipients of leaked subscriber data rather than the leakers (<a href="#">investigation</a>).</p> | Advanced  |
| <b>Lesotho</b> | <p>The <a href="#">Data Protection Act 2011</a> remains in force and unamended, on the most recent account held, dated March 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act has been in force since 2011 and was recorded as unamended as at 23 March 2026 (<a href="#">review</a>).</p> <p>No amendment, regulation or commencement instrument has been published since, and the base holds no enforcement action, complaint count or guidance issued under it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No change |

| COUNTRY           | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | PROGRESS                       |
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| <b>Liberia</b>    | <p>The <a href="#">Personal Information Act</a> was signed into force on 19 August 2026, with no authority yet existing to administer it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>It had been referred to a House committee in June 2025 and left unpassed, drafted with a media-development organisation under a European programme and validated in December 2024 (<a href="#">signature</a>, <a href="#">committee stage</a>).</p> <p>The base holds no authority, commencement order, registration regime or enforcement route under it, so what a data subject can actually do with it is unestablished.</p> <p>The country is a regional data-protection signatory and had until this month struggled to enforce privacy law at all (<a href="#">enforcement position</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced                       |
| <b>Libya</b>      | <p>No data-protection statute is in force; the <a href="#">National Artificial Intelligence Strategy</a> sets 2026 as the target for one, with nothing enacted by August.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The strategy published in October 2025 names a data-protection law among its 2026 deliverables (<a href="#">strategy</a>). Nothing had been enacted as at 10 August 2026, and the base holds no draft text, no sponsoring ministry and no parliamentary stage for it.</p> <p>Personal-data systems have meanwhile continued to be built and launched without one.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | No change                      |
| <b>Madagascar</b> | <p>The <a href="#">data-protection law of 2014</a> has been in force since January 2015 and is recorded as unenforced.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law is in force and unenforced, and excludes part of journalistic practice from its scope (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>Eleven years on, no amendment, implementing decree, enforcement action or guidance under it is held, and the supervisory body it provides for has never been constituted.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | No change                      |
| <b>Malawi</b>     | <p>The <a href="#">Data Protection Act 2024</a> exempted most controllers for twenty-four months from commencement, and that exemption elapsed in early June 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act commenced in June 2024 with the regulator designated data protection authority, and exempted controllers and processors not of significant importance from compliance for twenty-four months, so most of the economy sat outside its obligations (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>The general exemption elapsed in early June 2026 so that all controllers and processors are now within scope, while the subsidiary instruments to operate registration and enforcement were still in draft (<a href="#">compliance</a>, <a href="#">terms of reference</a>). The commencement day cannot be settled from this base: the circulating expiry date implies a 2 June 2024 commencement and the commencement notice is not held.</p> | Advanced, grace period elapsed |
| <b>Mali</b>       | <p>The <a href="#">personal data protection law of 2013</a> has been in force since May 2013 as amended, and is the stated basis for the authority's sanctions.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute is in force and the data-protection authority cites it as the basis on which it fines and issues formal notices (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>No amendment, implementing decree or consolidated text has entered the base since, so what can be established here is that the law is used rather than what it now says.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change                      |
| <b>Mauritania</b> | <p>The <a href="#">data protection law</a> has been in force since July 2017, requiring approved codes of conduct and free, unambiguous consent, with no enforcement decision published.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute covers both manual and electronic processing and requires codes of conduct approved by the authority and free, unambiguous consent (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>The authority runs monthly ordinary meetings and sensitisation days for ministries, telecom operators and financial institutions, and no enforcement decision, register entry, sanction or annual report is published (<a href="#">authority</a>). The held extraction of the law cuts off mid-article, so the chapters covering the authority's powers and sanctions are not captured.</p>                                                                                                                                         | No change                      |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS                                                                                                             |
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| Mauritius  | <p><a href="#">Data Protection Officer Regulations</a> were promulgated in June 2026 for January 2027, while the <a href="#">Data Protection Act 2017</a> is not among the fifty-eight Acts the omnibus amends.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The regulations formalise designation, qualifications, independence and reporting duties for data protection officers across public and private sectors, with a six-month compliance window (<a href="#">regulations</a>).</p> <p>Amendments to the Act itself were committed in July 2026 with no text, timetable or introduction date (<a href="#">commitment</a>), and the Act is not among the fifty-eight statutes the omnibus bill amends (<a href="#">bill</a>). The year's expanded inter-agency data sharing therefore arrives with no matching safeguards amendment (<a href="#">assessment</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Mixed, officer regulations promulgated while the Act itself was left out of an omnibus amending fifty-eight statutes |
| Morocco    | <p><a href="#">Law 09-08</a> has been in force since 2009, and the regulator states on the record that a recast is now in the legislative circuit.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The commission's president stated in August 2026 that a recast developed with the justice ministry has been sent to the government's general secretariat, describing it as clarification rather than replacement (<a href="#">statement</a>, <a href="#">account</a>).</p> <p>No transmission date or text is held (<a href="#">framework bill</a>). The statute's own text and gazette reference are not held either, nor any amending instrument, and a 2023 amendment survives only as an analyst's attributed statement (<a href="#">guide</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Advanced                                                                                                             |
| Mozambique | <p>The <a href="#">personal data protection bill</a> was being prepared for submission to parliament in August 2026, with no text, timetable or tabling date published.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Civil society argued at a round table on the draft data protection law that the country needs greater national capacity to store and process strategic, sensitive and personal data in infrastructure under its own jurisdiction (<a href="#">round table</a>).</p> <p>The agency's president stated in August 2026 that the draft is being prepared for submission; the Cabinet submission planned for June 2026 is not on record (<a href="#">statement</a>).</p> <p>An independent review of the proposed law was published in September 2025 (<a href="#">review</a>), and the government was recorded as preparing it in July 2026 (<a href="#">preparation</a>).</p> <p>Until it passes, the country's data rules are scattered across a constitutional article, the electronic transactions law, banking and labour statutes and a 2003 central-bank notice, with a ratified regional convention and no domestic statute giving effect to it.</p> | Advanced                                                                                                             |
| Namibia    | <p>The <a href="#">Data Protection Bill</a> has not been tabled about thirteen years after drafting began, and the <a href="#">March 2022 draft</a> remains the last version published for comment.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A tabling was announced for September 2025 (<a href="#">announcement</a>, <a href="#">return</a>) and the bill was still in finalisation in August 2026, with no data-protection statute in force (<a href="#">finalisation</a>, <a href="#">concerns</a>).</p> <p>The March 2022 revised draft runs to fifty-nine pages and eight Parts, with the supervisory authority at Part 2 (<a href="#">draft</a>).</p> <p>The 2020 version carries a Part on rights of the data subject, together with Parts on recourse to the judicial authority and on offences and penalties, none of which appears in the 2022 version, where access and correction survive only as controller obligations (<a href="#">2020 version</a>, <a href="#">removal</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                        | Stalled                                                                                                              |
| Niger      | <p><a href="#">Loi 2022-59 on personal data protection</a> has been in force since December 2022, replacing the 2017 statute and supplemented by a 2023 law.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute replaced the 2017 law and is supplemented by a further 2023 law (<a href="#">law</a>, <a href="#">predecessor</a>).</p> <p>No amendment, implementing decree or enforcement record has entered the base since. It is the privacy backstop for a biometric identity programme now in mass enrolment, which is what makes the absence of a caseload figure material.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No change                                                                                                            |

| COUNTRY               | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nigeria               | <p>The <a href="#">Data Protection Act 2023</a> is in force with an <a href="#">amendment bill</a> before the assembly, and the <a href="#">first damages award</a> under it was made in July 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act is criticised as structurally weak in placing the commission under ministerial control, and its section 63 gives it primacy over any inconsistent law on personal-data processing; the federal government and the governors' forum have been urging states to implement it, which is an admission that the tier handling civil registration, health, education and land records is not yet compliant (<a href="#">Act, accountability</a>).</p> <p>An amendment bill was introduced in July 2026 (<a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>A court awarded ₦15m general damages, costs and post-judgment interest for marketing after consent was withdrawn, grounded on the Act, the constitutional privacy provision and the consumer-protection Act together; it held personal data must be erased on termination but refused wholesale deletion where statutory banking retention applies (<a href="#">judgment</a>).</p> | Advanced                                                                                                                                      |
| Rwanda                | <p>The <a href="#">data protection and privacy law</a> has been fully in force since a two-year grace period ended in October 2023, and the Act's own text and law number are not held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The grace period ended on 15 October 2023, and the authority's framing of the period since is a year of accountability for controllers (<a href="#">law, expansion</a>).</p> <p>Neither the Act's text nor its law number is held. What the base can say about the regime is therefore drawn from secondary accounts of it and from the appropriation lines that fund the supervisory authority.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | No change                                                                                                                                     |
| Sao Tome and Principe | <p>A <a href="#">personal data protection law of 2016</a> modelled on a superseded European directive is enforced by the national authority, and the primary text is not held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The enactment year is taken from the law's own designation, and the only source describing it is a 2024 secondary legal survey rather than the 2016 text (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>Modelling on a directive that Europe itself replaced in 2018 is the substantive point: the regime the authority enforces is two generations behind the standard its cooperation partners now work to.</p> <p>The country is a signatory to the continental cyber and data convention, with ratification status not stated (<a href="#">convention</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | No change                                                                                                                                     |
| Senegal               | <p>The <a href="#">personal data law of 2008</a> has stood eighteen years unamended, and a <a href="#">revision bill</a> was taken to a two-day workshop to finalise it with its implementing decree.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law was promulgated in January 2008 and came into force in 2014, and no amending law is found. It did not move through the February 2026 breach of the national identity directorate (<a href="#">law, modernisation</a>).</p> <p>A workshop was convened to finalise the revision bill and its implementing decree; the source is proxy-dated, so the workshop's own date is unknown and must not be rendered as July 2026 (<a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>The national data strategy is the frame requiring the bill to be re-levelled, so the revision is being written to a strategy rather than to the breach.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Mixed, a revision bill in finalisation while the law in force has stood eighteen years unamended through a breach of the identity directorate |
| Seychelles            | <p>The <a href="#">Data Protection Act 2023</a> is in force in full, its eighteen-month transition having elapsed, and it expressly recognises participation in a global cross-border privacy system.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act commenced in December 2023 with an eighteen-month transition; that period has elapsed and controllers and processors are now subject to it in full (<a href="#">Act, force, review</a>).</p> <p>A continental review adds that the Act expressly recognises participation in a global cross-border privacy rules system (<a href="#">reforms</a>).</p> <p>A statute fully in force with an explicit cross-border interoperability provision puts this unit ahead of most in the frame on the law. What it lacks is recorded in the next cell.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | No change                                                                                                                                     |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS                                                                                 |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sierra Leone | <p>Cabinet <a href="#">authorised a Data Protection and Right to Access Information Bill</a> in April 2026, and the country has had no data-protection law in force throughout the period.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Bill was finalised in November 2025 and Cabinet approved the policy and authorised the Bill on 21 April 2026 (<a href="#">bill, finalisation</a>).</p> <p>No data-protection law has been in force at any point in the period. That is the frame for everything else in this unit: a biometric register covering most of the population, subscriber data disclosed to police, an identity migration in pilot and two competing identity platforms, all operating with no statutory data-protection regime behind them.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced                                                                                 |
| Somalia      | <p>A <a href="#">Data Protection Act</a> has been in effect since March 2023, and a <a href="#">regulatory framework under it</a> was approved by the Council of Ministers in January 2026 and adopted the following month.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act has been in effect since 23 March 2023 and its implementing regulations were reviewed (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>The regulatory framework was approved on 8 January 2026 and adopted in February (<a href="#">approval, adoption</a>).</p> <p>A statute in force since 2023 with regulations adopted in 2026 and an authority taking its first nationwide enforcement step in June puts this country ahead of several larger units in this frame on the sequence, if not on capacity.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Advanced                                                                                 |
| South Africa | <p>The Act is unamended, but binding <a href="#">regulations on the processing of health information</a> were gazetted in March 2026 and the regulator <a href="#">states it is working to amend the Act for AI and privacy by design</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-03-06 - the regulator <a href="#">gazetted final regulations on the processing of data subjects' health information by certain responsible parties, effective on publication and binding on confidentiality, integrity, availability and cross-border transfer</a>. They are subordinate legislation under the Act rather than an amendment to it, and they are the one binding instrument the window produced.</p> <p>The statute itself did not move. What is on the record beyond the regulations is an intention: the regulator <a href="#">stated on 18 August 2026 that it is working with the justice department to amend the Act to cover artificial intelligence and privacy by design</a>, and in the same session that it has no capability to test external systems for privacy compliance before launch.</p> <p>The Act's own terms are unchanged and its ceiling is low against the harm it addresses: <a href="#">five years on, the maximum fine remains R10m</a> against an average measured breach cost several times that. No amendment Bill, gazette notice or draft text is held, so that half is a stated programme of work rather than a legislative step.</p> | Mixed, binding health-information regulations gazetted while the Act itself is unamended |
| South Sudan  | <p>No <a href="#">data-protection statute or commission</a> exists, only a constitutional privacy right, and the minister <a href="#">states a bill will come</a> after a policy bill drafted in October 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>What stands is the Transitional Constitution's privacy article and nothing else: no statute and no commission as at August 2026 (<a href="#">absence</a>).</p> <p>The minister stated in December 2025 that a bill will come in 2026, and a policy bill was drafted in October 2025 by a civil-society partnership (<a href="#">statement, feature, drafting</a>).</p> <p>Meanwhile a biometric payroll register, a humanitarian biometric registration and a planned universal digital identity are all being built with no statute governing any of them.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Advanced                                                                                 |

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | PROGRESS  |
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| <b>Sudan</b>    | <p>A <a href="#">draft Data and Artificial Intelligence Law</a> is in redrafting with the digital transformation ministry, legislating data protection and artificial intelligence in one instrument.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The draft went to the Council of Ministers with two others and was reported back in redrafting in August 2026 (<a href="#">draft</a>, <a href="#">redrafting</a>).</p> <p>Legislating data protection and artificial intelligence in a single instrument is a design few African states have attempted. Neither text is published, so what it would provide on lawful basis, consent, transfer or supervision cannot be stated.</p> <p>The authority that would enforce it already exists, created by decree ahead of the statute.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Advanced  |
| <b>Tanzania</b> | <p>The <a href="#">Personal Data Protection Act, 2022</a> commenced in May 2023 with regulations in force, and practitioners record that key terms remain undefined and there is no adequacy mechanism for cross-border transfers.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Practitioners record that security breach and without undue delay remain undefined, that there is no adequacy mechanism for cross-border transfers, and that there is no duty to notify data subjects (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>Those three gaps bear directly on the rest of this unit: the identity register connects to more than 138 institutions, the social-media tax-credential rule publishes trader identifiers, and the financial consumer-protection regulations cross-reference this Act as their data basis.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | No change |
| <b>Togo</b>     | <p>A <a href="#">personal data protection law of ninety-seven articles</a> was gazetted in October 2019, and what moved in the period is the base's holding of it rather than the instrument.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law was gazetted on 29 October 2019 and the gazette's own signature block is dated a day after the title date (<a href="#">law</a>, <a href="#">implementation</a>).</p> <p>The instrument did not move in the window. It is the statute that created the protection authority by an article rather than by a separate constitutive act, and it is the basis for the corporate correspondents programme recorded separately.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No change |
| <b>Tunisia</b>  | <p>A <a href="#">draft organic law on personal data protection</a> was deposited in July 2025 and reached committee hearings in February 2026, to replace the <a href="#">2004 organic law</a> still governing.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The bill was deposited on 14 July 2025, referred to the rights and liberties committee two days later, and heard in committee in February 2026 (<a href="#">deposit</a>, <a href="#">hearings</a>, <a href="#">update</a>).</p> <p>The tabled Arabic text is held from the Assembly's own dossier and its article count is settled from it at 132: a committee account giving 123 reads as a transposition whose six-part structure matches the tabled text section for section, and a third account's 32 is a leading-digit loss in optical transcription. Whether the committee has since shortened the bill is not established.</p> <p>The 2004 law was still the governing instrument when the replacement entered committee (<a href="#">law</a>, <a href="#">rights</a>).</p> | Advanced  |
| <b>Uganda</b>   | <p>The <a href="#">Data Protection and Privacy Act</a> is in force and the office's director stated a shortfall of some 35,000 unregistered controllers against a 50,000 estimate.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute did not change; the estimate is the office's own and no prosecution outcome is held (<a href="#">shortfall</a>, <a href="#">enforcement</a>, <a href="#">decision</a>, <a href="#">order</a>).</p> <p>Registration at roughly three parts in ten of the office's own estimate of the controller population, three years into the regime, is what the enforcement record below has to be read against.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS  |
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| Zambia   | <p>The <a href="#">Data Protection Act 2021</a> is named as part of the operative framework, and a reported Cabinet repeal intent has produced nothing in sixteen months.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act's number and year of enactment are not established beyond 2021, and the reported repeal intent has produced nothing on the record in sixteen months (<a href="#">framework</a>, <a href="#">safeguards</a>, <a href="#">freedom</a>).</p> <p>A statute whose own enactment reference cannot be established, under a repeal intent that has produced nothing, is the legal basis under which the identity register, the health record and the refugee database all operate.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | No change |
| Zimbabwe | <p>The <a href="#">Cyber and Data Protection Act</a> was consolidated in 2022, and <a href="#">Statutory Instrument 155 of 2024</a> created a data-controller licensing regime a legal expert calls new and strange.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The same Act establishes a cyber security centre and inserts a false-data-message offence into the criminal code (<a href="#">Act</a>, <a href="#">overview</a>).</p> <p>The statutory instrument was gazetted in September 2024 with licence applications due six months on; two outlets date the deadline to 12 March 2025 and the gazetted text's own reckoning gives 13 March, and an analyst expects the cost to reach consumers as dearer airtime and data (<a href="#">instrument</a>, <a href="#">warning</a>, <a href="#">fees</a>).</p> <p>Two regulatory notices followed in 2026, neither published by the regulator itself: the first is reported with no signature date held (<a href="#">notice one</a>), and the second sets inspections beginning 1 September 2026 (<a href="#">notice two</a>).</p> | Advanced  |

## Cybersecurity legislation

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS                                     |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Angola   | <p>The National Assembly <a href="#">adopted the cybersecurity bill on 12 August 2026 by 104 votes to 56</a>, with promulgation and entry into force not on file.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-08-12 — the National Assembly <a href="#">adopted the bill in plenary by 104 votes to 56 on a presidential initiative, the governing party for and the main opposition against with no abstentions, after committee approval on 4 August and passage in generality in January 2026</a>.</p> <p>The text <a href="#">sets graduated administrative fines as multiples of the national minimum wage, from 7 to 70 for individuals on minor infractions and up to 500 for individuals and 4,000 for legal persons on the most serious. It also requires telecommunications operators to transmit any communication whose content is criminal or prejudicial to state security, which the opposition and part of civil society object to as leaving unclear which content qualifies and on what terms subscribers' personal data reaches the authorities, a year before the presidential election.</a></p> <p>No promulgation, gazette number or entry into force is on file. The vote followed a cyberattack on the incumbent operator and came days after the online-falsehoods law entered into force.</p> | Advanced                                     |
| Botswana | <p>The Cybersecurity Act <a href="#">was assented in November 2025 and gazetted, and was still not in force at the window's close</a>, its stated April 2026 commencement having passed.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-11-05 — <a href="#">the Act was assented and gazetted on 11 November 2025, with commencement on notice, against a Bill only at the start of the window. Commencement was stated for April 2026 and that date passed with no notice on file. Section 3(2) excludes classified information held by eight security and revenue bodies.</a></p> <p>So <a href="#">the 2018 cybercrime statute remains the operative law, its repeal enacted and not commenced</a>.</p> <p>The authority the Act creates is in the same position. <a href="#">It exists in law with a board, a chief executive, a licensing power over cybersecurity providers, a power to approve software before market placement and a critical-infrastructure mandate, and it is not established, with no organisation or vote in the year's estimates — an authority in law with no money at both the legal and the fiscal end.</a></p>                                                                                                                                                                            | Advanced, made and gazetted but not in force |

| COUNTRY                         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | PROGRESS  |
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| <b>Burkina Faso</b>             | <p>Two application decrees <a href="#">were adopted on 30 July 2026</a>, classifying critical-infrastructure bodies and fixing periodic audits and auditor accreditation under the 2024 security law.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-07-30 — the Council of Ministers adopted a decree identifying, classifying and setting obligations for critical-infrastructure bodies, defined as any entity housing installations indispensable to society's vital functions and expressly spanning energy, water, health, telecommunications and finance, and a second decree fixing conditions for periodic audits and vesting auditor accreditation in the national cyberspace control body. Before them the 2024 law asserted an auditor-accreditation duty with no procedure attached.</p> <p>Two things the decrees do not close. The accrediting body is named by function rather than by institution. And <a href="#">the technical approval and homologation regime for security products, provided by articles 7 and 9 of the law and carrying fines of FCFA 2m to 100m for importing or selling without approval, is still left to a regulation that has not been made.</a></p> <p>The mapping instrument lands just before the mass biometric enrolment it will have to cover, reported under registration of the population.</p> | Advanced  |
| <b>Burundi</b>                  | <p>A stand-alone cybercrime statute <a href="#">has been in force since March 2022</a>, with cybersecurity obligations carried in the <a href="#">2024 communications code</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">Loi n 1/10 du 16 mars 2022 portant prevention et repression de la cybercriminalite</a> is in force and recorded as such on the official legal database, and the base holds its complete promulgated text.</p> <p><a href="#">The 2024 code des communications electroniques et postales carries cybersecurity obligations at articles 160 to 167 alongside it.</a> Nothing moved on either in the window. What the base does not hold is any implementing regulation, any national cybersecurity strategy, or any published enforcement action under the 2022 statute.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change |
| <b>Cameroon</b>                 | <p><a href="#">Loi n. 2010/012</a> remains in force and is invoked to justify network restrictions; no reform is adopted on record.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law has stood since 21 December 2010 and is <a href="#">in force and invoked to justify network restrictions, with civil-society reform recommendations pending and none adopted on record.</a></p> <p>The recommendations were addressed to government after a workshop in June 2026. Nothing since reports a government response, a drafting instruction or a bill. The statute is the legal basis under which the restrictions recorded elsewhere in this report were imposed, which is why its non-reform is the material fact rather than its age.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | No change |
| <b>Central African Republic</b> | <p>The cybersecurity and cybercrime law <a href="#">has been in force since early 2024 carrying six to ten year sentences</a>, and is <a href="#">named as the instrument now used against online content</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">The law was voted by acclamation in January 2024 and has been in force since, carrying six to ten year sentences and fines of FCFA 5m to 10m.</a> Its text is unchanged and the statute itself is not held, which is a standing acquisition target.</p> <p>2026-07-29 — <a href="#">a commentator names it as the instrument now used against online content.</a> That is an opinion column rather than a record of prosecutions, so what the base can state is the claim and not a case.</p> <p>The agency the same law creates has never been established, reported under cybersecurity readiness, so the enforcement side of the statute runs through the ordinary criminal process.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change |

| COUNTRY           | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | PROGRESS  |
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| Comoros           | <p><a href="#">Loi n 21-012/AU</a> was promulgated on 18 January 2022; <a href="#">cybercrime</a> sits separately at articles 449 to 505 of the penal code.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The base's position on this indicator was wrong and is corrected here. The cybersecurity law was adopted by the Assembly on 25 June 2021 and promulgated by <a href="#">decret n 22-003/PR</a> on 18 January 2022; its own text defines cybersecurity, cybercrime, critical infrastructure and the supervisory commission, sets its scope at articles 1 to 4 and carries an offence and penalty regime covering illegal access, data and system integrity and fraud. It had been recorded as drafted and not enacted, on a 2021 agency account written before promulgation.</p> <p>The penal code, promulgated in February 2021, separately covers technology-specific offences, online intellectual-property infringement and service-provider liability at articles 449 to 505.</p> <p>Nothing moved in the window. No implementing decree, prosecution, caseload or enforcement figure is on file at either end.</p> | No change |
| Cote d'Ivoire     | <p><a href="#">Ordonnance n 2024-950</a>, ratified by the Senate in June 2025, is unchanged in law and remains the transfer instrument.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The ordinance <a href="#">moved network security, audit, certification and electronic-certificate issuance from the telecommunications regulator to the cyber agency</a>, and was ratified on 16 June 2025, a step carried through the <a href="#">electronic-exchanges ratification law</a>.</p> <p>Nothing in the window amended it. What moved is the exercise of the transferred mandate rather than the statute: the certificate power is now used through the national root of trust. No consolidated cybersecurity statute exists, and the successor strategy is a policy instrument rather than a law.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | No change |
| Djibouti          | <p>The <a href="#">Digital Code</a> was published in September 2025 and a statutory cybersecurity authority followed in December.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Digital Code, <a href="#">regulating personal data, electronic communications, cybersecurity and cybercrime</a>, was published in the Official Journal on 18 September 2025 after adoption on 30 June.</p> <p>2025-11-04 - the Council of Ministers approved the bill creating a National Cybersecurity Authority attached to the Presidency, tasked with the national strategy, protection of critical infrastructure and state information systems; the National Assembly passed it on 12 November.</p> <p>A World Bank report records <a href="#">operationalising the Code's telecommunications and cybersecurity books as a priority</a>; no implementing decree under either is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced  |
| Egypt             | <p>A <a href="#">regulatory framework for cybersecurity services</a> rests on the 2018 crimes law, which two bills would now amend.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The regulator's <a href="#">operative framework for providing cybersecurity services</a> rests on the 2018 information technology crimes law and the 2003 telecommunications regulation law.</p> <p>2026-04-22 - two separately sponsored private members' bills would amend the 2018 law: one to strengthen protection of children against newly emerging electronic crimes, the other to address artificial-intelligence-generated deepfakes and tie fines to the benefit obtained. Neither is recorded as passed.</p> <p>The regulator also <a href="#">signed a cross-border cyber security cooperation agreement with a Gulf council in October 2025</a>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Advanced  |
| Equatorial Guinea | <p><a href="#">Ley 7/2024 on social media and computer crime</a> has been in force since December 2024, its full text unheld and its provisions known from reporting.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Its provisions were reported in rollout from July 2026 (<a href="#">the law</a>).</p> <p>The same statute creates the national cybersecurity and critical infrastructure agency under the Presidency, and that body has no premises, staffing, budget or activity on record, so the law's institutional half exists only on paper.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | No change |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS  |
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| Eritrea  | <p>Computer offences sit in two articles of the general Penal Code; no dedicated cybersecurity statute exists (<a href="#">Penal Code</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Eritrea's only identifiable computer-offence provisions are Articles 374 and 375 of the 2015 Penal Code, covering unauthorised use of a computer — unauthorised access, interception, alteration or destruction of data, interference with lawful data use — and an aggravated form (<a href="#">Penal Code</a>).</p> <p>A country cybersecurity assessment records, item by item, no cybercrime legislation, no cybersecurity regulation, no officially recognised national computer incident response team, no national cybersecurity strategy, no governance roadmap and no responsible agency (<a href="#">assessment</a>).</p> <p>Nothing in the window changed either position. Criminal provisions exist; the institutional apparatus a cybersecurity regime needs does not.</p>     | No change |
| Eswatini | <p><a href="#">Cybersecurity, critical infrastructure, e-commerce and artificial-intelligence legislation</a> was named as forthcoming alongside the capital's smart-city deployment.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The communications regulator publicly stated that cyberbullying is a criminal offence under the computer crime statute (<a href="#">statement</a>). No prosecution or complaint figure is on the base.</p> <p>Four instruments were named together in August 2025 (<a href="#">legislation</a>).</p> <p>None has entered the base since as a draft, a tabling or an enactment. Naming a legislative programme alongside a deployment of 59 camera systems and a fifth-generation network is the sequence worth recording: the deployment is in progress and the four laws that would govern it are a list.</p>                                                                                                                                    | Advanced  |
| Ethiopia | <p><a href="#">Proclamation 1426/2026</a> designates twelve critical sectors and places eighteen obligations on their owners and operators, commencing about July 2027.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The proclamation was signed at Addis Ababa on 21 July 2026, and article 28 sets commencement one year after gazettment (<a href="#">Proclamation 1426/2026</a>).</p> <p>The designated sectors run from information and communications technology, financial services and transport to agriculture, trade and industry; a Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Fund is established, and the security agency is to write sector standards, give technical assistance and enforce through the transition (<a href="#">briefing on the proclamation</a>).</p> <p>Ratification, assent and commencement dates are not established in the base, and the regulations the Council of Ministers and the agency may make under articles 26 and 27 do not yet exist.</p> | Advanced  |
| Gabon    | <p><a href="#">Loi n 027/2023</a> on cybersecurity and cybercrime is in force from July 2023, its text not held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute appeared in the same gazette issue as the data-protection law, of 15 July 2023, and is named as present in the captured issue without being reproduced in it (<a href="#">gazette issue</a>).</p> <p>It reaches the base through the security agency's own account of its work rather than through the instrument (<a href="#">agency account</a>).</p> <p>No article text, implementing decree, prosecution or sanction under it is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | No change |

| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS                                                                                                                |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ghana   | <p>The <a href="#">Cybersecurity Act 2020</a> produced its first published penalties in August 2026, three totalling GH¢720,000, of which two are already unsettled.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act establishes the cyber security authority and a fund, provides for designation, registration and compliance audit of critical information infrastructure, and licenses cybersecurity service providers, with no licence register, designation list or enforcement record held before this month (<a href="#">the Act, in application</a>).</p> <p>The authority fined the companies registrar GH¢240,000 for engaging an unlicensed provider and that provider GH¢120,000 for operating without a licence (<a href="#">first penalties</a>).</p> <p>The registrar contests its sanction as premature and procedurally unfair, dating its procurement to a commitment authorisation of 28 November 2025 and a tender advertised on 4 December and evaluated on 22 December, before the directive it is said to have breached, and has asked the Attorney-General to intervene (<a href="#">challenge</a>).</p> <p>The largest penalty, GH¢360,000 against an accounting firm's Ghana practice, was announced and declared satisfactorily resolved in a joint statement the same day, with no statement of whether it was paid, reduced or withdrawn (<a href="#">penalty, resolution</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced                                                                                                                |
| Guinea  | <p>The <a href="#">first conviction</a> under the 2016 statute came in August 2026, and it ordered the deletion of the defendant's social-media account.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A court of first instance convicted an activist and entrepreneur of insult and defamation by means of a computer system on 19 August 2026, sentencing him to six months of which five were suspended and a 40 million GNF fine, and ordering the deletion of his account; the conviction rests on article 363 of the penal code and article 29 of the cybersecurity law (<a href="#">conviction</a>).</p> <p>The prosecution had sought a year and argued a conviction would set an example to other social-media users; the defence, which asked for acquittal, said it would consider an appeal. Deletion of an account as a criminal penalty is something the base holds no other instance of.</p> <p>The statute's cybercrime half reaches offences on national territory and those requiring collection of electronic evidence, again on the agency's summary rather than the text (<a href="#">the statute, in application</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Advanced                                                                                                                |
| Kenya   | <p>The Court of Appeal <a href="#">struck the false-publication sections</a> and a shutdown power, the National Assembly has <a href="#">appealed to the Supreme Court</a>, and <a href="#">cyber cafe logging rules</a> take effect in September 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The 2018 statute is narrowed by litigation, with the false-publication offences and the non-judicial website-shutdown power struck and a conservatory order blocking a national internet shutdown; the base does not date the judgments, so whether the narrowing falls inside the twelve months is unestablished (<a href="#">litigation</a>).</p> <p>Operators of public access centres must capture each customer's name and identity number, the terminal used and session times, and retain the records at least three years, on pain of fines of up to 0.2 per cent of annual turnover with a minimum of about US\$3,860 (<a href="#">rules</a>).</p> <p>The regulator clarified on 13 August 2026 that the conditions do not require operators to track browsing history; the conditions were gazetted on 7 August and take effect on 7 September 2026 (<a href="#">clarification</a>).</p> <p>2026-08-31 — the National Assembly <a href="#">asked the Supreme Court to restore sections 22 and 23, which carried fines of up to KSh 5m and up to ten years' imprisonment</a>. The Court of Appeal <a href="#">held the wording too broad, Parliament argues it reaches only knowing publication presented as authentic</a>. The statute's reach is contested, not settled.</p> <p>Accession to the Council of Europe cybercrime convention is planned, with public views invited by 11 September 2026 (<a href="#">accession</a>).</p> | Mixed, the cybercrime statute was narrowed by litigation while new logging duties were imposed on public access centres |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Lesotho    | <p>The Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill was split into a <a href="#">Cybercrime Bill</a> and a <a href="#">Cybersecurity Bill</a>, both awaiting National Assembly approval.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Both bills were reported on 29 July 2026 as awaiting National Assembly approval, on no published timetable (<a href="#">forum</a>, <a href="#">account</a>).</p> <p>The Cybersecurity Bill is intended to build the institutions protecting critical digital infrastructure, which is the statute the interim response team now operating was set up ahead of (<a href="#">interim body</a>). No text of either bill is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced |
| Liberia    | <p>The <a href="#">Cybercrime Act</a> was signed on 19 August 2026, seven months after passage, alongside <a href="#">sector cybersecurity regulations</a> already in force.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The signature ends a delay carried since January 2026, when Senate concurrence was communicated to the House; no commencement date, implementing regulation or enforcement body is published with it, and an international index still places the country in its second-lowest maturity tier (<a href="#">enactment</a>).</p> <p>The regulator's own 2026 regulations require telecom providers to store personal data primarily inside the country, establish an in-house cybersecurity unit within a year, notify the regulator of breaches within 24 hours and customers within 72, run annual penetration testing and keep security-event logs for at least twelve months; penalties are revenue-linked but apply only from a year after the effective date, and the penalty escalation ladder is unreadable in both held copies (<a href="#">regulations</a>).</p> <p>A National Cybersecurity Act scheduled for the third quarter of 2025 by the strategy's own action plan is not held as a draft, bill or enactment (<a href="#">action plan</a>).</p>                                                                                                     | Advanced |
| Libya      | <p>A comprehensive cybersecurity law is in drafting on the eastern legislative track, discussed with the <a href="#">National Security Council</a> in July 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The House of Representatives established a committee for the draft under the Speaker's decision 115 of 2025, and drafting was discussed with the National Security Council on 16 July 2026 (<a href="#">drafting</a>).</p> <p>No text has been published, no reading has been recorded, and the base holds nothing on how a law passed on that track would apply in the west of the country.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced |
| Madagascar | <p>A <a href="#">complete recasting of the 2014 cybercrime law</a> is one of <a href="#">three digital bills</a> before the extraordinary session opened on 25 August 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The cybercrime bill reached the National Assembly carrying prison terms of two to ten years and providing for a new digital protection and investigation unit (<a href="#">report</a>), presented as an update of the state's arsenal against rising digital risk (<a href="#">account</a>).</p> <p>The bill was adopted by the Council of Ministers and would define security incidents and critical infrastructure organisations, revise electronic evidence and connection-data retention, and require operator cooperation with justice (<a href="#">adoption</a>, <a href="#">account</a>).</p> <p>Revision was reported again in August 2026 alongside signature of the United Nations cybercrime convention, with findings that artificial-intelligence-enabled fraud is outpacing African states' response capacity given as the reason (<a href="#">revision</a>).</p> <p>Three of the seven bills on the session's order paper are digital: one on electronic communication and digital infrastructure, one recasting the cybercrime law and one authorising ratification of the convention (<a href="#">order paper</a>). No bill texts are on file.</p> | Advanced |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | PROGRESS           |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Malawi     | <p>The <a href="#">2016 Act</a> is in force since 1 June 2017; a policy and strategy went to consultation in December 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute's own text is now held. The <a href="#">Electronic Transactions and Cyber Security Act, chapter 74:02</a>, has been in force since 1 June 2017 and establishes the computer emergency response team.</p> <p>2025-12 - <a href="#">regional stakeholder consultations</a> ran from 1 to 5 December 2025 to support a new cyber security policy and strategy; no draft or timetable is on record, and the account is an officer's personal post rather than an institutional one.</p> <p>2026-02 - the regulator <a href="#">reported that the parliamentary committee on media and communications pledged to support review of the legislation governing mobile-money fraud</a>. A pledge to review is the whole of the parliamentary record here.</p>                                                                                                                                      | Advanced           |
| Mauritius  | <p>The <a href="#">Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act 2021</a> has been in force since December 2021 and carries the fake-profile, cyberbullying and undesirable-content offences.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The enacted text as gazetted is held, carrying the offences of misuse of a fake profile, cyberbullying and failure to moderate undesirable content with their penalty scales (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>It is the statute the ministry's own online-content warnings rest on, and no charge, prosecution or takedown count under any of those sections is published in this base.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | No change          |
| Morocco    | <p><a href="#">Law 05-20 on cybersecurity</a> has been in force since July 2020, with its own article 53 deferring effect to implementing texts the base does not hold.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law sets outsourcing conditions in article 12 and penalties in article 49, and defers its force to implementing texts in article 53 (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>The decree defining the sensitive data the law turns on is not held, so the statute is on the books and the base cannot establish which processing it reaches. No prosecution, enforcement action or compliance count under it is recorded.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | No change          |
| Mozambique | <p>A <a href="#">Cyber Security Law</a> and a <a href="#">Cybercrime Law</a> were published on 1 July 2026 and come into force on 29 September, with <a href="#">regulations</a> due within 180 days.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Cyber Security Law was approved by the assembly in April 2026, promulgated in June and published on 1 July, creating a national incident response team seated in the ICT institute and, at articles 67 to 71, a Cyber Security Fund financed by a flat 1 per cent of licensed providers' prior-year gross revenue (<a href="#">law, approval</a>).</p> <p>The Cybercrime Law was published alongside it, providing for preservation and collection of digital evidence and for international cooperation, and repealing six penal-code articles in favour of its own offences (<a href="#">cybercrime law</a>).</p> <p>Neither set of implementing regulations had been made by August 2026, and the Cyber Security Fund's own operating rules are among what they are left to settle (<a href="#">regulations</a>).</p> | Advanced           |
| Namibia    | <p>A <a href="#">Cybercrime Bill</a> was named as being finalised in July 2026, with no draft published and no tabling date given.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Enforcement has relied on the electronic transactions statute, the communications statute and the penal code; cabinet approved cybercrime proposals in November 2025 (<a href="#">proposals</a>) and the minister named the bill as being finalised alongside the data protection bill in July 2026 (<a href="#">finalisation</a>).</p> <p>The base first names this bill in July 2026, and the national incident response team states in its own report that it cannot fully execute its mandate absent a cybersecurity law.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced, marginal |

| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS                                               |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Nigeria | <p>The <a href="#">Cybercrimes (Amendment) Act 2024</a> is in force, and lawyers argue enforcement agencies misapply it against dissent rather than cyber threats.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Civil-society lawyers argue the Act is misapplied against dissent, with most such cases collapsing because complainants never testify; the financial sector alone lost ₦53.4bn to cybercrime in 2024 (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>No prosecution, conviction or dismissal series under the Act is published, so the claim of misuse and the claim of necessity rest on the same absence of data.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | No change                                              |
| Rwanda  | <p>The <a href="#">2018 cybercrimes law</a> remains the core statute, and <a href="#">software security directives</a> were issued in April 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute in force since 2018 covers offences, service-provider duties, investigation powers and critical-infrastructure protection, and is named as operative by the current national cybersecurity strategy (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>The cyber authority issued application software security directives in April 2026, operationalising security by design across the development lifecycle for internet and intranet-accessible applications in public and private institutions (<a href="#">announcement</a>, <a href="#">directives</a>).</p> <p>Directives are subordinate instruments. The statute beneath them is eight years old and unamended.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Advanced                                               |
| Senegal | <p>A <a href="#">critical-infrastructure protection law</a> was adopted unanimously on 20 August 2026, and both the <a href="#">bill text</a> and the <a href="#">inter-commission report</a> on it are now held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The National Assembly adopted the bill on the protection of critical information infrastructure and digital security (<a href="#">adoption</a>). Adopted is not promulgated; the base holds no gazette text.</p> <p>The Assembly adopted the law unanimously (<a href="#">adoption</a>, <a href="#">detail</a>, <a href="#">safeguard</a>). Every provision reaching the base through the news accounts is the ministry's own description and the enacted text is not held; the base held nothing on this workstream at the window's start (<a href="#">cooperation</a>, <a href="#">security</a>, <a href="#">digital security</a>).</p> <p>The bill's own text and the parliamentary inter-commission report on it are both held, so the base can read the provisions and the committee's reading of them rather than the tabling alone (<a href="#">bill</a>, <a href="#">text</a>, <a href="#">hosting</a>, <a href="#">continuity</a>).</p> <p>During the debate the Assembly's first vice-president argued cybersecurity must become a standing administrative culture rather than a compliance exercise, calling for mandatory staff training and minimum device-security standards — an account of where the state's own practice stands rather than of what the law requires (<a href="#">culture</a>).</p> | Advanced                                               |
| Somalia | <p>The lower house <a href="#">approved a Cybersecurity Law</a> in January 2026, and the upper house <a href="#">took only a first reading</a> on 29 August 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The House of the People approved the law on 26 January 2026, assigning policy to the communications ministry, technical oversight to the regulator and obligations to critical-infrastructure operators (<a href="#">approval</a>, <a href="#">coverage</a>).</p> <p>The Upper House gave a six-chapter, 33-article cybersecurity bill its first reading on 29 August 2026, at the first sitting of its eighth term (<a href="#">first reading</a>). The chamber's own published procedure requires three readings before a bill passes it (<a href="#">procedure</a>).</p> <p>So the instrument is short of final approval, and nothing on file states whether the bill now before the upper house is the one the lower house approved in January. The country ranked in the international index's fifth tier at 37.39 of 100 in 2024 and is a signatory to the continental cyber convention (<a href="#">index</a>).</p> <p>The law's text is not held, and no implementing regulation, commencement date or enforcement action is on record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Advanced, and the law is not yet through both chambers |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | PROGRESS                                                                                                                         |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| South Africa | <p>The Cybercrimes Act is in force, the state <a href="#">signed the United Nations cybercrime convention in October 2025</a>, and a revised strategy awaits adoption.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">The Cybercrimes Act is the standing substantive statute</a>, held as an excerpt.</p> <p>2025-10-25 — <a href="#">the state signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime</a>, told to a G20 ministerial by the justice minister. No ratification step has followed.</p> <p>2026-05-22 — <a href="#">consultation on a revised National Cybersecurity Strategy is substantially complete with adoption expected in the following quarter</a>. No adopted text is on file, so the strategy is an expectation stated in a budget vote.</p> <p>Signature, a statute and a strategy in consultation is a fuller legislative position than most countries in this base hold, and none of the three is a report of enforcement: no prosecution count under the Act appears anywhere on this ledger.</p> | Advanced                                                                                                                         |
| South Sudan  | <p>A <a href="#">Cyber Crimes and Computer Abuse Act</a> was signed in February 2026, criminalising false information, online impersonation and hate speech alongside hacking, and the text is withheld.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The bill passed in November 2025 and was signed on 18 February 2026, with the ministry setting out its operation the following day (<a href="#">signature</a>, <a href="#">passage</a>, <a href="#">operation</a>, <a href="#">effect</a>).</p> <p>The speech offences and the withheld text are the objections on record. The country has no data-protection statute, no privacy commission and no incident response team, so the first computer-crime statute is also the first digital statute of any kind.</p> <p>Its text cannot be read because there is no operating gazette, which is recorded separately.</p>                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced                                                                                                                         |
| Sudan        | <p>A <a href="#">draft Cybersecurity Law</a> is in redrafting, and its relationship to the cybercrime provisions the country described to a regional experts' meeting is not established.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The draft is the second of the three-instrument package and was reported in redrafting in August 2026 (<a href="#">draft</a>, <a href="#">redrafting</a>).</p> <p>Its relationship to the cybercrime provisions the country separately described to an Arab experts' meeting in July 2026 is not established (<a href="#">meeting</a>).</p> <p>That matters because the cybercrime statute in force is being used against speech, and whether the new draft replaces, amends or sits alongside it is exactly what no source says.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced                                                                                                                         |
| Uganda       | <p>The Constitutional Court <a href="#">nullified five sections of the Computer Misuse Act</a> on quorum and vagueness grounds, and government <a href="#">declared telecom-infrastructure attacks economic sabotage</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The nullification covered sections 11, 23 and 26 to 29. The movement stem records an instrument neutralised; the rights reading is the opposite (<a href="#">nullification</a>).</p> <p>Vandalism against telecommunications infrastructure is now treated as economic sabotage, with a subscriber-card conviction obtained under the 2024 interception regulations rather than the Act (<a href="#">sabotage</a>, <a href="#">crackdown</a>).</p> <p>Which statute an offence is charged under is worth recording when the principal computer-crime Act has just lost five sections.</p>                                                                                                                                                                           | Mixed, five Computer Misuse Act sections nullified for vagueness while vandalism enforcement was stepped up as economic sabotage |

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Zambia</b>   | <p>The <a href="#">Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025</a> and the <a href="#">Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025</a> are both in force, and the investigatory and interception powers in them are court-gated.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The gazetted text of the security Act was acquired from the National Assembly's own directory; it commenced on 12 May 2025 by statutory instrument (<a href="#">Act, signature</a>).</p> <p>Enforcement of the crimes Act was declared fully operational in July 2026. The gazetted texts of both Acts are now held, and the investigatory powers in the crimes Act and the interception power in the security Act are both court-gated; the claim that the 2025 Acts authorise interception without prior judicial review is not borne out, while the presidential-control half of that claim is (<a href="#">enforcement, warning, compliance, freedom</a>).</p> <p>The Law Association was reported set to mount a challenge in April 2025; the single held source is a lede-only capture and the absence of any subsequent record is itself the finding (<a href="#">challenge</a>).</p>                                                                                                           | Mixed, two 2025 Acts in force with their investigatory powers court-gated while a threatened legal challenge has produced no record |
| <b>Zimbabwe</b> | <p>The <a href="#">Cyber and Data Protection Act</a> is unamended, cybercrime offences sit in the Criminal Law Code, and a national cybersecurity strategy was completed in October 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act of 2021 remains the principal statute, designating the telecommunications regulator as data protection authority and providing for a cyber security centre; it is unamended and administrative sanctions are still not provided for (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>The regulator's director-general stated on 24 January 2026 that Zimbabwe has no standalone cybercrime Act, and that hacking, unlawful acquisition of data and related offences sit in Part VIII of the Criminal Law (Codification and Reform) Act as amended in 2021, hacking carrying a fine or up to ten years' imprisonment (<a href="#">clarification</a>).</p> <p>The ICT ministry announced on 15 October 2025 that the National Cybersecurity Strategy had been completed, a day after Cabinet approved the artificial-intelligence strategy (<a href="#">strategy</a>). The same minister described a 2026-2030 strategy as still being finalised in July 2026, and no text is held at either date (<a href="#">July 2026</a>).</p> | Advanced                                                                                                                            |

## Legislation covering digital id

| COUNTRY        | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Algeria</b> | <p>A <a href="#">digital-identity and trust-services law</a> has been before the Assembly since 2 November 2025; no promulgation is held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law did not exist at the window's opening. It was <a href="#">approved by the Council of Ministers on 2 November 2025 and is before the National Assembly, reported in the biometrics press, in the state daily and as a digital-trust and electronic-transactions measure</a>. No promulgation or gazette reference is held as at 2026-08-03.</p> <p>Meanwhile a unified national digital identity is already issued and in use as a single credential across the government services portal, so the credential is running nine months ahead of the statute that would govern it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Advanced |
| <b>Angola</b>  | <p>The Council of Ministers <a href="#">approved a civil and criminal identification bill in April 2026</a>, which would set the country's first dedicated identity-data regime.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-04-29 — the Council of Ministers <a href="#">approved a bill making the identity card the only valid document for banking, telecoms, school enrolment, property registration and contracts, and establishing the country's first dedicated regime for processing identity data</a>. Voter cards, driving licences and passports are currently accepted as substitutes.</p> <p>No parliamentary stage has been recorded since. Two other instruments touch the same ground and neither is this one: <a href="#">an electoral registration law replacing in-person enrolment with automatic enrolment from the civil identity database</a>, which reaches the base only through a secondary account with no gazette reference, and the data protection law reported above, which is the general regime the identity-specific one would sit beside.</p> | Advanced |

| COUNTRY                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS                                                             |
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| Benin                    | <p>The 2017 identification law is the statutory base for the identifier and the agency, extended in June 2025 to foreigners and Afro-descendants.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The 2017 law is the statutory base for the identification of natural persons, creating the identification agency and the unique personal identifier. It is held as the text layer of a scan, so quotation from it is unsafe.</p> <p>2025-06-23 — law 2025-12 creates a residents file with distinct foreigner and Afro-descendant identifiers, for migration control and civic inclusion. Nothing of the kind existed before it, and it is the only amendment to the identity statute in the window.</p> <p>The instrument the estate still lacks is a rule on what may be asked of the register: the data protection authority's intervention on the electoral roll, reported under data protection, was a regulator settling by decision a question no statute answers.</p> | Advanced                                                             |
| Botswana                 | <p>Section 14 of the Digital Services Act provides for online unique identification, and the amending registration Act commenced in November 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-10-17 — the Digital Services Act was assented, its section 14 providing for online unique identification.</p> <p>2026-02-24 — the ministry confirmed the National Registration (Amendment) Act No. 7 of 2025 commenced in November 2025, and reported a digital-ID roadmap facilitated by the African Development Bank due at the end of March 2026.</p> <p>No commencement notice for the Digital Services Act itself is held, and no roadmap document.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Advanced                                                             |
| Burundi                  | <p>A ministerial ordinance made identity-card registration of every SIM compulsory from 25 June 2026, while the identification file itself still awaits instituting texts.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-06 — the regulator required every subscriber to regularise SIM identification against the national identity card, with non-compliant lines deactivated from 25 June 2026, under a ministerial ordinance of 13 January 2026. It is the first instrument on the ledger to make the national identity card a condition of holding a service.</p> <p>Underneath it the register is not yet constituted: the official procedure page for the Fichier National d'Identification states that further texts remain to be adopted to institute the file. An obligation to identify against a register precedes the instrument establishing the register.</p>                                                                                             | Advanced                                                             |
| Cameroon                 | <p>Decret n. 2025/059 on identity titles and the 2024 civil-registration law are both in force and unamended.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The decree was signed on 28 February 2025 governing five identity-title classes and is in force, unamended; its refugee and disability chapters are not captured in the base.</p> <p>The civil-registration law was enacted on 23 December 2024 in 130 sections, providing for electronic declaration, a national database, digital certificates and a unique personal identification number, and is also unamended. Its text is not held, so what the unique personal identification number obliges, and how it relates to the biometric card, is not checkable from anything on file.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | No change                                                            |
| Central African Republic | <p>Government terms of reference scope legal reform covering civil status with digital identification; no such law is held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The terms of reference cover personal data, cybersecurity, electronic communications and civil status with digital identification. Two of the instruments they scope were made in early 2024 - the data protection law and the cybersecurity law - and nothing records the identification leg being drafted.</p> <p>What exists instead is an obligation without a statute behind it on the record: the unique identification number is recorded as made mandatory in a budget-support completion report, with no instrument named.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | No change, a first stated position with no earlier account behind it |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS                                                                                    |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Comoros       | <p>The biometric identity card is <a href="#">instituted by loi n 14-023/AU, promulgated by decret n 14-137/PR</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The justice ministry's legislation index <a href="#">carries the promulgating decree and a download link to the law instituting the digital, biometric Comorian identity card</a>. This is the first record in the base of a statute behind the card, which until now stood on procurement and operational accounts alone.</p> <p>The index dates the decree to 28 August 2024 while numbering it in the 2014 series and dating the law it promulgates to 24 June 2014. The decree's own text is not held, so the discrepancy is reported here rather than settled.</p> <p>What the statute requires - enrolment duties, the data it may hold, who may read it - is not on file, so nothing here says what the card's legal basis actually obliges.</p>                                                | No change, a first record of the promulgating decree with the law's own text still not held |
| Cote d'Ivoire | <p>The only identification instrument on file is <a href="#">decret n 2017-193 on subscriber identification</a>; no foundational digital-identity statute is held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The decree was <a href="#">made on 22 March 2017 and requires identification of subscribers to public telecommunications and information-technology services and of cybercafe users</a>. Nothing in the window touched it.</p> <p>It is not a digital-identity law. The national biometric register, the identification number and the credentials issued against them run throughout this report, and the base holds no statute, ordinance or decree establishing any of them, setting who may query the register, or stating what a holder may refuse. That absence sits under every identity row here.</p>                                                                                                                                           | No change                                                                                   |
| Djibouti      | <p>Identification is governed by a <a href="#">2019 law creating the register of natural persons and the national identification number</a>, unchanged in the period.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The founding law <a href="#">makes the Registre National des Personnes Physiques the unique reference for identifying individuals and for producing every secure national document - identity card, passport, voter card, driving licence - with administrative management at the population directorate and technical and security management at the state information-systems agency</a>.</p> <p>Its implementing decree defines the identification number as a digital instrument combining civil-status and personal data, and makes its use compulsory across public, parapublic and private administration for identification and third-party data exchange.</p> <p>Nothing amended either in the period; what moved is what runs on them.</p> | No change                                                                                   |
| DR Congo      | <p>A <a href="#">bill on the identification of natural persons was tabled at the National Assembly bureau on 12 June 2026</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-06-12 - the bill was <a href="#">tabled: it would set one legal frame for identification data and its collection, processing, retention and protection, impose security and interoperability requirements, and connect civil-registry, migration and health databases</a>. No committee report or plenary date is held.</p> <p>It runs alongside rather than through the twenty-year identity concession already signed, and nothing on file connects the two. A statutory frame arriving after the platform it would govern is the sequence here, and no source states which would prevail on retention, access or foreign processing.</p>                                                                                                                                            | Advanced                                                                                    |

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS                                                             |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Egypt</b>    | <p>A member's proposal for a biometric national identity card for children from age five was discussed at two workshops; no bill is tabled.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Nothing of the kind was on record at the window's opening. A member's proposal for a national identity card for children carrying a photograph from age five, requiring amendment of the Child Law, was discussed at two workshops, with recommendations including a unified national child-data platform, a full biometric identification system for children, and linkage between health, education and other government databases. Participants also recommended a strict legal framework for protecting the resulting data.</p> <p>No bill has been tabled. The country's identity layer - a digital identity app, a financial identity system, a biometric authentication pilot and facial verification at mobile-line enrolment - all now operates with no statute of its own, and the only identity legislation on the record is a proposal to extend it to children.</p>                                                                                | Advanced                                                             |
| <b>Eritrea</b>  | <p>No digital-identity statute exists; the closest instrument is the 1992 nationality proclamation (<a href="#">proclamation</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>No dedicated digital-identity statute was located. The closest identifiable legal instrument is the Nationality Proclamation 21/1992, still in force, which provides the legal basis for nationality certification through the Department of Internal Affairs and contains no digital-identity, electronic-identity, biometric or electronic-transactions framework (<a href="#">proclamation</a>).</p> <p>Identity cards are nonetheless required by other systems: anti-money-laundering law obliges financial institutions to identify every customer (<a href="#">proclamation</a>), and a national identity card is required before a passport is issued (<a href="#">country guidance</a>).</p> <p>So the card carries statutory weight without a statute defining it, and nothing regulates what data it holds or who may read it.</p>                                                                                                                            | No change                                                            |
| <b>Eswatini</b> | <p>Identity rests on the <a href="#">Identification Order of 1998</a>; no digital identity Act exists, and three conventions went to senators for ratification in July 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The King's Order in Council of 1998 establishes the population register and the personal identity number, and is the founding legal instrument behind national identity; no dedicated digital-identity Act is held (<a href="#">Order</a>).</p> <p>The ICT minister presented the African Union Malabo Convention on cyber security and personal data protection, the Budapest Convention on cybercrime and the Tampere Convention to senators for ratification on 10 July 2026 (<a href="#">workshop</a>).</p> <p>SADC ICT ministers had urged member states to consider ratifying Malabo in September 2019 (<a href="#">ministerial</a>). Seven years later it is at the presentation stage.</p> <p>The digital identity itself remains planned under the Digital Eswatini project, with no legal basis on file for it.</p>                                                                                                  | Advanced, on treaty ratification rather than on any identity statute |
| <b>Ethiopia</b> | <p>The 2023 identification proclamation became a binding operational requirement across banking, with migration to the new verification service mandated (<a href="#">decision</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The central bank and the national identity programme began harmonising all bank customer account numbers with the national digital identity, mandating migration from the first to the second verification service for all new and existing accounts with a deadline of 30 March 2026 (<a href="#">decision</a>).</p> <p>The government stated in December 2025 that 30 million citizens had been registered and that the identity had been carried into Digital Ethiopia 2030 with integration planned down to the lowest administrative levels (<a href="#">statement</a>).</p> <p>The statute itself was not amended in the window; what moved is the weight placed on it (<a href="#">Digital Identification Proclamation 1284/2023</a>).</p> <p>The base holds no statutory limit on state access to identity data and no redress route for a registrant, which is carried separately as a not-held position.</p> | Advanced                                                             |

| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS  |
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| Gabon   | <p>The identity framework <a href="#">rests on two named texts</a>, a law on the personal identification number and one on the civil registry centre, neither with a date.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Both texts are named as the legal basis of the national digital identity system, with no adoption, promulgation or gazette date for either (<a href="#">framework</a>).</p> <p>They were named again in the stocktake of legal identity projects, which lists three separate systems resting on them (<a href="#">legal identity stocktake</a>).</p> <p>Neither text has a number, date or gazette reference on file, so the identity card, the biometric register and the digital identity system all operate on a basis the base cannot read.</p>                                                                                                                                         | No change |
| Gambia  | <p>The <a href="#">digital identity strategy for 2023 to 2028</a> is in force and now carries a delivered system, with no statute governing it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The strategy was validated at a supported workshop in May 2024 and provided for a system that has since been built (<a href="#">validation, strategy</a>).</p> <p>What the base does not hold is the legal basis for issuing identity cards outside the country, which the opposition alleged was unlawful in August 2025 for issuance in Mauritania, Congo and Togo; no official response, regulation or registry statement has followed (<a href="#">allegation</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | No change |
| Ghana   | <p><a href="#">Amendment regulations in force from June 2026</a> make biometric-only verification law and bar visual inspection and photocopying of the card.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The regulations were signed on 2 March 2026, gazetted on 27 March and came into force on 9 June, with penalties running to 2,000 penalty units for an organisation (<a href="#">regulations</a>); the gazetted artefact is an image scan with no text layer, so the regulation is not machine-readable (<a href="#">regulations, agency statement</a>).</p> <p>A fee schedule made under separate 2025 regulations took effect on 2 February 2026: first registration free below 25 and GH¢30 at 25 and over, replacement GH¢200 and record updates free, across 276 district offices, the agency stating it was approved by Parliament rather than introduced by the agency (<a href="#">fees</a>).</p> | Advanced  |
| Kenya   | <p>The High Court recognised a <a href="#">registered phone number as a personal digital identifier</a> and gave the Attorney-General six months to legislate.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The judgment also bars recycling of dormant numbers without consent; the window was still open as at 12 August 2026 with nothing tabled and closes about September (<a href="#">judgment</a>).</p> <p>Analysis of it argues the judgment should produce a coordinated number-recycling policy binding banks, savings societies and platforms that keep relying on numbers after reassignment (<a href="#">analysis</a>).</p> <p>It is the only instrument in the base that defines a digital identifier in law, and it arrived through litigation rather than through Parliament.</p>                                                                                                                   | Advanced  |
| Lesotho | <p>The <a href="#">National Identity Cards Act 2011 is the founding statute</a>; an electoral Bill now ties voter registration to the identity number.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2011-03-21 — <a href="#">Act 9 of 2011 establishes the National Identity Register and the identity-card regime</a>, commenced in 2013.</p> <p>2026-06-04 — <a href="#">the Senate adopted its legislation committee's report on the electoral amendment Bill, which ties voter registration and verification to the national identity number</a>.</p> <p>2026-06-29 — <a href="#">the home affairs ministry opened a workshop on a systems architecture and modernisation framework, setting out the legal and institutional implications of the reforms proposed</a>.</p> <p>No amendment to the 2011 Act is before Parliament.</p>                                                                            | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS                                                                                        |
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| Madagascar | <p>Two identification laws cleared constitutional review inside the window: the <a href="#">founding 2025 law</a> and a 2026 special birth-registration law.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Constitutional Court declared the law on identification of natural persons constitutional in August 2025, after adoption by the National Assembly on 3 July and the Senate on 4 July (<a href="#">decision</a>).</p> <p>A second law, for derogatory registration of adults without birth certificates, was adopted on 21 April 2026 (<a href="#">adoption</a>) and cleared for promulgation on 13 May 2026 (<a href="#">decision</a>).</p> <p>Enrolment under the framework opened in January 2026 (<a href="#">launch</a>). Neither promulgated text is held; the base carries the Court's decisions on them.</p>                                                                                                                                            | Advanced                                                                                        |
| Malawi     | <p>The <a href="#">National Registration Act is under review</a> and <a href="#">registration service fees were raised</a> by regulations gazetted in July 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A consultative meeting under the acceleration project reviewed the registration Act and the marriage and family relations statute, the bureau stating the aim is a modern and secure civil registration and identification system; no bill, draft or timetable is on record (<a href="#">review</a>).</p> <p>Amendment regulations gazetted on 31 July 2026 raised fees for identity card replacement, electronic know-your-customer verification, civil registration and marriage services; the individual levels and their previous values are not carried in the record held, so the size of the increase is not established, and the electronic verification charge is a charge on third parties for using the identity system (<a href="#">fees</a>).</p> | Advanced                                                                                        |
| Mauritius  | <p>The <a href="#">1985 identity card Act</a> carries the digital card through 2024 regulations, with the 2026 Finance Act amending around it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act has been in force since April 1986 and is the statutory basis for the card (<a href="#">Act</a>); the regulations of February 2024 set the terms on which the card and the mobile identity are issued and read (<a href="#">regulations</a>).</p> <p>The Finance Act 2026, assented in August, carries the statutory changes behind the budget's identity and registry measures (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>The Electronic Transactions (Amendment) Act 2026 was enacted in May (<a href="#">Act</a>). A forty-year-old card statute is doing the work, extended by regulation rather than replaced.</p>                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced                                                                                        |
| Morocco    | <p><a href="#">Law 72-18</a> creates the population and social registries, the civil and social digital identifier and the register agency, deferring force to implementing texts.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute was promulgated by dahir in August 2020 and creates the national population register, the unified social register, the civil and social digital identifier and the national register agency (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>Articles 19 and 22 carve out defence and security processing, and article 45 defers force to implementing texts. The base holds no implementing decree, so the identifier's legal operation cannot be established from the statute alone.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Advanced                                                                                        |
| Mozambique | <p>The digital certification framework is unamended; the ICT institute <a href="#">signed a memorandum with Brazil on digital certification on 13 February 2026</a> covering the root certification authority behind it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-02-13 — the national ICT institute <a href="#">signed a memorandum with Brazil's information technology institute to cooperate on digital certification, digital-identity technologies and the root certification authority</a> underpinning the national digital certification system.</p> <p>The law behind it did not move: that system rests on a 2019 decree under a 2017 statute, and neither was amended in the window. A memorandum is a cooperation instrument, not a legal one, and no term, budget or deliverable is published for it.</p>                                                                                                                                             | No change, the 2017 and 2019 instruments stand and the movement was cooperation rather than law |

| COUNTRY               | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | PROGRESS  |
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| Namibia               | <p>The <a href="#">Civil Registration and Identification Act 13 of 2024</a> is the statutory basis for a single civil register and a unique identity number, and a <a href="#">gazette notice withdrawing older documents</a> has not issued.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act was assented in December 2024 as the basis for a single civil register, a unique identity number and identity-data confidentiality, and was read by officials in July 2026 as permitting institutions to accept either the physical card or its digital version, with disclosure conditional on the holder's consent; the commencement date is not established in this base (<a href="#">Act, reading</a>).</p> <p>The notice that will end the validity of pre-independence cards, older documents and current machine-readable cards has not issued, so until it does the September 2026 card is additive rather than replacing anything (<a href="#">notice</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Advanced  |
| Niger                 | <p>An <a href="#">ordonnance of April 2026 with its application decree</a> replaced the civil-status regime, and a <a href="#">National Nationality Register</a> was instituted under the justice ministry.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The ordonnance of 22 April 2026 and its application decree of 18 May are in force, and no gazetted text is held (<a href="#">ordonnance</a>).</p> <p>The same ordonnance institutes a national nationality register under the justice ministry (<a href="#">register</a>). Between them the civil, nationality and population registers are set up by one instrument, which is a cleaner legal basis than most units in this base have and is not yet matched by an operating system.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Advanced  |
| Nigeria               | <p>The <a href="#">NIMC Act 2026</a> makes the identity number the foundational credential, and a <a href="#">legal reading</a> puts mandatory use across passports, banking, telecommunications and land dealings.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act replaces the 2007 statute, recognises the identity number as the foundational credential under a one-person-one-identity policy, incorporates the data-protection regime and lets the commission prosecute identity fraud; the gazetted text was still not publicly available about six weeks after assent, so neither the expansion reading nor the counter-reading can be checked against it (<a href="#">Act, transformation, analysis</a>).</p> <p>On a law firm's reading the commission becomes the root certification authority for a national public key infrastructure and the national biometric-data repository, use of the number is made mandatory across four named sectors, the Act states that proof of identity is not proof of eligibility or citizenship, and unauthorised database access carries penalties of at least NGN10m or five years for an individual (<a href="#">reading</a>).</p> | Advanced  |
| Rwanda                | <p>A <a href="#">single digital identification law</a> writes a June 2027 sunset of all legacy documents into statute, and the law's number and enactment date are not held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The sunset is written into the law rather than set by administrative decision, which is what makes the enrolment count a legal deadline rather than a target (<a href="#">deadline, enrolment</a>).</p> <p>The law's number and enactment date are not held, so the base cannot say what it provides on correction, appeal or exclusion for anyone unenrolled when legacy documents cease to be valid.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Advanced  |
| Sao Tome and Principe | <p>An <a href="#">aggregated identification document law</a> was flagged as urgent by a lender mission in 2025, its absence stated as a potential constraint on data collection, and no later source confirms passage.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The mission flagged review, public consultation, finalisation and approval as urgent (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>A year later nothing records movement. The foundational digital identity it would govern has live prototypes and a system integrator engaged, so the build is running ahead of the statute — the same order this frame finds in most units.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | No change |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS                                                                   |
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| Senegal      | <p>A <a href="#">bill on computerising civil-status management</a> remains listed among outstanding steps, validated but not enacted, and the register-reconstitution decree is likewise unsigned.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The bill appears among outstanding steps in the agency's own August 2025 presentation and again in the June 2026 programme closing report (<a href="#">bill</a>, <a href="#">closure</a>).</p> <p>Validated is not enacted. The digitisation programme it would govern has meanwhile closed its external financing, deployed software across most centres and loaded millions of records, so the legal basis trails the system by a wide margin.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change                                                                  |
| Sierra Leone | <p><a href="#">Subscribers Regulations 2025</a> began a phase-out of unregistered subscriber cards, and government <a href="#">conceded the identity linkage is incomplete</a> in a ministerial statement.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The phase-out was announced on 30 July 2026, linking registration to the national identification number. The instrument's own text is not held and does not appear in the regulator's public register (<a href="#">regulations</a>).</p> <p>Government conceded on 4 August 2026 that the linkage is incomplete (<a href="#">linkage</a>, <a href="#">phase-out</a>).</p> <p>That concession matters because the fraud response recorded elsewhere rests on registration and identity verification as its principal control, and the control is admitted to be partial.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Advanced                                                                   |
| Somalia      | <p>The <a href="#">2023 identity law</a> gained its <a href="#">implementing regulation</a> in June 2024, and a <a href="#">civil status law</a> followed in April 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Law No. 009 of March 2023 is the founding statute for the identity authority and the national digital identity system (<a href="#">law</a>). Its implementing regulation was made by the Prime Minister on 8 June 2024 and gazetted that October (<a href="#">regulation</a>).</p> <p>Law No. 46, published 5 April 2026, adds the civil-registration and vital-statistics layer beside the identity infrastructure (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>The base now holds all three primary texts. What it does not hold is any provision setting out how the identity system and the civil register are to be joined.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced                                                                   |
| South Africa | <p>Draft identification regulations were <a href="#">gazetted on 4 May 2026</a> and consulted to 6 June, while the <a href="#">National Identification and Registration Bill is still before Parliament</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-05-04 — draft amendments to the Identification Regulations were <a href="#">gazetted</a>, with a 33-day comment period closing on 6 June 2026. They would create <a href="#">voluntary digital-ID credentials with legal parity to the physical document</a>, grant accredited trusted entities API access to the population register under data-sharing agreements, and set three assurance levels, seven-year audit logs and private-sector enrolment points, with finalisation dated September 2026.</p> <p>The primary legislation has not kept pace. The <a href="#">National Identification and Registration Bill remains before Parliament</a>, named as the statutory foundation the regulations should rest on, and the record does not say whether its passage is now a precondition. A submission on the closing day asked the department to suspend the regulations pending that Bill, a published digital identity policy and demonstrated compliance with the data protection Act, on the ground that a biometric enrolment and real-time verification system is being built with no formal role for the Information Regulator. That submission is held as a supplied document with no published address, so it cannot be linked here.</p> | Advanced, the regulations moved ahead of the Bill they are said to rest on |

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS                                                                            |
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| <b>Sudan</b>    | <p>The <a href="#">Electronic Transactions Act 2007</a> and the <a href="#">Civil Registry Act 2011</a> carry the digital identity; two later instruments it cites are not held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The 2007 Act covers digital signatures, electronic authentication and certification, and establishes an electronic licensing committee (<a href="#">Act</a>). The 2011 Act founds the civil registry and its unique national number, and requires the registry to supply data to competent state organs (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>The national digital identity's terms, published 21 May 2026, cite both, plus a digital identity regulation of 2025 and a cybersecurity act of 2025 (<a href="#">terms</a>).</p> <p>Neither 2025 instrument could be located as an independently accessible text, so the legal basis a reader can check stops at 2011.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced                                                                            |
| <b>Togo</b>     | <p>A <a href="#">review of the 2009 civil registration law</a> held its scoping meeting, with proposals due before the end of 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The scoping meeting was held in August 2026 (<a href="#">review</a>).</p> <p>It is the statute under which the birth-registration catch-up campaigns and the online certificate pilot operate, and the review is the first movement on it the base holds. No draft or proposal is on record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Advanced                                                                            |
| <b>Tunisia</b>  | <p><a href="#">Organic laws on biometric identity</a> were adopted in March 2024, and civil society records that committee deliberations lacked public consultation.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The laws were adopted by parliament on 6 March 2024, with use of the biometric card and passport targeted for the first half of 2025 (<a href="#">laws</a>, <a href="#">usage</a>, <a href="#">rollout</a>).</p> <p>The consultation criticism is an attributed position rather than a finding of this report.</p> <p>Two and a half years on, whether issuance has begun is recorded separately as not established — so the enabling statutes are in force and their effect is unmeasured.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | No change                                                                           |
| <b>Zambia</b>   | <p>A <a href="#">statutory instrument amended the citizenship regulations</a> while the registration department <a href="#">began computerising document issuance</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-12-31 — <a href="#">Statutory Instrument No. 98 of 2025 amended the citizenship regulations</a>, the clearest in-window regulatory movement touching national identity documents.</p> <p>2025-08 — <a href="#">the home affairs permanent secretary announced that the registration department has begun computerising national registration card, passport and citizenship-document issuance with the state technology institute, targeting online applications including from the diaspora</a>.</p> <p>The instruments governing identity are being amended at the edges while the system beneath them is rebuilt; no consolidated digital identity statute is held, and the new register's legal basis remains the National Registration Act.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                | Advanced                                                                            |
| <b>Zimbabwe</b> | <p>No digital-identity Act is held. Identity rests on the <a href="#">National Registration Act</a>, and a 2026 constitutional amendment moved the voters' roll to the registrar-general.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The National Registration Act, commenced in 1976 and consolidated to 31 December 2016, is the statute under which the register of residents and the issue of identity documents sit (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>Constitution of Zimbabwe Amendment (No. 3) Act, Act No. 6 of 2026, amends the Constitution to assign the registrar-general responsibility for voter registration and custody of the voters' roll, consolidating electoral identity under the national identity authority (<a href="#">amendment</a>).</p> <p>The commissioning of the Mutare provincial registry office for biometric passport and identity services was described by the registrar-general as foundational to a digital identity system (<a href="#">registry office</a>).</p> <p>There is no electronic-identity or digital-identity Act, and no legal basis on file for the national digital identity that remains announced and unlaunched.</p> | Advanced, on a constitutional amendment rather than on any digital-identity statute |

## Digital payments legislation

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Algeria  | <p>A <a href="#">first regulation dedicated to payment service providers</a> was followed by one <a href="#">bringing them inside the anti-money-laundering regime</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The umbrella statute is the monetary and banking law of June 2023, whose article 166 repealed the prior ordinance.</p> <p>2025-04-14 - the first Algerian regulatory instrument specifically dedicated to payment service providers was adopted by the central bank.</p> <p>2025-09-24 - a second regulation explicitly brings payment service providers inside the anti-money-laundering regime, and in November the banking commission issued guidelines on virtual assets. No licence granted under the provider regime is recorded.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Advanced |
| Botswana | <p>Electronic payment regulations were amended in April 2026, extending scope to value transfer services and reaching beneficial owners, with unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-04-02 – amended regulations came into effect extending scope to money or value transfer services, taking fit-and-proper tests down to beneficial owners and 10% shareholders, and making unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years, with the central bank's implementation release in July. Float interest is ring-fenced and directed by the central bank, and financial-inclusion promotion was dropped from the permitted uses without being replaced by any customer entitlement – which is the change a wallet holder would notice if anyone told them.</p> <p>The virtual-asset regime is unchanged and still criticised: the Act is in force with crypto not legal tender, and a regional follow-up assessment in February 2026 still records provider-oversight shortcomings.</p>                           | Advanced |
| Burundi  | <p>The 2018 payment-systems statute <a href="#">is the framework law</a>; the central bank has since published an <a href="#">oversight framework</a> and <a href="#">launched a national instant payment system</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Loi n 1/07 du 11 mai 2018 portant systeme national de paiement is the framework statute, and the law the central bank cites for its power to regulate the issue and use of payment instruments; its articles 22 to 24 carry the move of payment instruments off paper and the admissibility of electronic and optical evidence. Every official copy located is an image-only scan.</p> <p>The central bank has published an oversight framework covering the real-time gross settlement system, the clearing house, the central securities depository, the national switch, instant payment systems and electronic money platforms, with a licensing, monitoring, inspection and sanction regime for payment service providers, and in April 2026 launched the national instant payment system under a regulation of its own.</p> | Advanced |
| Comoros  | <p>The 2026 finance law puts electronic filing and payment of taxes on a statutory footing, above a 2017 electronic-money regulation.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The standing instrument is the central bank's <a href="#">regulation on electronic-money activity</a>, setting the conditions and modalities for carrying it on, on the authority of the 2013 banking law, the 2012 anti-money-laundering law and the 2015 payment-systems decree.</p> <p>2025-12 - the finance law <a href="#">inserted a new section into the fiscal-procedures code</a> establishing <a href="#">teledclaration and telepayment</a>, with a phased obligation on large and medium taxpayers, the legal value of an electronic filing, authentication, archiving and penalties for not using it, implementation dates left to regulation.</p> <p>2026-04 - the tax directorate <a href="#">opened a three-day workshop to validate that legal framework</a>, which places the implementing texts still in draft four months after the statute.</p>                                              | Advanced |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | PROGRESS                                                |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Congo         | <p>An order of 22 May 2026 makes all public revenue payable exclusively through one national platform, with payment outside it void.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The order was signed on 22 May 2026 and gazetted on 11 June with a 60-day conformity window: all public revenue is payable exclusively through one national platform, defined in the text as a national and sovereign payments switch, payment outside it is void and non-discharging, and administrations must suppress every parallel circuit.</p> <p>Derogations are limited to technical unavailability, absence of access to electronic means, or duly established exceptional circumstances. It is the most categorical digital-payments instrument on this ledger, and it obliges the state rather than the market.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Advanced                                                |
| Cote d'Ivoire | <p>A <a href="#">banking regulation bill</a> adopted in April 2026 would bring financial technology firms and electronic money into the national banking perimeter.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-04-29 - the Council of Ministers adopted a bill aligning national law with the monetary union's uniform banking law, bringing financial technology firms and new operations such as electronic money - which the communique states are not covered by current legislation - into the national banking perimeter; a second bill reforming microfinance regulation was adopted at the same sitting.</p> <p>Both are government-adopted bills. No parliamentary passage, promulgation or entry into force is held for either, and the communique states no date by which either is expected. The regional instruments the bill aligns to are already directly applicable, so what the bill adds is national enforcement rather than the rule itself.</p>                                                                                                            | Advanced, a bill adopted in council and not yet enacted |
| Djibouti      | <p>Payments are governed by a <a href="#">2016 law placing every payment service under central-bank licensing and supervision</a>, unchanged in the period.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law applies to every payment service and system operated in the country, empowers the central bank to license, regulate and supervise payment-system providers, and defines electronic money and electronic funds transfer.</p> <p>Beneath it the central bank acts by instruction rather than by statute: from <a href="#">31 August 2025</a> all cheques had to meet new format, security and encoding standards, with non-conforming cheques refused by the settlement platform and legacy stock withdrawn, a measure that took effect a day before this period opened.</p> <p>No amendment, and no implementing text on electronic money issued in the period, is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                           | No change                                               |
| Egypt         | <p>The central bank approved <a href="#">regulations for a digital financial identity platform</a> and the financial regulator <a href="#">admitted two projects to its sandbox</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-09 - the central bank issued <a href="#">regulations on governance, internal control and fit-and-proper criteria for key officials of payment system operators and payment service providers</a> - the conduct rules beneath the payments market.</p> <p>2026-08-23 - its board <a href="#">approved the regulations governing the digital financial identity platform for identifying bank customers and verifying their identities electronically</a>, which is the rule that lets an account be opened without a counter.</p> <p>2026-09-01 - the financial regulator <a href="#">granted preliminary approval for two further technology projects to enter its regulatory sandbox</a>.</p> <p>No licence issued under the payment-institution rules, and no count of customers identified through the platform, appears on this ledger.</p> | Advanced                                                |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS                                                                                   |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Eritrea  | <p>A regional peer assessment records a state-owned financial system with no cash machines, cards or internet banking (<a href="#">evaluation</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A regional anti-money-laundering peer assessment, adopted in July 2025 after an on-site visit in 2024, states that Eritrea's financial system is state-owned and offers simple and less sophisticated services, with no automatic teller machines, debit or credit cards, or internet banking (<a href="#">evaluation</a>).</p> <p>There is therefore nothing for payments legislation to regulate, and the base holds no payment systems act, no e-money regulation and no licensing regime. The only draft text addressing digital finance is an unofficial consultation draft (<a href="#">drafts</a>).</p> <p>The one instrument on the ledger is a central bank legal notice ordering cash deposits, which is currency management rather than payments law.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | No change                                                                                  |
| Eswatini | <p>The <a href="#">National Payments System Act 2023</a> is in force, regulations to operationalise it were approved by Cabinet in July 2026, and the fast-payments platform completed onboarding in November 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act of 2023 provides for the regulation and supervision of payment systems, the safety and efficiency of the national payments system and the central bank's functions in relation to them (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>Cabinet approved National Payment Systems Regulations of 2026 in the first quarter of 2026/27 to operationalise it; no gazette text, publication or commencement date is held (<a href="#">Cabinet</a>).</p> <p>The central bank governor told a regional report launch on 13 November 2025 that the eighth and final participant would go live on the fast-payments platform two days later (<a href="#">remarks</a>).</p> <p>The statute is the enablement and the switch is the delivery; the regulations between them are approved and unpublished.</p>                                                                                                                                                                   | Advanced                                                                                   |
| Ethiopia | <p>The central bank widened its <a href="#">virtual-asset prohibition</a> to the whole category, and a court <a href="#">struck down a decree</a> revoking licences without a court order.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A central-bank public notice of 23 July 2026 widened the prohibition by clarification rather than by new rule, covering use, purchase, sale, exchange, transfer, trading, settlement and facilitation absent express authorisation, with no new regulation and no enforcement mechanism announced (<a href="#">public notice</a>).</p> <p>The Federal High Court of Lideta struck down a December 2025 lottery-administration decree that had cut banking services to betting platforms and gateways, holding revocation of a licence without a court order unconstitutional (<a href="#">the ruling</a>).</p> <p>No payments proclamation or electronic transactions statute is held, so the operative law reaches the base as directives, notices and one judgment.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Mixed, the central bank widened a prohibition by notice while a court struck down a decree |
| Ghana    | <p>The <a href="#">Virtual Asset Service Providers Act 2025</a> passed in December 2025, and a digital banking framework is complete and awaiting consultation.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Before it there was no statute, against more than 3 million virtual-asset users and over 100 service providers recorded in a July 2025 registration exercise, with regulated institutions directed not to facilitate virtual-asset activity at all (<a href="#">policy position</a>).</p> <p>On the regulator's account the Act is risk-based and technology-neutral, splits supervision between the central bank and the securities regulator by activity, attaches licensing to the service rather than to holding, excludes virtual assets from deposit protection and from invoicing, pricing and wages, and provides transition arrangements; the licensing requirements are still being built (<a href="#">the Act, questions answered</a>).</p> <p>The gazetted text is not held, so every characterisation is the central bank's own. A digital banking framework with comprehensive draft guidelines is complete and awaiting stakeholder consultation, with no date (<a href="#">framework</a>).</p> | Advanced                                                                                   |

| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS  |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Guinea  | <p>There is <a href="#">no payments statute</a>, and the national payment council that would sit under one is at terms-of-reference stage.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Both the payments law and the council are at terms-of-reference stage under the donor programme, the law awaiting the lender's no-objection; the position comes from the central bank's own project register, which is undated and whose latest dated entry is January 2025 (<a href="#">project register</a>).</p> <p>On virtual assets the central bank issued a warning rather than a regime: it states it has granted no licence or authorisation to any entity for crypto-asset trading or online financial placement, sets out seven warning signs of fraudulent offers, notes that registration with a foreign authority is not a domestic licence, and reserves the right to refer illegal fund collection, money laundering and fraud to the courts (<a href="#">communiqué</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | No change |
| Kenya   | <p><a href="#">Virtual asset regulations were gazetted</a> in July 2026 with joint licensing across ten categories, and existing operators have until November to transition.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The 2025 Act commenced on 4 November 2025, giving pre-existing operators a year to comply (<a href="#">the Act</a>).</p> <p>The regulations set capital by licence class from KES 300m for stablecoin issuance to nil for advisers, with a seizure and freezing framework; the draft ownership cap was dropped between draft and gazette, and the Finance Bill replaces a proposed 3 per cent transfer tax with a 10 per cent excise duty on provider fees (<a href="#">regulations</a>, <a href="#">compliance cost</a>).</p> <p>Six named exchanges have said they intend to apply, and the regulators had not announced the application process as at 7 August 2026 (<a href="#">applicants</a>).</p> <p>On mobile money the position is different in kind: the central bank's pricing principles operate through voluntary operator alignment, with no gazetted tariff rule or determination to cite, appeal or extend to a competitor, reversible at the operator's discretion (<a href="#">pricing principles</a>).</p> | Advanced  |
| Lesotho | <p>The <a href="#">Payment System Bill reached second reading in May 2026</a>, to replace the 2014 Act and license fintech providers.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2014-09-12 — <a href="#">the Payment Systems Act governs payment systems and instruments, electronic money and cards among them</a>.</p> <p>2025-11-17 — <a href="#">the financial sector strategy sets strengthening the payments system and access to digital financial services as cross-cutting priorities</a>.</p> <p>2026-05-05 — <a href="#">the finance minister moved the Payment System Bill to second reading, to repeal and replace the 2014 Act and license fintech payment providers</a>.</p> <p>No enactment date is on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Advanced  |
| Liberia | <p>The <a href="#">mobile money regulations</a> are in force and unamended, and the interoperable fee schedule of 2026 was approved under them.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>They are the central bank's standing mobile-money framework (<a href="#">regulations</a>).</p> <p>No payments statute, electronic transactions act or switch instrument sits above them, so a fee schedule for a national instant payment system rests on a regulation written before that system existed.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | No change |
| Libya   | <p>A prime-ministerial decree of <a href="#">6 March 2026</a> obliges treasuries and collecting agencies to accept electronic payment, the first such instrument on file.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The decree was issued on 6 March 2026 and is reported alongside a cut in the foreign-exchange levy, making electronic acceptance a duty of state collecting bodies rather than an option (<a href="#">decree</a>).</p> <p>The base holds no implementing regulation, no compliance deadline and no penalty for a body that does not comply.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS  |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Madagascar | <p>The <a href="#">2016 electronic money law</a> remains the governing instrument; nothing amended it in the window.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute runs to 120 articles and licenses electronic money institutions under the banking supervisor (<a href="#">law</a>); its constitutionality was confirmed in January 2017 (<a href="#">decision</a>).</p> <p>The 2026 finance law, itself cleared by the Constitutional Court in December 2025, carries mobile transaction tax provisions (<a href="#">decision</a>).</p> <p>The central bank's digital currency project has a published distribution model and a pilot framed for August 2026, with no legislative instrument behind it in the base (<a href="#">project</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | No change |
| Malawi     | <p>A <a href="#">financial crimes amendment</a> removing all references to cheques passed Parliament in August 2026, one of four bills effecting the cheque phase-out.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The bill was passed alongside amendments to the payment systems and deposit insurance statutes, following a bills of exchange amendment that effects the phase-out (<a href="#">bills</a>).</p> <p>Assent, gazette date and commencement are not published, and the safeguarding regulations the finance minister promised are not drafted. A member warned that rural users risk being left behind by the switch away from cheques (<a href="#">warning</a>), and the base holds no primary for the discontinuation itself and no date for it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Advanced  |
| Mauritius  | <p>The <a href="#">2018 payment systems Act</a> is the governing statute; a payment aggregator guideline was issued under it in July 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act was assented in November 2018 and is now at its seventh consolidated version (<a href="#">Act, consolidation</a>).</p> <p>The central bank issued a guideline for payment aggregators in July 2026, bringing them under a stated supervisory expectation for the first time (<a href="#">guideline</a>).</p> <p>The financial-crime statute book was amended in April 2026 (<a href="#">Act</a>). No enforcement action, licence refusal or sanction under the payments Act is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Advanced  |
| Mozambique | <p>The central bank <a href="#">made connection to the single national payments network mandatory with 60-minute incident reporting</a> and <a href="#">set an annual ceiling on card payments abroad</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-06-02 — a central-bank notice <a href="#">made connection to the single national network mandatory for electronic payment services and imposed 60-minute incident-reporting, continuity and disaster-recovery duties on financial institutions</a>. The gazette text was not locatable, and the base holds the fullest available account instead.</p> <p>2026-07-28 — a further notice <a href="#">set an annual limit of 3,000,000 meticaïs on external payments made with bank cards, revoking the December 2025 notice it replaces</a>, this one the primary gazette text.</p> <p>Two instruments moved in two months, in opposite directions: one compels participation in a domestic rail, the other caps what can leave through a foreign one.</p>                                   | Advanced  |
| Namibia    | <p>The <a href="#">Payment System Management Act</a> commenced in August 2023, its licensing determination took effect in January 2026, and government-to-person payments went live in June.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act commenced on 8 August 2023, and the central bank's PSD-1 determination brought licensing and authorisation of payment service providers into operation on 6 January 2026 (<a href="#">commencement, determination</a>).</p> <p>Under the Act the payments association moved from a management council to a management board during 2025, and a fees and charges determination came into force in December 2025.</p> <p>The first live government-to-person grant payments ran over the national instant payment network on 17 June 2026 through one certified bank (<a href="#">disbursements</a>).</p> <p>An operational and cybersecurity standard for the payment system followed in July 2026. The statute is doing what statutes are for: each determination under it lands as a dated rule.</p> | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Nigeria      | <p>Crypto sits <a href="#">inside the securities perimeter</a>, an <a href="#">executive order</a> created a coordinating council, <a href="#">draft virtual-asset rules</a> set capital thresholds and a <a href="#">stablecoin licensing regime</a> is drafted.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Investments and Securities Act 2025 put crypto inside the securities perimeter (<a href="#">Act</a>), and an executive order of July 2026 created a Virtual Asset Council and Office with its secretariat at the central bank, creating no new regulator and transferring no powers (<a href="#">order</a>).</p> <p>Draft rules out for comment set N500m minimum capital for digital-asset platforms, N200m for service providers, a N30m registration fee, local incorporation and a resident chief executive (<a href="#">rules</a>, <a href="#">data</a>).</p> <p>A drafted issuer-licensing regime for fiat-collateralised stablecoins requires full reserves with licensed Nigerian banks, daily reconciliation and monthly audited publication; no instrument is issued (<a href="#">regime</a>). The securities regulator has admitted further firms to an incubation programme with no graduation route published (<a href="#">incubation</a>), and the central bank intends to run observer nodes on approved stablecoin blockchains (<a href="#">nodes</a>).</p> <p>2026-08-31 — the same draft <a href="#">also carries custody and incident duties: customer assets segregated from the firm's own with 80% held offline, N2bn minimum capital for exchanges and custodians, a fidelity bond of at least 25% of that minimum, incidents notified within 24 hours and reported within 48, and SEC approval before a foreign-issued stablecoin is listed</a>. No commencement date or transition period is stated.</p> | Advanced |
| Rwanda       | <p>The lower house approved the rationale for a <a href="#">draft law on virtual assets</a> in April 2026 with nothing reported since, above a <a href="#">central bank regulatory sandbox</a> established in 2022.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The chamber approved the rationale in April 2026 and nothing has been reported on the draft since (<a href="#">draft</a>).</p> <p>The sandbox has run since 2022 on an analyst's account; its own regulation is not held, so its admission criteria, cohort and exit route are unstated (<a href="#">sandbox</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Advanced |
| Sierra Leone | <p>A <a href="#">Public Financial Management Act 2026</a> went to stakeholder consultation in August 2026 covering digital payments, and the <a href="#">National Communications Authority Act 2022</a> was tested against the fraud wave in a published legal analysis.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The draft was consulted on in Freetown in August 2026; no text, parliamentary stage or commencement date is published (<a href="#">draft</a>).</p> <p>The communications Act was tested against the mobile-money fraud wave in a published legal analysis in July 2026 (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>Between them and the cybercrime Act the country has statutes that reach the conduct. What it does not have, recorded separately, is a rule allocating the loss.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Advanced |
| Somalia      | <p>The <a href="#">National Payment System Bill</a> cleared both chambers by January 2026, replacing a regime that rested on <a href="#">2020 mobile money regulations</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The lower house passed the bill 154 to 2 on 8 November 2025 (<a href="#">vote</a>) and the upper house carried its third reading 28 to nil in January 2026 (<a href="#">vote</a>). It empowers the central bank to license and supervise payment systems and digital-money platforms.</p> <p>Until it is signed, the operative instrument remains the Mobile Money Regulations amended in 2020, covering licensing, conduct of business, safeguarding of consumer funds, supervision and winding-up (<a href="#">regulations</a>).</p> <p>No record of presidential signature was found.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Advanced |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS  |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| South Africa | <p>A National Payment System Bill will go out for public comment, moving payment regulation from entity-based to activity-based (<a href="#">announcement</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Reserve Bank governor said on 1 September 2026 that the National Payment System Bill will soon go out for public comment, moving payment regulation from an entity-based model to an activity-based one (<a href="#">announcement</a>).</p> <p>An activity-based model is what would open payment licensing to non-banks, which the base currently carries as a not-held position.</p> <p>Nothing is enacted: the base holds a governor's statement of intent, no published bill text, no comment period dates and no commencement provision.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Advanced  |
| South Sudan  | <p>A <a href="#">National Payment System Bill</a> went to a five-day validation workshop in August 2026, with no text, introduction date or parliamentary timetable held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The workshop opened on 10 August 2026 (<a href="#">workshop</a>, <a href="#">transition</a>, <a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>The separately recorded national instant payment system has been planned since early 2025 and has not moved, so the statute and the rail are both at the stage of intention.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Advanced  |
| Sudan        | <p>Four central bank instruments cover digital payments: <a href="#">mobile payment licensing</a>, <a href="#">banking agency</a>, <a href="#">USSD controls</a> and <a href="#">anti-money-laundering controls</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The 2020 regulation sets licensing conditions, capital and insurance requirements, e-money and trust-account rules and agent rules for mobile payment institutions (<a href="#">regulation</a>).</p> <p>Three instruments were made inside the window. The banking agency regulation of 1 March 2026 lets banks deliver services through licensed agents outside branches (<a href="#">regulation</a>).</p> <p>Circular 7/2026 sets binding consumer-protection requirements for USSD services (<a href="#">circular</a>).</p> <p>Circular 8/2026 extends anti-money-laundering supervision to mobile and phone payment channels (<a href="#">circular</a>).</p> <p>All four are central bank instruments made under the Banking Business Organisation Act 2004. No primary payments statute is held.</p> | Advanced  |
| Togo         | <p>An <a href="#">anti-money-laundering law</a> was adopted in the December 2025 budget session, with no promulgation date, number or gazette reference held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The source gives only the budget session, so the vote date is not established (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>It is the only payments-adjacent statute in this ledger, and its text cannot be read. Against six institutions live on the regional instant payment platform and a treasury prepaid card announced, the governing law is present as a headline.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Advanced  |
| Uganda       | <p><a href="#">Digital lending platform regulation</a> was stated as intended at a finance ministry and parliamentary retreat, with no bill, instrument or timetable held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The intention was stated in August 2026 (<a href="#">intention</a>).</p> <p>It is the only payments-specific legislative movement in this ledger, against a payments record that includes a stablecoin corridor, a tokenised-asset exchange, a currency-settlement service and a credit-scoring memorandum with nothing published about its consent or legal basis.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced  |
| Zambia       | <p>The <a href="#">mobile money levy</a> rate doubled during 2025, dated only to the year, and the source is an industry body arguing against such levies.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The doubling is dated only to the year, so it cannot be placed inside or outside the window (<a href="#">levy</a>).</p> <p>Naming the source's interest matters here: an industry body arguing against mobile money levies is the only account of this one, and no government or regulator statement of the rate or its yield is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | No change |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | PROGRESS |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Zimbabwe | <p>The <a href="#">National Payment Systems Act</a> of 2001 is the standing statute, and Statutory Instrument 65 of 2026 opened a licensed fintech sandbox at the Victoria Falls financial centre.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act of 2001, commenced on 16 November 2001 and consolidated to 31 December 2016, provides for the recognition, operation, regulation and supervision of payment, clearing and settlement systems, electronic payment instructions included (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>Statutory Instrument 65 of 2026, made under section 81 of the Banking Act, establishes a technology department and a financial technology lab at the Victoria Falls International Financial Services Centre, with application, licensing, variation, suspension, monitoring and interim and final reporting for tested activities (<a href="#">regulations</a>).</p> <p>The instrument is held as a capture truncated near section 9, so the licensing conditions themselves are not on file.</p> | Advanced |

## Legislation enabling data interoperability

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | PROGRESS  |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Algeria  | <p>A <a href="#">national data-governance system was launched</a> in February 2026 under a presidential decree of December 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-02-09 - the prime minister <a href="#">launched the national data-governance system established by a presidential decree of 30 December 2025</a>.</p> <p>The trust-services law of February 2026 is the other enabling instrument: it <a href="#">establishes the national trust-service and electronic-identification framework across 116 articles and requires trust-service-provider data to be hosted nationally</a>.</p> <p>Neither is accompanied by an operating rule, a participating body, a dataset exchanged or a service built on it, so what is established is the legal frame and not its use.</p>                                                                                      | Advanced  |
| Benin    | <p>The exchange's founding decree of March 2020 <a href="#">is in force and now on file</a>, acquired as a signed scan rather than a gazette copy.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">The decree instituting the national exchange was signed on 18 March 2020 and remains in force</a>. What moved in the window is custody rather than law: the base acquired the signed decree in August 2026 from the operator's own media host. It is not a gazette copy, and the file is a page-image scan with no text layer, so its articles cannot be quoted.</p> <p>No amendment, implementing decree or successor statute appears. The instruments that have moved are administrative — the access conditions and the architecture referentials reported elsewhere — which is how a six-year-old decree comes to govern an exchange carrying 32.7m requests a month.</p> | No change |
| Botswana | <p>The <a href="#">Digital Services Act</a> supplies the enabling law for data interoperability, at sections 12 and 22.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-10-17 — <a href="#">the Act requires a standardised framework for secure exchange of information and an information gateway</a>, the first statutory basis for cross-government data exchange the base holds.</p> <p>No regulations have been made under either section, and the base carries nothing on the gateway being built.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | PROGRESS  |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Burundi                  | <p>A 2018 presidential decree is the closest instrument to legislation enabling data sharing between public bodies; nothing moved on it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Decret n 100/085 du 25 juillet 2018 establishes the national framework for the collection, dissemination, access, archiving and security of data and micro-data. It defines administrative data as data collected by public institutions in the exercise of their functions, brings administrative data into the dissemination regime, and provides for making data available by electronic means, with institutional public users and rules on access.</p> <p>It is an enabling instrument rather than a mandate: it does not require any two public bodies to connect, and the base holds no implementing text, no data-sharing agreement made under it and no platform operating on its authority.</p> | No change |
| Cape Verde               | <p>The interoperability standards diploma announced for 2024 is unadopted while interoperability is asserted as working.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The diploma was announced for drafting in 2024 under the state-modernisation strategy, with no adoption on record.</p> <p>There is no evidence it was adopted two years past its stated year, while interoperability is asserted as a working property of the government portal and of the company registry. The gap between an asserted interoperability layer and an unadopted standards instrument is the finding: what public systems must do to connect, and who decides, is set by nothing published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Stalled   |
| Central African Republic | <p>A national platform became operationally effective at one ministry in February 2026; no interoperability statute is held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-02 - a national platform became operationally effective at the planning ministry, with data migrated, staff use made mandatory and a launch ceremony held, launched publicly in late February. It is the first working government data platform the base holds.</p> <p>The architecture it would sit in is commissioned rather than built: the digital governance project's procurement plan carries a US\$300,000 technical-assistance contract for interoperability architecture.</p> <p>No statute, decree or standard obliging interoperability appears anywhere on this ledger, so what enables exchange here is a platform and a contract, not a law.</p>                                                  | Advanced  |
| Chad                     | <p>A digital code has no adopted text: a forty-five-day drafting deadline set in April 2026 expired in June with nothing on record.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The code was described as finalised in December 2025 and a committee was then given forty-five days from 27 April 2026 to draft the framework; that deadline expired about 11 June with no text on record (code, finalisation, agency).</p> <p>The committee itself was inaugurated with thirty-four members and mandated to build on prior regulator contributions, and no output is on record (committee).</p> <p>A ministry system prohibition and an interoperability programme are both recorded separately as depending on a framework that does not exist.</p>                                                                                                                                          | Stalled   |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS                                                                                              |
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| Cote d'Ivoire | <p>A <a href="#">2017 ordinance</a> requires an interoperability reference framework, a platform every authority must join, and a bar on asking users for data the state already holds.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute is the enabling law and it is unchanged in the window. It requires a general interoperability reference framework fixing the technical rules, data repositories, norms and standards administrative authorities must use; requires the State to put in place an e-services interoperability platform every administrative authority is bound to connect to, giving existing systems two years to conform; and <a href="#">forbids an authority requiring a user to supply information already produced to any authority whose system respects that framework</a>.</p> <p>2026-01-16 - the identification office and the post office launched an application giving every holder of the national identification number a digital post box, and the office <a href="#">placed the national register of natural persons at the centre of it, stating that embedding a certified identity is what guarantees transaction reliability, data protection and traceability</a> - the once-only principle working in one service rather than across the administration.</p> <p>The two-year conformity deadline the ordinance set fell in 2019. Nothing on the ledger records it being met, enforced or extended.</p> | No change, the 2017 statute stands unamended and its two-year conformity deadline is eight years past |
| Djibouti      | <p>A <a href="#">2022 law gives the digital economy ministry a statutory mandate over the interoperability of state information systems</a>, unchanged in the period.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law establishing the ministry <a href="#">charges it with ensuring the coherence and interoperability of information systems by design, breaking down ministerial application silos and enabling data sharing between administrations through a dedicated platform</a>, in force since 27 July 2022.</p> <p>It is a mandate on a ministry rather than a duty on data holders: no law compels an administration to expose its data, and no implementing decree under this article is held. The <a href="#">interoperability framework the state information-systems agency maintains</a> is a technical document with no enacting instrument on file.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | No change                                                                                             |
| Egypt         | <p>The <a href="#">data centre and cloud licensing framework</a> is the operative rule; no interoperability statute is held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The regulator's <a href="#">licensing and registration framework for establishing and operating data centres and providing hosting and cloud computing services</a> is the operative rule beneath the estate, issued under the telecommunications law.</p> <p>The one law that obliges an exchange is sectoral: <a href="#">the 2025 real estate identifier law establishes a unified non-repeating national identifier database built on a unified base map</a>, which is a shared key by statute.</p> <p>No general statute requiring public bodies to exchange data, and no once-only rule, appears anywhere on this ledger.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | No change, a first stated position with no earlier account behind it                                  |
| Eritrea       | <p>No law enables data exchange between government systems; a 2022 assessment records no service bus and no cross-system exchange (<a href="#">dataset</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A structured government-technology dataset for 2022 records no government interoperability framework and no system that exchanges data across financial management, human resources, payroll, customs, tax or social-insurance systems (<a href="#">dataset</a>).</p> <p>A regional ministerial assessment places Eritrea's data-protection policy area at a nascent stage without legislation or regulatory oversight (<a href="#">policy matrix</a>), so there is also no legal basis on which systems could lawfully share personal data.</p> <p>The one system that did move is closed rather than connected: the customs platform runs on an intranet architecture independent of continuous internet access (<a href="#">account</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change                                                                                             |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS                                                                        |
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| Eswatini | <p>No Act enables data interoperability. The <a href="#">Electronic Communications and Transactions Act</a> is the nearest instrument, and it does not create a duty to share.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act of 2022 is the operative electronic-transactions statute and the closest legal basis for exchange between public bodies; nothing in the base creates an interoperability obligation (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>The obligations that do exist run the other way. The data protection authority requires every controller to document its data flows, storage and sharing, which constrains exchange rather than mandating it (<a href="#">directive</a>).</p> <p>Where systems are being joined it is by project rather than statute: the 2026 budget speech reports the first release of an integrated financial management information system (<a href="#">budget speech</a>).</p> <p>More than half of ministries still lack meaningful system interoperability.</p> | No change, no interoperability statute and the duties that exist are protective |
| Ethiopia | <p>No instrument compels agencies to integrate with the unified service platform, <a href="#">on its own regional executives' account</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Regional executives of the unified public-service platform say no legal framework obliges agencies to join it, so integration rests on agreement between them (<a href="#">platform review</a>).</p> <p>The base holds no interoperability proclamation, no data-sharing regulation and no mandate under the e-government interoperability framework, which has itself been in development since 2024.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | No change                                                                       |
| Gabon    | <p>An <a href="#">ordinance of September 2025</a> makes interconnection between administrations compulsory and mandates digitisation of administrative services.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The ordinance on digitalisation and electronic government was signed by the President and published in the gazette of 7 September 2025, carrying compulsory interconnection between administrations and a national-preference clause in digital public procurement (<a href="#">the ordinance</a>).</p> <p>Its number comes from the minister's own commentary rather than from the instrument (<a href="#">ministerial commentary</a>), and the base holds no article text or gazette reference.</p> <p>It names no platform and no standard, so the obligation to interconnect exists without anything to interconnect through.</p>                                                                                                                                                           | Advanced                                                                        |
| Ghana    | <p>A <a href="#">data harmonisation bill</a> was consulted on in November 2025 and a separate data exchange Act was named in July 2026; neither has been laid.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The harmonisation bill went to public consultation from 19 to 27 November 2025 and would make the information technology agency both regulator and technical enforcer of the standards; it was renamed an Act in the July 2026 artificial-intelligence plan and has not been laid before Parliament (<a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>The ministry names a data exchange Act as a statute distinct from harmonisation, carrying interoperability and inter-agency sharing, with no draft or timetable (<a href="#">exchange Act</a>).</p> <p>Two instruments have been named for the same problem and neither exists as a text the base can read.</p>                                                                                                                                                | Advanced                                                                        |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | PROGRESS                                                    |
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| Guinea-Bissau | <p>A national interoperability regulation for public and private digital systems <a href="#">was approved by the government in August 2026</a>, with no decree number or in-force date named.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-08-08 — the WARDIP programme <a href="#">announced government approval of a national interoperability framework regulating how public and private digital systems and platforms connect</a>, presented as Guinea-Bissau's contribution to the regional programme.</p> <p>It is the one instrument of the three <a href="#">draft decrees the Council of Ministers approved on 10 July 2025</a> that has moved since. What the record does not carry is the instrument itself: no decree number, no gazettal and no entry-into-force date, and the approval is reported by the World Bank-backed programme that supports the work rather than by an official journal.</p> <p>No data exchange platform appears on this ledger for the regulation to govern.</p> | Advanced                                                    |
| Kenya         | <p>Interoperability duties are arriving sector by sector: the <a href="#">Digital Health Act</a> in 2023, an agricultural information bill in 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Digital Health Act of November 2023 is the clearest statutory basis for data exchange in a sector, carrying its own data exchange regulations (<a href="#">act</a>).</p> <p>A Digital Agricultural Information Bill published in March 2026 would establish a centre for digital agricultural information with statutory functions (<a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>A national data governance policy remains in validation (<a href="#">validation</a>). What the base does not hold is any general statute establishing a duty to share data across government; each instrument enables one sector.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Advanced                                                    |
| Lesotho       | <p>No dedicated interoperability statute exists; the <a href="#">VAT e-invoicing regulations are the binding data-exchange rule</a> the base holds.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2012-02-22 — the <a href="#">Data Protection Act</a> is the closest enacted instrument bearing on lawful sharing of personal government data.</p> <p>2026-03-27 — <a href="#">Legal Notice 25 of 2026 requires system-to-system electronic transmission of VAT transaction data</a>, a binding interoperability rule confined to one revenue stream.</p> <p>2025-08-26 — <a href="#">a workshop opened to develop a digital public infrastructure framework</a>.</p> <p>No statute enabling data exchange across government generally is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Advanced, on a tax regulation rather than a general statute |
| Madagascar    | <p>A <a href="#">draft electronic-signature and interoperability decree</a> was validated at a ministry workshop in September 2025 and has not been adopted.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The 2015 electronic-signature law has had no implementing decree; the draft validated in September 2025 would supply one and provides for a national interoperability committee (<a href="#">draft</a>).</p> <p>The minister named the recasting as a contribution to a future digital code, which is not held. A year on, no adoption, gazette reference or committee appointment is recorded.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Advanced                                                    |
| Malawi        | <p>A proposed <a href="#">government data sharing regulation</a> would route all data requests through the national data centre and require binding sharing agreements, and it is not made.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Ministries and agencies had been sharing citizen data by email, USB drive and paper, and the platform operated without binding rules (<a href="#">regulation</a>).</p> <p>The proposal would require encryption in transit and at rest, set a common digital standard for system-to-system exchange, and require binding data sharing agreements with usage limits and audit trails. No draft text is held, and the minister described a binding regulation as the missing piece in an account given during a vendor meeting abroad.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Advanced                                                    |

| COUNTRY   | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS |
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| Mauritius | <p>An <a href="#">omnibus bill</a> of 119 pages amending fifty-eight Acts carries the fintech committee, the artificial-intelligence city scheme, a threat-sharing platform and a digital travel authorisation. Full record</p> <p>The bill was introduced on 24 July 2026 with staged commencement from 1 September and several provisions deemed retrospective (<a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>A secondary account put the figure at some sixty laws; the enacting text gives fifty-eight amended and one repealed (<a href="#">account</a>). It is the single largest legislative vehicle in the country's digital record, and it was introduced and not enacted.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Advanced |
| Morocco   | <p>A <a href="#">Digital X.O framework bill</a> sits with the government's general secretariat on three pillars, one of them interoperability on traceable consent. Full record</p> <p>The bill was under review by the general secretariat in November 2025, on pillars of data governance, sectoral digital identity, and interoperability resting on traceable consent (<a href="#">bill</a>, <a href="#">account</a>).</p> <p>The ministry frames it as sitting under the 2009 data-protection law rather than replacing it. No text, article count or tabling date is on record, and nothing has been published about it since.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Advanced |
| Namibia   | <p>The <a href="#">Electronic Transactions Act</a> of 2019 is the enabling statute, and its electronic-signature and accreditation provisions were brought into force in June 2026. Full record</p> <p>The Act of 2019 is the standing statute for electronic transactions and remains the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>Electronic signature regulations were gazetted in December 2025 and the regulator separately gazetted regulations for accrediting security products, services and their providers; the Act's section 20 and its accreditation chapter were brought into force in June 2026 (<a href="#">signatures</a>, <a href="#">accreditation</a>, <a href="#">commencement</a>).</p> <p>The regulator states it is the national root certification authority, and legally recognised electronic signatures still had no launch on record in July 2026.</p> <p>Trust infrastructure is now legislated. What is not legislated is a duty on public bodies to make their systems talk to each other.</p> | Advanced |
| Nigeria   | <p>A <a href="#">National Digital Economy and E-Governance Bill</a> before the assembly would elevate the technology agency to a super regulator, with overlap flagged by stakeholders. Full record</p> <p>The bill offers a unified legal framework with broad supervisory and enforcement powers, and also carries the risk-based artificial-intelligence regime (<a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>Its electronic-signature provisions overlap with the root certification authority the identity statute already created, and which instrument governs digital signatures is unresolved on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Advanced |
| Rwanda    | <p>The <a href="#">2023 single digital identity law</a> requires relying-party integration and synchronisation with civil registration; the <a href="#">strategy above it</a> followed in March 2026. Full record</p> <p>The law enacted in June 2023 governs population registration in the single digital identity system, defines authentication, obliges relying parties to integrate, and requires synchronisation with civil registration (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>That is the clearest statutory obligation to interoperate the base holds for any Rwandan system.</p> <p>The digital public infrastructure strategy launched in March 2026 sets the architecture around it (<a href="#">launch</a>), and the shared data hub that would carry general exchange is still at pre-procurement (<a href="#">minutes</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Advanced |

| COUNTRY               | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS                                                                                                        |
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| Sao Tome and Principe | <p>A <a href="#">National Framework for Interoperability</a> was enacted as Law 1/2024 for public-sector data sharing, and only a secondary legal survey describes it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law is held through the same 2024 legal-survey chapter as the data-protection law, not through its own text (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>It is the legal basis for the civil-registry to electoral-database linkage recorded separately, which is the one working interoperability in this unit — so the law has an evidenced use even though its provisions cannot be read here.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | No change                                                                                                       |
| Somalia               | <p><a href="#">Law 46 of 2026</a> puts civil registration on a statutory footing beside the identity system; nothing yet compels one public body to share data with another.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Population Registration and Civil Status Statistics Law, gazetted 5 April 2026, establishes the civil-registration and vital-statistics layer alongside the national identity infrastructure (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>The Data Protection Act supplies the conditions under which personal data may move, including outside the country (<a href="#">Act</a>) — permission, not obligation.</p> <p>What carries interoperability in practice is administrative: a cross-institutional working group launched in June 2026 to integrate the national identity and its verification platform across public and private services (<a href="#">working group</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Advanced                                                                                                        |
| South Africa          | <p>Draft data-exchange legislation is a <a href="#">stated deliverable of the exchange pilot</a>, over a <a href="#">2014 statute that already provides for administration-wide norms and standards</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The standing instrument is not a data law. <a href="#">The Public Administration Management Act has been in force since 2014 as the frame for administration-wide arrangements across national, provincial and municipal spheres, including the transfer and secondment of employees and the establishment of common norms and standards</a> — which is the authority under which service standards are set, and it says nothing about data.</p> <p><a href="#">Draft data-exchange legislation is one of three named deliverables of the one-year exchange pilot</a>, alongside four task teams and interoperability standards.</p> <p>So the country is running a federated data exchange in pilot with no statute behind it, and the statute is scheduled to be drafted by the pilot itself. Nothing on this ledger states who would introduce it or when.</p> | Advanced                                                                                                        |
| South Sudan           | <p>An <a href="#">ICT Authority</a> is being established while awaiting legislation, and a May 2026 account states the President already signed its legal framework; the two are unreconciled.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Both accounts trace to one speaker. In May 2026 the minister said the law is out already and signed by the President; in August 2026 he was reported standing the body up while parliamentary legislation is awaited (<a href="#">establishment</a>, <a href="#">framework</a>).</p> <p>No bill, act, presidential order or gazette entry can be found. The justice ministry's law collection stops at 2017 and omits the cybercrime Act too, the Office of the President publishes no decrees, and the Assembly's bills register stops in 2023 — so the registers are not current enough for their silence to settle anything.</p> <p>The division of competence with the existing communications regulator is unstated. The qualified status is the resting state.</p>                                                                                                    | Mixed, an ICT Authority reported both as legally established and as awaiting legislation, from the same speaker |
| Sudan                 | <p>A <a href="#">draft Digital Transformation Law of 2026</a> is in redrafting with the ministry, the third of a three-instrument package.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>It went to the Council of Ministers alongside the cybersecurity and data drafts and was reported in redrafting in August 2026 (<a href="#">draft</a>, <a href="#">ministry</a>).</p> <p>None of the three texts is published. The platforms the law would presumably govern — the national services platform, the identity credential, the civil-service records system — are already live, so the statute follows the systems rather than authorising them.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Advanced                                                                                                        |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS                                                                                       |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tunisia  | <p>The <a href="#">Development Plan 2026-2030</a> was promulgated as a law in July 2026, and every volume of the annex held is marked draft.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>It was promulgated on 20 July 2026 after adoption by both chambers (<a href="#">law</a>, <a href="#">annex</a>).</p> <p>Whether the promulgated annex differs from the version tabled and voted is not established, and no as-enacted printing has been published. That is a live problem rather than a formality: the annex is where the digital programme's project lines sit, so the legally binding content of the country's digital plan cannot be read.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Advanced                                                                                       |
| Zambia   | <p>A <a href="#">Cabinet directive on open-source technology</a> was issued to ministries, reported only in an excerpt of a trade-press article with no government publication held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>It was issued alongside the spatial data infrastructure launch in June 2026 (<a href="#">directive</a>).</p> <p>No government publication of it is held. Officials elsewhere in this ledger name fragmented, vendor-locked systems as a governance and legal problem rather than a technical one, which is the case the directive would answer — and the directive itself cannot be read.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Advanced                                                                                       |
| Zimbabwe | <p>No Act enabling data interoperability is held. The <a href="#">Cyber and Data Protection Act</a> governs lawful sharing, and the standards work is technical rather than statutory.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act's transborder-flow and processing provisions are the strongest enacted instrument bearing on lawful data linking and sharing, and they constrain rather than mandate exchange (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>Where interoperability is being enabled, it is by technical standard rather than legislation: a national health information exchange is in development to connect laboratory, logistics and facility systems (<a href="#">exchange</a>).</p> <p>Nothing on the base creates a duty on public bodies to make their systems interoperable, or a legal basis for once-only data sharing across ministries.</p> | No change, the sharing rules sit in data-protection law and no interoperability statute exists |

## AI legislation / regulations

| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | PROGRESS |
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| Algeria | <p>An <a href="#">ethical-artificial-intelligence law</a> is reported in preparation, with no draft text, sponsor or timetable held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Nothing existed at the window's opening. The law is <a href="#">described as in preparation, with no draft text, sponsor or timetable held</a> as at 2026-08-03.</p> <p>That is nine months of a stated preparation with nothing published, against a national strategy whose deployment roadmap was agreed in the same period and a university assistant announced to steer module allocation and mark student answers from the 2026-2027 academic year. No rule, appeal route or disclosure duty governs any of it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Advanced |
| Angola  | <p>An 86-article artificial-intelligence bill <a href="#">went to public consultation in September 2025</a>, with no tabling, committee stage or vote since.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The draft <a href="#">runs to 86 articles in nine chapters</a> and departs from the tiered risk pyramid used elsewhere: a single critical-AI category carries registration, security-risk assessment and emergency-response duties, with extraterritorial reach over activity abroad affecting Angolan interests, a right to explanation and to refuse decisions made by artificial intelligence, and both criminal and strict civil liability.</p> <p>It repeals no existing legislation, defers military applications to a separate instrument and excludes scientific research and purely personal use. Its financial assessment is not costed.</p> <p>No tabling, committee stage or vote is on record in the eleven months since consultation opened, and the policy the law would implement does not exist: the readiness assessment reported under strategy names its absence as the central gap.</p> | Advanced |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS  |
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| Benin         | <p>A four-country comparative study <a href="#">found no artificial-intelligence-specific legislation in force or in draft</a>; the 2023 to 2027 strategy carries the field.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-08-10 — <a href="#">a four-country comparative study of West African artificial-intelligence governance found no artificial-intelligence-specific instrument in force or in draft in Benin</a>, and rates a neighbour's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance. That is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one.</p> <p>What carries the field instead is soft law: the national strategy, the data protection authority's artificial-intelligence policy and the generative-tool regime for public agents, all reported elsewhere in this report. Each binds a part of the state and none binds a private deployer, which is the gap a statute would close.</p>                                                                                                                                            | No change |
| Botswana      | <p><a href="#">No AI-specific Act or regulation exists</a>; the Data Protection Act 2024 is the closest adjacent enacted instrument.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-12-22 — <a href="#">the country profile records no AI legislation and the national policy at an advanced stage</a>.</p> <p>2025-08-13 — <a href="#">a minister said the policy was in final drafting</a>, the earliest in-window movement toward one.</p> <p>The absence was searched on 31 August 2026 and nothing was found: no Bill, no regulations under an existing statute, and no announced timetable for either.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No change |
| Burundi       | <p>No binding artificial-intelligence instrument was located in any national legal source; <a href="#">a non-binding strategy was validated in April 2026</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">No Burundian loi, decret, ordonnance ministerielle or regulator reglement governing artificial intelligence</a> was located across the official legal database, the official gazette, the presidency, both chambers, the communications regulator and the state technology secretariat, on a search dated to the national readiness assessment held in Bujumbura on 25-27 November 2025.</p> <p>2026-04-21 — <a href="#">a national validation session for the artificial-intelligence strategy was opened by the ministry responsible for the digital economy with a development agency</a>. What moved is the validation of a non-binding strategy, not any instrument: the absence the indicator asks about is unchanged and is now dated.</p>                                                                                                            | No change |
| Comoros       | <p>An <a href="#">obligation to label artificial-intelligence content</a> entered law at article 231 of the new <a href="#">communication code</a>; no dedicated statute exists.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-02 - the communication code was <a href="#">modified and completed by loi n 25-021/AU</a>, promulgated on 2 February 2026; its article 231 requires explicit labelling of content generated or heavily modified by artificial intelligence, backed by graduated administrative sanctions to one million Comorian francs and a public campaign. The full text is now on file, running to two hundred and seventy-four articles.</p> <p>2026-03 - the Council of Ministers <a href="#">took a six-month evaluation of institutional, technical and regulatory readiness</a>, adding the interior ministry to the committee on national-security and data-governance grounds. Its stated June conclusion has passed with nothing published.</p> <p>The country now regulates one use of the technology inside a media statute, and nothing else.</p> | Advanced  |
| Cote d'Ivoire | <p><a href="#">No Ivorian artificial-intelligence statute is published</a>; governance runs entirely through non-binding strategy instruments.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The position at both ends of the window is that <a href="#">no bill, act or implementing decree on artificial intelligence has been published</a>, and that is a cited absence rather than an unexamined one.</p> <p>What moved instead is policy. The <a href="#">draft 2026-2030 cybersecurity strategy extends state scope to artificial intelligence, emerging technologies and cloud</a>, and is the only binding-track vehicle doing so. A published bill, act or implementing decree would settle the indicator; nothing on file suggests one is drafted.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | No change |

| COUNTRY           | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS  |
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| Djibouti          | <p>No artificial-intelligence law, decree or procurement rule is held; the strategy in preparation is not an instrument.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The position is unchanged at both ends of the window: no law, decree or procurement rule governing artificial-intelligence systems in public use is held, and the strategy under preparation is not an instrument.</p> <p>It matters more here than the absence alone suggests, because systems are already in public use: a weather early-warning system in service and a memorandum for a compute zone signed. Nothing published states what a public body must do before deploying such a system, who may audit it, or what a person subject to one may contest.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | No change |
| Egypt             | <p>The minister told Cabinet a regulator unit already detects and acts on artificial-intelligence-manipulated content, and legislative amendment is needed.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-07-29 - the minister told Cabinet that a unit had been formed inside the telecommunications regulator which already detects and acts on manipulated video and imagery, but that legislative amendment is needed to address the practices at root. The unit's formation date, legal basis, staffing, method, appeal route and contest procedure are not stated: the detection capability operates ahead of the instrument that would authorise it.</p> <p>At the same meeting the Cabinet agreed a review of the governing social-media statutes, heavier financial penalties and public awareness campaigns, with a comparative study of other states' approaches being prepared and no bill, text or timetable stated; the Prime Minister credited a press and media campaign with prompting the response.</p> | Advanced  |
| Equatorial Guinea | <p>A draft artificial intelligence law is being written, setting six guiding principles and proposing an autonomous national authority for the technology and for data.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A drafting session in August 2025 addressed splitting the proposed authority's functions, and two national institutions are named as prospective training and certification centres under the draft; no enactment, text or adoption date is published (draft law).</p> <p>The proposed authority would supervise both artificial intelligence and data, in a country whose existing data-protection statute has had no supervisory body for a decade.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Advanced  |
| Eritrea           | <p>A review dated June 2026 records no dedicated artificial-intelligence law and no national strategy (review).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A legal-status review dated 8 June 2026 states that Eritrea has no dedicated artificial-intelligence law, no national artificial-intelligence strategy, no data-protection statute and no data-protection authority, and that the nearest legal anchor is the privacy article of the 1997 constitution, which has never entered into force (review).</p> <p>The 2025 government artificial-intelligence readiness index, in its January 2026 edition, scores Eritrea zero on policy capacity and ranks it 193rd overall on a score of 13.69 (index).</p> <p>The absence is total rather than partial: no instrument, no draft and no institution with a mandate.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                             | No change |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | PROGRESS                                                                                                    |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Eswatini | <p>No AI Act or regulation exists. The regulator's <a href="#">spectrum guidelines</a> are the only binding instrument touching AI devices, and a national AI strategy is not held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The 2024 licence-exempt spectrum guidelines are the base's only binding instrument expressly touching artificial-intelligence and internet-of-things devices (<a href="#">guidelines</a>).</p> <p>A reviewed science, technology and innovation policy and a combined fourth and fifth industrial revolution strategy went to stakeholder validation in February 2026, framing artificial intelligence, automation and data governance inside a human-centred approach; neither document is held (<a href="#">validation</a>).</p> <p>The Prime Minister told a global governance dialogue in July 2026, speaking for the King, that artificial-intelligence governance frameworks should protect children and uphold human dignity (<a href="#">Geneva</a>).</p> <p>The regulator has issued guidance on artificial intelligence and deepfakes in broadcasting, which is guidance and not an instrument with force. A national AI strategy was probed and not found.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | No change, no artificial-intelligence instrument and a strategy that is Not held                            |
| Ethiopia | <p>An implementing directive gave the security agency power to designate new and emerging technology products for clearance (<a href="#">directive</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Directive 1135/2026, made under the Information Technology Products Security Clearance and Control Proclamation, creates security clearance, permit and monitoring procedures for restricted and prohibited information technology products and provides for the designation of new or emerging products — a power wide enough to reach advanced artificial-intelligence systems (<a href="#">directive</a>).</p> <p>The only instrument addressed to artificial intelligence as such remains the National Artificial Intelligence Policy adopted by the Council of Ministers in June 2024, a policy rather than a binding statute (<a href="#">policy</a>).</p> <p>The base holds no AI act, no draft bill and no regulator with an artificial-intelligence mandate, so what governs AI here is import control and general policy.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced, on a security-clearance directive rather than on any statute addressed to artificial intelligence |
| Ghana    | <p>An <a href="#">emerging technologies bill</a> is the chosen vehicle instead of a standalone artificial-intelligence Act, and the oversight body it needs does not exist.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The draft would create an emerging-technologies agency for cross-functional compliance across artificial intelligence, blockchain, connected devices, cloud and quantum, with voluntary startup registration, and was to be laid before Parliament in 2026; no text is held (<a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>A responsible artificial-intelligence body was proposed at a national consultation in April 2025 and provided for in the launched strategy within its first year, and sixteen months after first proposal it has no establishing instrument, budget or staff (<a href="#">oversight body</a>).</p> <p>Sources differ on whether it is one body or an authority plus a ministry office (<a href="#">consultation</a>, <a href="#">approval</a>).</p> <p>A third draft would overhaul the 2008 law governing the information technology agency, licensing every technology business, certifying professionals, regulating artificial intelligence and blockchain, levying 1 per cent on services and splitting the agency's regulatory and commercial arms (<a href="#">agency bill</a>); the minister's answer to critics is that detail comes in a later legislative instrument (<a href="#">agency bill</a>, <a href="#">critics</a>, <a href="#">response</a>).</p> | Advanced                                                                                                    |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS                                      |
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| Kenya      | <p>Two tracks run in parallel: a <a href="#">governance act under debate</a> and an <a href="#">artificial intelligence bill before the Senate</a> transplanting the European statute.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Senate bill is a self-declared transplant with a presidentially appointed commissioner and fines capped at KES 5m, on a separate legislative track from the ministry's draft policy; the bill text is not held (<a href="#">Senate bill, copyright and AI</a>).</p> <p>A human-rights organisation argued on 24 August 2026 that the governance act carries no child-specific protections and no consultation mechanism, setting it against the country's membership of a children's protection coalition and against a global drive to age assurance that the analysis argues adds data trails and surveillance risk rather than closing the harms it names; the act's text, sponsor and date remain unestablished (<a href="#">critique</a>).</p> | Advanced                                      |
| Lesotho    | <p>The government names the <a href="#">AI Policy of 2025 as its governance foundation</a>; no AI Act or regulation exists.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-02-20 — the ministry's ICT director reported the national AI policy successfully approved.</p> <p>2026-07-07 — the Deputy Prime Minister told the UN global dialogue that the policy is the country's AI governance foundation.</p> <p>2026-07-20 — Lesotho signed the founding agreement of a world AI cooperation organisation in Shanghai, an international commitment ahead of any domestic law.</p> <p>The absence was searched on 31 August 2026. No Bill, no regulations, and no announced timetable for either.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | No change, a policy with no statute behind it |
| Madagascar | <p>No artificial-intelligence law, bill or regulator exists; the <a href="#">data-protection commission</a> is the nearest body with oversight bearing on it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The only binding provision located is in the 2014 data-protection law, whose article 3 prohibits decisions taken solely on automated profiling (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>The commission that enforces it published its first annual report in 2026, confirming its effective establishment (<a href="#">report</a>).</p> <p>A courtesy visit to the National Assembly in August 2025 drew a statement of support for laws adapted to technological questions, the closest dated statement of legislative intent on file (<a href="#">visit</a>). No bill has been tabled.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                | No change                                     |
| Malawi     | <p>An <a href="#">AI Bill</a> is targeted to reach parliament before December 2026, and the <a href="#">copyright body will not register wholly AI-generated works</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The bill is announced as the statutory backing for the strategy, to establish a framework promoting innovation while safeguarding citizen privacy and ensuring operational accountability; the minister put the target at before December 2026, no draft text is stated, and the strategy it would ground is itself pre-adoption (<a href="#">bill, drafting, scope</a>).</p> <p>The statutory copyright body will not register works created entirely by artificial intelligence or distribute royalties on them; the rule is known only as reported, with no test stated for how much assistance is admissible, and the body's own statement is not held (<a href="#">rule</a>).</p>                                                                                 | Advanced                                      |
| Mali       | <p><a href="#">Francophone West African artificial-intelligence governance guidelines</a> were adopted with five other states in July 2026, led by an advocacy organisation.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The guidelines were adopted on 9 July 2026 and announced at a global dialogue on artificial-intelligence governance (<a href="#">guidelines</a>).</p> <p>They are the country's only artificial-intelligence governance instrument in force, they are regional rather than national, and they were led by an advocacy organisation rather than by a state. No domestic statute, decree or regulator on the subject is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Advanced                                      |

| COUNTRY           | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS                                                                      |
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| <b>Mauritius</b>  | <p>The <a href="#">higher education AI regulations of April 2026</a> are the country's only binding artificial-intelligence instrument.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Government Notice 39 of 2026 makes regulations on the use of artificial intelligence in higher education (<a href="#">regulations</a>).</p> <p>The national strategy and its fairness, accountability, inclusiveness and responsibility guidelines are non-binding (<a href="#">strategy</a>, <a href="#">guidelines</a>).</p> <p>The higher education regulator issued amended guidelines of its own in May 2026 (<a href="#">guidelines</a>). What the base does not hold is any general artificial-intelligence statute, bill or regulator: the one binding rule reaches universities only.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Advanced                                                                      |
| <b>Morocco</b>    | <p>The <a href="#">electoral organic law</a> carries the only enacted artificial-intelligence offences, while a <a href="#">private members bill</a> on regulating the technology has not moved.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Organic law 53.25 enumerates artificial-intelligence tools as a means of commission on four electoral offences and creates a new article punishing the fabrication of election disinformation with two to five years and a fine of MAD 50,000 to 100,000, upheld against a press-freedom challenge (<a href="#">offences</a>). The constitutional court found nothing unconstitutional in December 2025 (<a href="#">decision</a>, <a href="#">tabling</a>).</p> <p>A seventeen-article private member's bill setting fines of MAD 50,000 to 500,000 has been before the chamber's bureau since January 2025 with no committee report (<a href="#">bill</a>, <a href="#">roundup</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                | Advanced                                                                      |
| <b>Mozambique</b> | <p>There is <a href="#">no dedicated artificial-intelligence legislation</a>; an <a href="#">online copyright act</a> is in drafting and an <a href="#">intellectual property strategy</a> mandates a patentability study.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The ICT institute's board chairman stated in August 2026 that the country still lacks dedicated artificial-intelligence legislation (<a href="#">absence</a>).</p> <p>An Online Copyright Protection Act is in drafting for introduction next year, its chairman naming authorship of artificial-intelligence output and liability for artificial-intelligence training as open questions the country has no law on; no draft text or introduction date is held (<a href="#">drafting</a>).</p> <p>An intellectual property policy and strategy to 2035, approved by resolution in June 2026, mandates a study of the patentability of inventions made by artificial intelligence and of the inventive-step and disclosure standards that should apply (<a href="#">strategy</a>, <a href="#">account</a>).</p> | Advanced                                                                      |
| <b>Namibia</b>    | <p><a href="#">Artificial-intelligence legislation</a> is announced as following the strategy, and the research council's own authors recorded no governance framework in place.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The minister sequenced legislation behind the strategy, and nothing has been drafted or tabled (<a href="#">sequencing</a>, <a href="#">framework</a>).</p> <p>The research council's own authors recorded no artificial-intelligence governance framework in place as at February 2026. A strategy that is itself unpublished cannot yet ground a statute, so both halves of the governance question are pending on the same document.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | No change, announced as following the strategy with nothing drafted or tabled |

| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS  |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Nigeria | <p>A <a href="#">risk-based regime</a> sits in an unpassed bill, competition law was <a href="#">turned on AI training over Nigerian journalism</a>, and <a href="#">judicial officers</a> called for authentication standards.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>High-risk systems in finance, public administration, surveillance and automated decision-making would face annual impact assessments with fines up to ₦10m or 2 per cent of Nigerian revenue (<a href="#">bill</a>); an external reading finds the bill envisages risk assessment without categorising risk into levels, and a domestic critique warns it concentrates broad powers in agencies that lack proven capacity (<a href="#">bill, control, governance</a>).</p> <p>A presidential directive of July 2026 covers alleged anti-competitive practices, unlawful exploitation of news content and other unfair conduct by major global technology and generative artificial-intelligence firms; it followed a press-organisation petition and no terms of reference or interim finding is published (<a href="#">directive, scope</a>).</p> <p>Fifty-four judicial officers called for stricter authentication standards for AI-generated evidence and a review of the digital-evidence, cybercrime and privacy statutes; a communique carries no legal force and no legislative response is on record (<a href="#">communique</a>). A university-system artificial-intelligence framework has been written and three tertiary regulators committed to harmonise (<a href="#">tertiary</a>).</p> | Advanced  |
| Rwanda  | <p>No <a href="#">review framework for commercial artificial-intelligence partnerships</a> is held, and a three-year vendor memorandum was signed in February 2026 without one.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>External commentary asks who is accountable when a frontier vendor becomes infrastructure for government health and education work, and records that the memorandum was signed with no review framework in place; the criticism is attributed, not adopted (<a href="#">commentary, memorandum</a>).</p> <p>The country holds an artificial-intelligence policy and is standing up an agency, so the gap is specifically in the instrument that would govern a commercial partnership rather than in artificial-intelligence policy generally.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | No change |
| Senegal | <p>A four-country comparative study found <a href="#">no artificial-intelligence-specific legislation in force or in draft</a>, and the strategy stack and a planned ethics committee carry the field instead.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The study searched in August 2026 and found no artificial-intelligence-specific instrument on record; it rates a neighbour's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance (<a href="#">study</a>).</p> <p>What the country holds instead is a 2023 strategy, an instruction for a development plan, a planned ethics committee and a non-binding regional guideline set — four policy artefacts and no binding rule.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | No change |
| Somalia | <p>No artificial-intelligence instrument is in force or in draft. A <a href="#">readiness assessment</a> was still recruiting its lead expert in October 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Recruitment opened in October 2025 for a national expert to lead a readiness assessment and produce a policy-oriented report to inform a national governance framework, working under a government-side steering committee (<a href="#">call</a>). Somalia was listed at inception stage.</p> <p>The national artificial intelligence centre names advising on ethical policy formulation among its objectives (<a href="#">centre</a>), which places the drafting capacity somewhere but produces no instrument.</p> <p>The Data Protection Act is the only statute reaching automated processing at all, and it is not AI-specific (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | No change |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | PROGRESS  |
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| South Africa | <p><a href="#">No rules govern state automated decision-making</a>. What moved instead was <a href="#">litigation over an algorithmic grant eligibility screen</a> and a copyright Bill silent on AI.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The position is unchanged and stated as such: the base holds <a href="#">no instrument governing automated decision-making by the state</a>.</p> <p>What the window produced is a court case rather than a rule. The state is <a href="#">appealing a January 2025 judgment that struck down regulations governing the Social Relief of Distress grant</a>, a scheme administered online only and screened by an algorithmic verification system that excluded applicants it read as earning above R624.00; the court found the automation unfairly excluded otherwise eligible applicants, an AI governance organisation was admitted as a friend of the court, and the appeal was set down for 25 August 2026.</p> <p>The one Bill in the window that touches machine learning does so silently. The <a href="#">Copyright Amendment Bill</a> would <a href="#">replace fair dealing with a broader fair use exception</a> and returned to Parliament in June 2026 after the Constitutional Court upheld most of it; it says nothing explicit about generative AI or text and data mining, which imports another country's judicial answer to those questions along with the doctrine.</p> | No change |
| Sudan        | <p>No artificial-intelligence statute is in force. The <a href="#">cybercrime amendment of 2020</a> is the instrument reached for, and it is not AI-specific.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Cyber Crime Prevention (Amendment) Act, 2020 was signed on 22 April 2020 and gazetted on 13 July, sharply increasing penalties across articles 5 to 39 of the 2018 Cyber Crime Law (<a href="#">gazette</a>).</p> <p>It carries no deepfake or generative-AI provision, and no dedicated instrument was found. A draft data and artificial intelligence law was reported in redrafting in August 2026.</p> <p>When a manipulated image of the prime minister circulated in June 2026, the information ministry reserved the right to act without naming a provision (<a href="#">statement</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | No change |
| Zambia       | <p>No binding instrument; a <a href="#">readiness assessment methodology</a> was <a href="#">piloted ahead of the national strategy's review before its end-2026 expiry</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-06-22 to 23 – a <a href="#">Lusaka consultation</a> <a href="#">piloted an international readiness assessment methodology</a>, ahead of the National AI Strategy's review before its end-2026 expiry.</p> <p>That is the whole of the movement, and the expiry is the part worth recording: the country's only artificial-intelligence instrument is a strategy that runs out at the end of this year, with no statute, statutory instrument or regulator rule behind it and no successor drafted. A readiness assessment is a diagnostic, not a rule.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | No change |
| Zimbabwe     | <p>A <a href="#">national artificial-intelligence act</a> is proposed by the strategy with no draft on record, and an <a href="#">ethics framework</a> is committed for tabling by the first quarter of 2027.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The act is a strategy proposal with no draft on record (<a href="#">act</a>, <a href="#">privacy</a>).</p> <p>The minister's own caveat on the ethics framework was that policy without implementation is mere poetry (<a href="#">framework</a>).</p> <p>A regulatory sandbox is named in the strategy and a supervising council was announced in August 2026 (<a href="#">sandbox</a>), and technical standards are likewise a strategy proposal (<a href="#">standards</a>). Four artificial-intelligence instruments, all proposed by one strategy that has no legal force.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Advanced  |

## E-commerce legislation

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS                  |
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| Algeria    | <p><a href="#">Law 18-05</a> is in force while most online selling runs through social-media pages outside its obligations, cash on delivery dominant.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law is in force, and the great majority of online selling runs through social-media pages outside its obligations, with cash on delivery dominant.</p> <p>The assessment is named-analyst opinion from a consumer organisation rather than a state position; the law's own date and text are not held, and no enforcement action or compliance figure is on file. A statute whose scope most of the activity it governs sits outside, with no published enforcement, is the position - and the payment side matches it, with fewer than a tenth of merchants operating a card terminal.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | No change                 |
| Botswana   | <p>The <a href="#">Electronic Communications and Transactions Act 2014</a> is the principal e-commerce statute; the movement this year was in taxing digital supply.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2014-05-14 — the <a href="#">Act gives legal recognition to electronic communications and transactions</a> and is unamended on the record.</p> <p>2026-05-29 — <a href="#">regulations set the registration and compliance machinery for foreign suppliers of remote services</a>.</p> <p>2026-07-01 — the <a href="#">Value Added Tax Act 2026</a> was gazetted, taxing remote services and electronic marketplaces supplied into Botswana.</p> <p>The capture of the 2014 Act is a truncated scan and does not carry its commencement date.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Advanced, on the tax side |
| Burundi    | <p>There is no free-standing e-commerce statute; coverage sits in the <a href="#">2024 communications code</a>, under which the regulator made a conformity declaration compulsory in June 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>There is no Burundian law on electronic commerce, electronic transactions or electronic signature; coverage is carried inside the <a href="#">2024 code des communications électroniques et postales</a>, whose article 1 applies to all transactions by electronic means, and the regulator treats that code as the legal basis for electronic commerce.</p> <p>2026-05-29 — the regulator published guidelines for the national electronic-commerce sector setting technical, operational and organisational standards for interoperability, transparency, transaction security and online consumer protection.</p> <p>2026-06-26 — it then made a prior conformity declaration compulsory for platforms and merchant sites operating in Burundi, which is the operative regulatory step. The guidelines themselves are an image-only scan, so what they require cannot be read from the base.</p> | Advanced                  |
| Cape Verde | <p>Legal frameworks for digital services, e-commerce and digital banking are <a href="#">named among the 5G strategy's declared reach</a>; no bill is held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The frameworks were <a href="#">declared as a component of the 5G strategy presented in September 2025</a> and are <a href="#">named among the declared reach of the strategy approved on 20 February 2026</a>, alongside a regulatory and business framework to support investment. No bill, draft or diploma is held: it is a stated legislative programme covering three fields, not a named instrument.</p> <p>Against that, a <a href="#">dedicated startup law with tax benefits</a>, a <a href="#">special technology economic zone</a>, <a href="#">modern data-protection and digital-transactions laws</a>, <a href="#">simplified business registration</a> and a <a href="#">digital-nomad visa</a> are all <a href="#">stated to be in place</a>, with no instrument number, adoption date, text or take-up figure for the startup law or the visa. That position rests entirely on a minister's summary in trade press.</p> | Advanced                  |

| COUNTRY                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | PROGRESS                                                             |
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| Central African Republic | <p><a href="#">Loi 22.002 of January 2022</a> is the operative electronic transactions law and the only instrument on the subject the base holds.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law adopted on 11 January 2022 governs electronic transactions and is the single instrument on the subject the base carries; <a href="#">the regulator's own law index carries the citation</a>.</p> <p>The law's own held record has no resolvable address - the regulator's hosted file did not answer from two clients - so what a reader can follow is the index entry rather than the text. No implementing decree, no dispute under it and no electronic-commerce measure is held, and nothing in the window touched it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | No change, a first stated position with no earlier account behind it |
| Comoros                  | <p>The <a href="#">e-commerce law is still to be drafted</a>, and no <a href="#">electronic-signature instrument</a> exists.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The e-commerce law was <a href="#">recorded as still to be drafted in March 2021 and is unchanged</a>, as is a <a href="#">revised public procurement code for procurement conducted electronically, drafted and not enacted, with no procurement platform on record</a>.</p> <p>An electronic-signature instrument was <a href="#">named as a legal vacuum by the state's own 2018 strategy</a> and none is on file at 2026-08-04 - the last of six gaps the state itself named in 2018 that the base cannot show closed. Without a signature instrument, none of the paperless procedures being procured elsewhere in this report has a legal basis for the act it would replace.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | No change                                                            |
| Congo                    | <p>Certified electronic invoicing became <a href="#">compulsory for every economic agent from 1 July 2026</a>, with four implementing orders gazetted.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A voluntary pilot group ran at the window's opening. A decree <a href="#">signed 31 March 2026 and gazetted 9 July made invoicing mandatory from 1 July for every economic agent except the state, local authorities on public-service missions and diplomatic bodies, with terminals, software and enterprise modules homologated jointly by the tax directorate and the security agency, after a sensitisation campaign in June</a>.</p> <p>Four orders gazetted 16 July set a <a href="#">four-stage homologation with a 30-day decision deadline, mandatory cryptographic certification, a penetration test under twelve months old, a sworn no-backdoor attestation, ten-year invoice retention and real-time tax-directorate data access, at FCFA 5,000,000 per terminal model and per software version</a>. No phase-in by firm size and no assisted or offline route is stated.</p> | Advanced                                                             |
| Cote d'Ivoire            | <p><a href="#">Loi n 2013-546 on electronic transactions</a> remains in force with article 50 repealed, and its implementing decrees still stand.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law stands <a href="#">in force with article 50 repealed by ordinance and ratified in 2025</a>, and its <a href="#">2014 and 2016 implementing decrees on cryptology, electronic signature and digital archiving are the stated legal basis of the national public key infrastructure</a>.</p> <p>Nothing in the window amended it. It is the only Ivorian digital statute the base can name implementing decrees for, which is why it carries the weight it does here: electronic signature across the administration, certificate issuance and digital archiving all rest on a 2013 text and its two decrees.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | No change                                                            |
| Djibouti                 | <p>The <a href="#">Digital Code, eight volumes and about 800 articles adopted on 30 June 2025, is in force with no implementing decree held</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The code was <a href="#">adopted by the National Assembly on 30 June 2025</a>, three weeks before the window opened, and is <a href="#">in force across eight volumes and about 800 articles, explained at length in the state daily</a>.</p> <p>No implementing decree is held for any of its volumes. It is the instrument on which the data-protection regime, the prior-authorisation regime and the supervisory commission all rest, and none of the three is evidenced in operation - so a code of eight hundred articles has produced no secondary instrument the base can show in the thirteen months since.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | No change                                                            |

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS  |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Egypt</b>    | <p>A 54-article party draft on the digital space would oblige platforms to appoint a legal representative and register influencers; it is not tabled.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Nothing of the kind was on record at the window's opening. The draft was described by its sponsor on 10 August 2026 as fifty-four articles across seven chapters, requiring digital platforms to appoint a legal representative in the country and register influencers on a national platform, and regulating artificial intelligence, deepfakes, online extortion, gambling and child protection online.</p> <p>It is not tabled and no text is published; the article count and the preparation time are the sponsoring member's own account, and it is separate from the cabinet's own social-media legislative review. So the most comprehensive platform instrument on this ledger exists only as a member's description of it.</p>                                                | Advanced  |
| <b>Eritrea</b>  | <p>No electronic transactions framework is in force; the only relevant texts are unofficial consultation drafts (drafts).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A diaspora legal-reform initiative published around eighty consultation-draft acts, codes and regulations intended to reconstruct Eritrea's legal order, including a proposed commercial code and a payment systems and digital finance act addressing electronic transactions (drafts). These are unofficial and carry no legislative status.</p> <p>The standing assessment is that Eritrea lacks a comprehensive legal framework in the digital-trade area, with the only body holding sector-supervision power having little to no decision-making authority (profile).</p> <p>Nothing on the base records a government bill, a consultation or a stated intention to legislate on electronic transactions.</p>                                                                                                  | No change |
| <b>Eswatini</b> | <p>Online Media Publishing Guidelines 2026 are stated by the ministry as complete in development, and restrictions on children reaching harmful content were raised in the Senate with no instrument behind them.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The ministry stated development of the guidelines is complete, and used the same account to state that implementation, enforcement and oversight of data protection are vested in the regulator rather than itself (guidelines).</p> <p>A senator asked during a Senate debate what prevents minors reaching harmful content; the answer was that two offices are working together on online-content regulation. No instrument, timetable, age-verification method or definition of harmful content is stated, and no draft is held (question).</p> <p>Guidelines complete but unpublished, and content regulation that exists only as an answer in debate, are the two forms this unit's regulation of platforms takes.</p> | Advanced  |
| <b>Ethiopia</b> | <p>A draft amendment would add service provider duties, site blocking and take-down notices to the 2004 copyright proclamation, the first platform-liability instrument held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The intellectual property authority reported in August 2026 that the amendment is being drafted after several consultation rounds, and would put duties on internet service providers, set procedures for blocking infringing sites and create a rights-holder take-down notice (the authority's account).</p> <p>Enforcement would stay rights-holder-initiated and by web address, because channel operators cannot be identified, against existing remedies of one-to-ten-year sentences and fines to 25,000 Birr (the same report).</p> <p>A draft proclamation ratifying accession to the Berne Convention is before the Council of Ministers, with no parliamentary date published (the report again).</p>                                                 | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | PROGRESS |
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| <b>Gabon</b>  | <p>An <a href="#">ordinance of 8 April 2026</a> regulating digital platforms is in force, its text unheld and its provisions judged disproportionate by the association reporting it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The sole account of the ordinance is a civil-society advocacy report presented on 25 July 2026, which records it as in force and recommends its revision; no primary text, number or gazette citation is held (<a href="#">advocacy report</a>).</p> <p>A separate civil-society declaration states that a social-media regulation bill exists and awaits promulgation, giving no title, number or adoption date, and it may be the same instrument (<a href="#">declaration</a>).</p> <p>The base therefore holds two accounts of platform regulation and no instrument behind either.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Advanced |
| <b>Gambia</b> | <p>The <a href="#">Communications Bill 2025</a> passed second reading in March 2026 and covers electronic commerce, signatures and cybercrime in one instrument.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>It also covers electronic communications and broadcasting, and was referred to National Assembly committees after the second reading on 2 March 2026 (<a href="#">second reading</a>).</p> <p>The press union is pressing for repeal of the restrictive media laws around it (<a href="#">committee stage</a>).</p> <p>No enactment date is held, and until it passes the country has no electronic transactions or electronic signature statute at all.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Advanced |
| <b>Ghana</b>  | <p>An <a href="#">electronic transactions bill</a> dated October 2025 would mandate age verification, ban targeted advertising to children and impose duties on very large platforms.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The draft is published on the ministry's site and would replace the 2008 Act, requiring risk assessments and semi-annual transparency reports from very large platforms (<a href="#">draft bill</a>).</p> <p>The 2008 Act remains the standing baseline until it is enacted, and no parliamentary date is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Advanced |
| <b>Guinea</b> | <p>An <a href="#">electronic signature decree</a> signed in August 2026 completes a frame that has rested since 2016 on a statute the base can only read in summary.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The 2016 statute frames electronic signature, digital archiving, certification of information systems, consumer information duties in online commerce and the related fraud and forgery offences; the agency publishes it as a 14-page image-only scan with no text layer, so the provisions are its summary rather than the statute's words (<a href="#">the statute</a>).</p> <p>The 2021 implementing decree gives the telecommunications regulator supervision of electronic transactions including mobile money, with security oversight, data collection, administrative police powers and the power to levy charges on payment traffic; providers must hold a domestic or generic domain, a dedicated site and a secured transaction facility, and price in local currency inclusive of taxes and delivery (<a href="#">decree</a>).</p> <p>The August 2026 decree gives an electronic signature the same probative force as a paper writing where it is authentic, unfalsifiable, non-reusable, unalterable and irrevocable, extends it to administrative, private-sector and person-to-person acts, and imposes duties on certification services; no certification authority is yet accredited on the record (<a href="#">signature decree</a>).</p> | Advanced |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | PROGRESS                          |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Kenya      | <p>A <a href="#">copyright bill</a> and an <a href="#">intellectual property bill</a> are both out for comment, alongside an adopted inter-agency piracy enforcement framework.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The copyright bill would create a copyright authority and a disputes tribunal, and carries the 2001 computer-generated-work authorship rule forward unchanged; its comment window's closing date is not on file (<a href="#">copyright bill</a>).</p> <p>The intellectual property bill would merge the industrial property institute, the copyright board and the anti-counterfeit authority into one regulator with a tribunal, replace the 2001 and 2008 statutes, and set rules distinguishing artificial-intelligence-assisted from artificial-intelligence-generated inventions (<a href="#">property bill</a>).</p> <p>An inter-agency digital piracy enforcement framework was adopted on a steering committee's hundred-day report, with the ministry coordinating the copyright board, the regulator, the media council and the tribunal; a national policy on digital piracy is announced as the next step with no draft, drafter or date (<a href="#">framework</a>, <a href="#">losses</a>).</p> | Advanced                          |
| Lesotho    | <p>The <a href="#">Electronic Transactions and Electronic Communications Bill</a> remains pending <a href="#">promulgation</a>; the movement was in adjacent law.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2024-12-30 — <a href="#">the National Digital Policy</a> records the 2022 Bill as still pending promulgation.</p> <p>2026-03-27 — <a href="#">electronic invoicing</a> was made mandatory for VAT transactions, a direct digital-commerce compliance rule made while the general statute waits.</p> <p>2026-05-05 — <a href="#">the Payment System Bill</a> reached second reading.</p> <p>Four years after it was drafted, Lesotho still has no statute recognising electronic transactions generally.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | No change, the Bill still pending |
| Madagascar | <p>The <a href="#">2014 electronic transactions law</a> stands unamended; a separate cybercrime bill was adopted in Council of Ministers in July 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law of December 2014 governs electronic transactions, contracts and payment across 35 articles (<a href="#">law</a>); the base holds it from a mirror of the official legal database and only to its first part.</p> <p>A regional workshop in September 2025 put data governance and electronic commerce to delegates from the southern African bloc (<a href="#">workshop</a>).</p> <p>A draft bill reforming the decade-old cybercrime statute was adopted in Council of Ministers in July 2026 (<a href="#">bill</a>). It is a criminal-law instrument and does not amend the transactions law.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | No change                         |
| Malawi     | <p><a href="#">Consumer-protection regulations</a> were enacted in March 2026 above a <a href="#">2016 e-commerce Part</a> still unamended.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The standing framework is Part V of the <a href="#">Electronic Transactions and Cyber Security Act</a>, in force since 1 June 2017; the capture does not reach that Part, so what it obliges is not readable from the base.</p> <p>2025-12 - the government's statutory fiscal policy statement <a href="#">committed to developing e-trade legislation, regulations, a policy and a strategy</a>, with no draft, sponsor or date attached.</p> <p>2026-04 - the <a href="#">Competition and Fair Trading Regulations 2026</a> were enacted as <a href="#">Government Notice 27 of 2026</a>, assented 5 March, strengthening the consumer-protection framework that governs online trade. The regulation's own text failed to render at capture.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Advanced                          |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS                                                                                                                                     |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mauritania | <p>The transport regulator gave ride-hailing applications <a href="#">fifteen days to bring their authorisations into line</a> in August 2026, warning of suspension.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The communique warned that failure within the deadline could bring legal proceedings including suspension of the activity, with no further notice or warning required, and set the warning against growing use of digital platforms for transport services (<a href="#">communique</a>).</p> <p>No operator is named and no count of non-compliant authorisations is given. It is the base's only record of platform activity being regulated in the country, and it reaches the platforms through transport law rather than through any digital statute.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced                                                                                                                                     |
| Mauritius  | <p>A <a href="#">virtual-asset solicitation rule</a> in the omnibus bill would presume any publicly accessible communication targets Mauritius, and <a href="#">electronic transactions amendments</a> were referred to in July 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Unlicensed solicitation of investors would be prohibited by any medium, defined to reach targeted or algorithmic advertising, platforms, applications, social media, influencers, affiliates, referral codes, seminars and webinars, with any publicly accessible communication presumed to target the country; the presumption shifts the burden onto an offshore promoter to show it was not soliciting locally (<a href="#">rule</a>).</p> <p>Amendments modernising the digital-commerce framework and consumer protection were referred to by the minister at a postal-sector workshop, with no text, timetable or introduction date published (<a href="#">amendments</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Advanced                                                                                                                                     |
| Mozambique | <p>The <a href="#">electronic transactions licensing regime</a> issued its <a href="#">first 19 licences</a> in June 2026, against about 170 companies under evaluation.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Nineteen licences were issued to digital operators in June 2026 of about 170 registered companies under evaluation (<a href="#">licences</a>).</p> <p>The fee is one national minimum wage plus 1 per cent of revenue annually from the next fiscal year (<a href="#">regime, diagnostic</a>). The regime had been in force with no licences issued a year earlier, so the movement here is the door opening rather than the rule changing.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Advanced                                                                                                                                     |
| Namibia    | <p>The <a href="#">Electronic Transactions Act 2019</a> has been in force since March 2021 and covers signatures, consumer protection and contracts but not personal data or cross-border flow.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act is the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime, with the communications statute and the penal code (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>A regulatory profile records that it does not reach cross-border data flow, data localisation or personal data protection (<a href="#">profile</a>). Company process under the corporate laws reform is routed through it, so it is doing more work than it was written for.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | No change                                                                                                                                    |
| Nigeria    | <p>A <a href="#">US\$222m consumer-protection penalty</a> is under appeal, <a href="#">enforcement of new platform rules was paused</a> in July 2026, and a <a href="#">local-presence bill</a> went to public consultation.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The penalty was imposed in 2025 and is under appeal, distinct from the data-protection track (<a href="#">penalty</a>).</p> <p>The minister paused enforcement of new internet-platform rules pending a unified national digital-economy policy framework, convening a joint technical committee of three regulators to resolve overlapping mandates (<a href="#">pause</a>).</p> <p>An amendment requiring large platforms to maintain physical offices went to a Senate committee hearing and then to public consultation; a coalition backed passage on an investment case while a rights organisation calls for withdrawal over a power it reads as letting the commission prohibit a non-compliant platform's activities after thirty days without adequate judicial safeguards, and thresholds, deadlines, sanctions and appeal routes are still undefined (<a href="#">bill, hearing, legislation</a>).</p> | Mixed, a US\$222m platform penalty under appeal and a local-presence bill in consultation while enforcement of new platform rules was paused |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | PROGRESS  |
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| Rwanda       | <p>A <a href="#">competition and consumer protection law</a> enacted in February 2026 carries the first dedicated statutory e-commerce framework in its sixth chapter.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law enacted on 26 February 2026 repeals the 2012 competition law, and its articles 41 to 48 create enterprise and intermediary obligations, licensing requirements and online-consumer rights (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>Until this, e-commerce was governed only by general contract and consumer provisions; the base holds no earlier dedicated instrument.</p> <p>No implementing regulation or licensing register has been published since enactment.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced  |
| Senegal      | <p>A <a href="#">bill on a media and social-network regulator</a> was presented in January 2025 covering digital platforms and online media, and no source has moved it since.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The draft was presented with the broadcasting regulator and its scope covers digital platforms, social networks and traditional and online media (<a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>Nothing in the base has moved it since January 2025. A ministry legal adviser separately states on the record that the state has worked on social-media regulation since 2024, which is the first dating of the workstream the base holds and does not name the bill (<a href="#">workstream</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | No change |
| Sierra Leone | <p>A public-private dialogue was convened to <a href="#">operationalise the Electronic Transactions Act 2019</a>, seven years after enactment, and the Act as enacted and gazetted is not held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The dialogue ran over two days in July 2026 with donor support (<a href="#">dialogue, framework</a>).</p> <p>The Act as enacted and gazetted is not held; every automated route to the text failed as at August 2026, and what the base has is a record of the instrument rather than its provisions (<a href="#">record</a>).</p> <p>An Act that needs a dialogue to operationalise it seven years after passage is the clearest instance in this unit of the gap between enactment and effect.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Advanced  |
| Somalia      | <p>A <a href="#">national e-commerce strategy</a> stands at its November 2022 baseline against an April 2028 target, with the lender recording that no strategy exists.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>It is a results indicator of the regional digital integration project, and the lender records that no strategy exists in this country, in a neighbour, or at the regional body (<a href="#">strategy</a>).</p> <p>Three parties to the same project have none between them. That is a regional gap rather than a national one, and it is the only place this base can say so.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | No change |
| South Africa | <p>The 2002 electronic transactions statute <a href="#">is the standing law, platform competition guidance was gazetted in February 2026, and a market inquiry imposed binding remedies on six platform companies</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Electronic Communications and Transactions Act has been in force since 2002 as the legal basis for electronic contracting and data messages, held as an excerpt, with no amendment or successor bill on file.</p> <p>2025-11-13 — <a href="#">the competition authority's media and digital platforms market inquiry closed with binding remedial actions under section 43D(1) for Google, Meta, Microsoft, OpenAI, TikTok and X, on a finding that 77% of the population take social media as their main online source of news. Google's remedies commit up to ZAR 687,500,000 over their five-year term.</a></p> <p>2026-02-06 — <a href="#">final guidance for leading online intermediation platforms was gazetted, naming price-parity clauses, interoperability restrictions, self-preferencing and misuse of competitively sensitive data as the competition risks the commission will act on.</a> It is guidance rather than regulation and no enforcement action under it is on file.</p> <p>Beyond the inquiry's remedies, the enforcement on file is a municipal one: three online grocery platforms had premises closed in a health and licensing operation, reported under local government.</p> | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY     | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS  |
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| South Sudan | <p>A <a href="#">national e-commerce strategy</a> is recorded as non-existent in the regional project's seventh implementation report.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The lender records it as non-existent (<a href="#">strategy</a>).</p> <p>The same report records the same absence for two other parties to the project, so three parties have none between them.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | No change |
| Sudan       | <p>A ministerial meeting resolved to <a href="#">review state-level border-trade protocols</a> and replace them with a single national legal framework, with revenue protection the stated driver.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The meeting was chaired by the finance minister and resolved to refer the state-to-neighbouring-country protocols to the Council of Ministers, to build one national framework in their place (<a href="#">meeting</a>).</p> <p>It was paired with the adoption of the national platform as the sole channel for foreign-trade transactions, and the stated driver is revenue protection rather than service delivery.</p> <p>No draft, timetable or list of the protocols under review is published.</p>                                                                                                                                    | Advanced  |
| Tanzania    | <p>The <a href="#">Electronic Transactions Act was amended by the Finance Act 2026</a>, and a <a href="#">review of more than 1,000 laws</a> was announced with no list, sequencing, responsible body or timetable.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Section 13 of the Act was amended on 30 June 2026; the land, building and motor-vehicle requirement is a substantive obligation in its own right and is not part of the scheduled transaction classes the separate order lists (<a href="#">amendment</a>).</p> <p>The thousand-law review was announced in August 2026 with nothing stated about scope, sequencing, responsible body, timetable or consultation route (<a href="#">review</a>).</p> <p>Distinguishing the Act amendment from the order made under it matters: secondary accounts treat the mandatory-payment regime as regulations, and it is neither.</p> | Advanced  |
| Togo        | <p><a href="#">Rules on mobile commercial offers</a> entered into force in April 2026, recorded in one line of an operator parent's half-year financial report.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>No instrument number, title or text is held, and the sole account is a single line in a foreign-listed operator's financial filing (<a href="#">rules</a>).</p> <p>A rule that changes what operators may offer consumers, evidenced only in the accounts of the company it binds, is worth recording as exactly that. The consumer-rights tour recorded separately is running in the same period with no reference to it on file.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Advanced  |
| Uganda      | <p>A <a href="#">Protection of Sovereignty Bill</a> caps foreign funding at about UGX 400m a year above which ministerial approval is required, and the regulator <a href="#">opened nationwide enforcement against unlicensed public wireless access</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The bill was assessed technically by the central bank to joint committees in April 2026; enactment is reported but unconfirmed (<a href="#">bill</a>, <a href="#">editors</a>).</p> <p>A cap on foreign funding with ministerial approval above it reaches every civil-society body in this ledger — the digital-rights submissions, the awareness campaigns and the climate-information project are all externally funded.</p> <p>Nationwide enforcement against unlicensed public wireless access opened on a public notice in July 2026 (<a href="#">enforcement</a>).</p>        | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | PROGRESS |
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| <b>Zambia</b>   | <p>A <a href="#">Postal and Courier Services Bill 2026</a> went to public written submissions, replacing a 2009 Act that also underwrites postal banking and financial services.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Submissions closed on 27 July 2026 (<a href="#">bill</a>, <a href="#">submissions</a>).</p> <p>The 2009 Act underwrites postal banking and financial services, so its replacement governs the postal service's agency-banking role — which makes a postal bill a payments instrument.</p> <p>Submissions closed one working day after the consultations ended, and it is the only open public call for written comment on a domestic instrument the base holds for the whole window (<a href="#">consultation</a>).</p> | Advanced |
| <b>Zimbabwe</b> | <p>Cabinet directed drafting of a <a href="#">statutory instrument on e-hailing services</a>, reported to Parliament in August 2026 with no text, consultation or commencement date published.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>It is a drafting instruction (<a href="#">direction</a>).</p> <p>It is the only platform-economy instrument in this ledger, and the revenue motive named in the reporting is what places it here rather than in transport.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Advanced |

## Statistics legislation

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS                                                 |
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| <b>Algeria</b>  | <p>Oversight of the statistics office was <a href="#">transferred by presidential decree</a> in November 2025; the governing statute is still the <a href="#">1994 legislative decree</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The office's own presentation to an international quality workshop <a href="#">names the 1994 legislative decree as the governing statistics law</a>, with its organisation set by a <a href="#">1995 decree whose article 6 makes it responsible for the technical preparation, conduct, processing and analysis of population censuses</a>.</p> <p>2025-11-10 - <a href="#">a presidential decree transferred oversight of the office, and a Council of Ministers sitting the same autumn took its modernisation</a>.</p> <p>The institution is being rearranged around a statute that is thirty-two years old, and no replacement bill is on the record.</p> | Advanced                                                 |
| <b>Botswana</b> | <p>The <a href="#">Statistics Act commenced in December 2010</a> and is unamended; a second development strategy launched in its place.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2010-12-01 — <a href="#">the Act establishes Statistics Botswana and the national statistical system</a>, including the ten-yearly census mandate.</p> <p>2025-11-24 — <a href="#">the second strategy for the development of statistics was launched, after more than a year's preparation</a>.</p> <p>No amendment to the Act is on the record and none is announced.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | No change, with the movement in strategy rather than law |
| <b>Burundi</b>  | <p>Statistics legislation <a href="#">is a chain of three acts rather than a code</a>, the 2021 recast being the most recent link with a machine-readable text.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">Loi n 1/08 du 20 mai 2021 recast the 2007 law organising the national statistical system</a>, and is the substantive recast in a chain running from the 2007 statute through this one to a further modification of 24 July 2023 that the statistics institute cites as the governing law.</p> <p>No gazetted text of the 2023 modification was located, so the operative law can be named and its current wording cannot be read. Nothing moved on the statute in the window.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                              | No change                                                |

| COUNTRY                  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS  |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Central African Republic | <p>The <a href="#">2001 statistics law</a> is still the basis, and a <a href="#">modernised replacement was validated in April 2026</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The founding law of 16 July 2001 <a href="#">established the national statistical system, the statistics institute and the national statistics council</a>, and is still the institute's own cited legal basis.</p> <p>2026-04-23 - a workshop with the presidency, the national assembly, ministries, the central bank and civil society <a href="#">validated a modernised draft law to replace it, carrying new institutional arrangements</a>. No adoption or promulgation is recorded since, so a twenty-five-year-old statute still governs.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Advanced  |
| Comoros                  | <p>The <a href="#">2011 statistics act is in force and unamended</a>, constituting the national statistical system and its three components.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The act, <a href="#">deliberated and adopted on 26 March 2011, constitutes the national statistical system as the Conseil national de la statistique, the statistics institute and the statistical services placed within ministries and public bodies</a>. It gives those bodies scientific independence, subordinates any census or survey to a prior visa from the Council, and sets <a href="#">fines from 500,000 to 4,500,000 Comorian francs for running a survey without one</a>.</p> <p>Nothing amends, replaces or implements it on file, and no implementing decree is held. The capture stops part-way through article 28, so the later articles are outside what the base can be read for.</p>                                                                                                                                                         | No change |
| Cote d'Ivoire            | <p>The statistics law's <a href="#">three implementing decrees were adopted in June 2025</a>, covering the survey visa, pricing, and transfer of administrative files.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-06-18 - the Council of Ministers <a href="#">adopted three decrees implementing the 2020 statute that amended the 2013 law organising the national statistical system: on the award of the statistical visa for surveys and censuses, on the conditions and pricing of statistical products and services, and on communication of administrative files to the system's administrations for statistical exploitation</a>. Their stated purpose is a coherent and transparent governance framework, protection of personal information in inter-agency data transfers, and a pricing grid keeping statistical data accessible.</p> <p>The statute's own text is not held - it could not be fetched - so this communique is the most authoritative dated statement of the framework on the base, and no decree text is held either.</p> | Advanced  |
| Djibouti                 | <p>Two decrees and an order in the period <a href="#">created a specialised statistical corps and approved the institute's 2026 budget</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-02-25 - the institute's <a href="#">2026 forecast budget of 485,686,344 FDJ was approved by order, following board adoption on 18 November 2025 and Council of Ministers review on 23 December</a>.</p> <p>2026-05-12 - a decree <a href="#">created a specialised civil-service corps of statisticians, engineers, senior administrators and technicians, charged with compiling, analysing and projecting socio-demographic, economic and environmental data</a>.</p> <p>2026-06-11 - a government reorganisation decree <a href="#">assigns the finance ministry responsibility for the national strategy on collecting, processing and disseminating official statistics</a>.</p> <p>No founding statistics law is held; these are instruments made under a framework the base does not carry.</p>                                                          | Advanced  |
| DR Congo                 | <p>Draft ordonnances-lois organising statistical activity were adopted, the country's first legislation on the subject (<a href="#">adoption</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Council of Ministers adopted draft ordonnances-lois organising statistical activity on 28 August 2026, presented as the country's first legislation on the subject and as adapting the legal and institutional framework (<a href="#">adoption</a>). The texts are drafts adopted by the executive; the base holds no promulgation and no published text.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | PROGRESS                                                                  |
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| <b>Egypt</b>    | <p>The governing statute is <a href="#">the 1960 statistics and census law</a>; no replacement is on the record.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statistics agency publishes <a href="#">the 1960 statute under its own heading of the laws regulating statistical work</a>; its <a href="#">article 1 vests censuses and statistics in a technical body constituted by presidential decree</a>. It is sixty-six years old and the base holds no amendment or replacement.</p> <p>2026-02-02 - the machinery under it moved: <a href="#">the prime minister chaired the high committee for the 2027 population, housing and establishments census, with the agency and six ministers</a>.</p> <p>A national statistics strategy <a href="#">had been in preparation for nearly two years with 18 ministries and research bodies plus international partners</a> and is not published.</p>                                                                                                                | No change, a first stated position with no earlier account behind it      |
| <b>Eritrea</b>  | <p>The statistics office has never operated under an enacted statistics law; a draft proclamation was recorded as pending (<a href="#">review</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A mid-term review of statistical capacity support records that the statistical proclamation, the equivalent of a statistics act, had been submitted to government and that the formal issue was still pending (<a href="#">review</a>).</p> <p>No later record of enactment was located at the probe date of 31 August 2026, so the national statistics office has operated for at least two decades without a statutory mandate.</p> <p>This matters for the surveys the base does hold: a population and health survey was carried out without a law defining who owns the data, who may access it or on what terms it is published.</p>                                                                                                                                                                               | No change                                                                 |
| <b>Eswatini</b> | <p>The <a href="#">Statistics Act of 1967</a> is the operative statute, fifty-nine years old and unamended on the base, with no replacement Bill held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act constitutes the Central Statistical Office and carries its collection powers; no amendment, replacement Bill or commencement is held (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>Under it, the ministry and the population fund launched the 2027 Population and Housing Census together with the 2025/2026 Economic Census in November 2025 (<a href="#">launch</a>).</p> <p>The 2026 budget speech reports household mapping and listing begun and E130.5 million allocated (<a href="#">budget speech</a>).</p> <p>The gap is the point: the largest statistical operation in a decade runs on a statute written before the internet, and nothing on the base sets a date for replacing it.</p>                                                                                                                          | No change, a statute of 1967 unamended against a census it must now carry |
| <b>Ethiopia</b> | <p>A successor statistics proclamation was approved by the House on 30 June 2026, replacing the 2005 statute (<a href="#">approval</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Council of Ministers referred the draft Ethiopian Statistics Proclamation to the House of People's Representatives on 26 May 2026 (<a href="#">referral</a>), and the House approved it on 30 June 2026, intended to strengthen the statistics service's independence and align the national statistical system with international statistical principles (<a href="#">approval</a>).</p> <p>The statute it replaces is Proclamation 442/2005, which established the Central Statistics Authority as an autonomous federal agency with legal personality and defined the national statistical programme (<a href="#">Proclamation 442/2005</a>).</p> <p>No gazette text or proclamation number for the new law had been located at the probe date of 28 August 2026, so what is held is the approval, not the enacted text.</p> | Advanced                                                                  |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS  |
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| Ghana      | <p>The <a href="#">2019 statute</a> is still the governing statistics law and a stakeholder engagement opened on a replacement bill in July 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The founding statute came into force on 27 September 2019, establishing the statistical service as the central statistics-producing and co-ordinating institution for the national statistical system and repealing the 1985 law; the service's own page carries it as the <a href="#">currently governing framework</a>.</p> <p>2026-07-26 - the service <a href="#">opened a stakeholder engagement with ministries, development partners, civil society and academia on a proposed replacement bill</a>. It is a consultation: no bill is shown as introduced, read or passed, and no draft text is held.</p> <p>The held capture of the Act itself stops at section 19 of a longer statute, so its offences and miscellaneous provisions are not on the base.</p> | Advanced  |
| Kenya      | <p>The <a href="#">Statistics Act of 2006</a> is under replacement by a 2026 bill establishing a statistics authority with stated professional independence.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act of 2006 has governed official statistics for two decades (<a href="#">act</a>).</p> <p>A bill published in April 2026 would replace it, establishing a Kenya Statistics Authority whose guiding principles include professional independence (<a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>Sector statistical obligations continued to be made under other statutes: regulations of November 2025 require statistical returns from petroleum licensees (<a href="#">regulations</a>). The bill is published and not enacted.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Advanced  |
| Lesotho    | <p>A <a href="#">fourth Statistics Bill</a> is expected to be enacted before the end of 2026, replacing a statute from 2001.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2001 — <a href="#">Act 8 of 2001</a> establishes the Bureau of Statistics and the national statistical system.</p> <p>2025-12-12 — a <a href="#">regional peer review</a> recorded a fourth Statistics Bill in drafting and recommended modernising the 2001 Act.</p> <p>2026-06-27 — <a href="#">bureau officials described the Bill's content and expected enactment before the end of 2026</a>.</p> <p>The Bill text is not held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Advanced  |
| Madagascar | <p>The <a href="#">2018 statistics law</a> remains in force; activity in the window was implementation rather than amendment.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law of April 2018 repealed the 1967 statistics obligation and established the national statistical system, its council and the statistics office's statutory role (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>Alignment of public finance statistics to international standards continued under external technical assistance in March 2026 (<a href="#">alignment</a>).</p> <p>A project document for the fourth general population and housing census was presented in May 2026 (<a href="#">document</a>). The law itself is held to its first title only; its 78 articles are not fully captured.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                           | No change |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS                                                                              |
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| Malawi     | <p>An <a href="#">amendment of April 2026</a> opened protected tax data to the statistics commissioner, above the 2013 Act.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The operative law is now held: the <a href="#">National Statistics Act, chapter 27:01</a>, commenced 19 July 2013 and establishes the National Statistical Office and the national statistical system.</p> <p>Nothing amends it.</p> <p>What changed came from outside it. 2026-04 - the <a href="#">Tax Administration (Amendment) Act 2026, Act 6 of 2026</a>, assented 9 April, permits the revenue commissioner general to disclose protected tax data to the Commissioner of National Statistics. The Act's own text failed to render at capture, so what safeguards attach to that disclosure is not knowable from the base.</p> <p>2026-04 - the statistics commissioner <a href="#">described the finalised strategic plan as expanding participation from 17 to 35 ministries and agencies</a>.</p>               | Advanced                                                                              |
| Mauritius  | <p>The <a href="#">Statistics Act 2000</a> is under revision, with the office's independence carried in the 2026-2027 budget annex.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act has been in force since April 2001 and is held in its consolidated, amended form (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>The 2026-2027 budget annex carries the independence of the statistics office (<a href="#">annex</a>), and the Finance Act 2026 amends the statute book around it (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>An observance of standards and codes data module assessed the statistical system in December 2025 (<a href="#">assessment</a>). The independence provision is announced; no amending text is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Advanced                                                                              |
| Mozambique | <p><a href="#">Law 7/96</a> remains the operative statute creating the National Statistical System, unamended, while a personal-data bill bearing on statistical collection <a href="#">went to Parliament in March 2026</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The founding instrument has not moved: <a href="#">Law 7/96 of 5 July</a> creates the National Statistical System and the statistics institute's mandate and is still operative thirty years on.</p> <p>2026-03-03 — the Council of Ministers <a href="#">approved a Personal Data Protection Bill for submission to Parliament</a>, bearing on statistical collection, consent and cross-border transfer. It is an approved proposal, not an enacted law.</p> <p>2025-08-18 — a ministerial diploma <a href="#">placed the production and publication of public-finance statistics inside the finance ministry's own internal regulation</a>, an institutional mandate rather than a change to the statistical law.</p> | No change, the founding statute stands while two adjacent instruments moved around it |
| Namibia    | <p>The <a href="#">Statistics Act of 2011</a> constitutes the agency and the national statistics system, and five standards were issued under it in September 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act provides for the statistics agency, the national statistics system and the spatial data infrastructure (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>Five standards were published under its standards mandate in September 2025: statistical quality indicators, statistical metadata, leave no one behind, data and statistics presentation, and data and statistics dissemination (<a href="#">standards</a>).</p> <p>The agency's own strategic plan runs to 2026/27, alongside a strategy for the development of statistics over the same period.</p> <p>The Act is fifteen years old and has not needed amending on this base — which distinguishes it from the data protection statute the same government has been drafting for six.</p>                                           | Advanced                                                                              |
| Nigeria    | <p>The <a href="#">Statistics Act 2007</a> remains operative pending the Statistics Bill 2025, and nothing in the window moved it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The <a href="#">Act, gazetted 11 June 2007</a>, established the National Statistical System and the statistics bureau. The base holds no dated stage for the Statistics Bill 2025 that would replace it, so the standing position is the 2007 statute.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | No change                                                                             |

| COUNTRY      | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | PROGRESS  |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Rwanda       | <p>The <a href="#">2013 statistical activities law</a> remains the governing statute, and a <a href="#">draft central bank law</a> would add a publication obligation.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute in force since June 2013 founds the national statistical system and assigns the statistics institute its coordinating role; it is still cited as primary on the institute's own legal page (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>A draft law reforming the central bank, whose relevance the Chamber of Deputies approved on 12 February 2026, would make publication of statistical and financial data and studies an express obligation under its article 69 (<a href="#">explanatory note</a>).</p> <p>That is at draft stage. The data governance framework published in November 2025 sits below the statute rather than amending it (<a href="#">framework</a>).</p>                                                                                        | Advanced  |
| Somalia      | <p>The <a href="#">National Statistics Law of 2020</a> remains the governing statute, having replaced a 1970 law; its own text is not held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Law No. 24, assented on 24 February 2020, established the national statistics bureau and repealed the Statistics Law No. 35 of 1970 (<a href="#">bureau</a>).</p> <p>No direct link to the statute's own text was found; the bureau's institutional statement is the fullest account the base can reach, which is a real limit on what can be said about its provisions.</p> <p>Law No. 46 of 2026 adds a vital-statistics mandate alongside it without amending it (<a href="#">law</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | No change |
| South Africa | <p>The Statistics Amendment Act <a href="#">has been proclaimed for implementation</a>, with <a href="#">regulations and twenty memoranda of understanding under development</a> to carry it.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">The Statistics Act of 1999 is the standing statute and the Amendment Act was assented in December 2024.</a></p> <p>2026-03-11 — <a href="#">the Amendment Act had been proclaimed for implementation and implementation was reported as progressing</a>; the proclamation date itself is not stated in the held account.</p> <p>2026-06-23 — <a href="#">regulations and twenty memoranda of understanding are under development under the amended Act</a>. Those memoranda are the mechanism by which the statistics office would obtain other departments' administrative data, which makes them the operative instrument rather than the Act.</p> <p>Nothing states which departments they cover or when they are expected.</p> | Advanced  |
| Sudan        | <p>The <a href="#">Statistics Act 2003</a> remains in force and was assessed in 2021 as not providing for recent advances in statistical production.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A joint assessment of the national statistical system, with fieldwork between March and July 2021, states plainly that the Act is outdated, does not adequately provide for recent advances in statistical production and contains no gender-statistics provisions (<a href="#">assessment</a>).</p> <p>That is the most current authoritative statement of the Act's standing the base holds. No full primary text of the Act itself was locatable, and no amendment or successor bill has been found.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | No change |

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PROGRESS                                                                    |
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| <b>Zambia</b>   | <p>The 2018 Act is operating on its own terms: a release calendar issued under section 27(1) and a Statistician-General appointed under section 11.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Act No. 13 of 2018 establishes the statistics agency and the national statistical system and remains the operative framework.</p> <p>2025-12 — a national statistical release calendar for 2026 was issued expressly under section 27(1) of the Act, operationalising its release-planning mandate.</p> <p>2026-03-24 — a new Statistician-General was appointed, the statutory chief executive under section 11.</p> <p>Both are the statute working rather than changing, which is the more useful thing to record about a law eight years old: the offices it creates are filled and the duties it imposes are being discharged on schedule.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                    | Advanced                                                                    |
| <b>Zimbabwe</b> | <p>The <a href="#">Census and Statistics Act</a> is in force as consolidated in 2020, and the statistics agency said in October 2025 that it is outdated.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act, consolidated on 4 September 2020, constitutes the statistics agency and carries its census, survey and data-collection powers (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>On World Statistics Day 2025 the agency said the Act is outdated and does not adequately support the efficient provision of official statistics, naming uneven connectivity in rural areas as its other operational constraint (<a href="#">statement</a>).</p> <p>The agency adopted a board charter setting the statutory board's roles, authority and ethical standards, and naming the professional independence and credibility of official statistics among what it safeguards (<a href="#">charter</a>).</p> <p>No amendment Bill, formal review or reform timetable is held: the agency's own account of the defect is the whole of the record.</p> | No change, the controlling Act called outdated by the agency it constitutes |

## Access to information legislation

| COUNTRY         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | PROGRESS                                                             |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Algeria</b>  | <p>The <a href="#">media organic law</a> requires public bodies to facilitate journalists' access to information; no general right-to-information statute is held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The <a href="#">organic law of 27 August 2023</a> governing media and information activity includes provisions requiring public bodies to facilitate journalists' access to information.</p> <p>That is a press-access provision inside a media statute, not a general right of access. No right-to-information law, no request procedure, no refusal ground and no appeal route open to a citizen appears anywhere on this ledger, and no request, refusal or appeal under the media law's provisions is recorded either.</p> | No change, a first stated position with no earlier account behind it |
| <b>Botswana</b> | <p>The <a href="#">Access to Information Act</a> was passed, its passage confirmed from the podium in <a href="#">November 2025</a>; no commencement notice is held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2024-07-26 — the Act sets out the commission's functions, its audit power and the identity-card regime, with commencement on notice.</p> <p>2025-11-11 — the President confirmed passage in the State of the Nation Address.</p> <p>2025-10-17 — the <a href="#">Digital Services Act</a> subordinates itself to this Act and ties enterprise data inventories to its disclosure obligations.</p> <p>No commencement notice is on the record.</p>                                                                            | Advanced, passed and not commenced                                   |

| COUNTRY              | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS  |
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| <b>Burkina Faso</b>  | <p>The access to public information law <a href="#">was reported dormant in February 2025</a>, and its number, date and text are not held.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">A press-freedom body reported the access to public information law dormant</a>, and no held source records any movement since. The law's number, date and text are not on the base, so what is recorded is an instrument known only by its inactivity.</p> <p>Nothing else supplies the function. There is no open data portal, no dataset catalogue and no publication licence, reported under open data, and the data-protection authority's own statutory annual report has not been published since 2020. Transparency in this record runs through budget documents and ministry review meetings rather than through any right to ask.</p>                                                  | No change |
| <b>Burundi</b>       | <p>An access to information bill <a href="#">was listed on the National Assembly's order paper for the session opened on 3 August 2026</a>, with no text published.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-08-04 — <a href="#">the bill was listed for examination in the session opened on 3 August 2026</a>. No text, tabling number, sponsoring ministry or timetable has been published, and none existed before this listing.</p> <p>The session runs about three months under the constitution, which is the outer bound for passage in this sitting. Nothing else on this ledger touches access to information: there is no open data portal, no open data policy and no published dataset, so the bill would arrive into an absence rather than onto a practice.</p>                                                                                                             | Advanced  |
| <b>Cameroon</b>      | <p>The e-government and access to information bill is still a preliminary draft; the 2018 transparency code stands.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The bill is <a href="#">a preliminary draft on the right of access to and use of public information and the digital transformation of the administration, circulated in May 2023</a>. Later reporting on its progress is in the base but is not citable, so the position stated here is older than the record.</p> <p>The transparency and good governance code promulgated on 11 July 2018 remains in force, <a href="#">requiring budget-information dissemination and civil-society involvement, and the finance ministry was still running first-contact sensitisation with civil society in April 2026</a> - eight years after promulgation.</p>                                                                              | No change |
| <b>Comoros</b>       | <p><a href="#">No access-to-information law has been adopted</a>, and none is recorded as drafted.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>UNESCO's submission to the forty-sixth session of the universal periodic review states it plainly: <a href="#">no access to information laws have been adopted in the Comoros</a>. That is a dated, sourced absence rather than a gap in the record.</p> <p>The <a href="#">constitution guarantees freedom of information, communication and the press only within conditions established by law</a>, and the instrument that law turned out to be regulates journalism: the 2021 communication code created <a href="#">the press and audiovisual council and made a press card a condition of practising</a>. Neither creates a citizen right to obtain a government record.</p> <p>Nothing on file records a draft, a commitment or a date.</p> | No change |
| <b>Cote d'Ivoire</b> | <p>The <a href="#">2013 access-to-information law's operational refresh was presented in July 2025</a> and nothing has been reported since.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-07-25 - a programme was <a href="#">presented at the Prime Minister's office as the operational refresh of the 2013 access-to-information law: a portal, a conformity audit tool, a helpline, a mobile application and a monitoring barometer</a>.</p> <p>No later source is on file in the year since. No request volumes, audit results or barometer output have been published, so whether any of the five components exists in service is unestablished, and the law's own text is not held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No change |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS                                                                                                                                  |
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| Djibouti | <p><a href="#">No access-to-information law exists</a>; the 1992 law on freedom of communication is the only instrument on the field.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>This is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one. A country panel dated April 2026 records that the media and information regime is still governed solely by the law of 15 September 1992 on freedom of communication, never substantially reformed in more than three decades, with no dedicated access-to-information instrument.</p> <p>The same panel names the communication regulator as the operative body and places the country 167th of 180 on the 2026 press-freedom index.</p> <p>The Digital Code's <a href="#">own title on access to administrative documents</a> is the nearest statutory route, and it is a reuse provision rather than a right of access with a procedure.</p>                                                                                                                  | No change                                                                                                                                 |
| DR Congo | <p>A <a href="#">bill setting access as the norm</a> was declared admissible on 27 March 2026; a classification regime was presented two weeks earlier.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-03-27 - the bill was declared admissible and referred to a joint commission with ten days to report: it sets access as the norm and limitation the exception, applies to public services and some private actors, and requires a simple, fast and free request procedure, proactive publication, reasoned refusals and a right of appeal. Four months past that ten-day deadline, no commission report, plenary date or adoption is held.</p> <p>2026-03-13 - an information note to the Council of Ministers set out <a href="#">four levels of classification with access limited to cleared agents, traceability of transmissions, reinforced archiving and a ban on sending sensitive documents over private messaging</a>, tied by its own account to the security situation in the east.</p> | Mixed, an access-to-information bill was declared admissible while a four-level classification regime was put to the Council of Ministers |
| Egypt    | <p>Two <a href="#">freedom of information bills</a> were submitted to parliament in August 2026; nothing is enacted.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-07-05 - the minister of state for information <a href="#">told the prime minister that coordination was under way with ministries and authorities to issue the freedom of information law quickly</a>.</p> <p>2026-08-09 - a member's bill was <a href="#">submitted to the House with its text carried in the reporting</a>.</p> <p>2026-08-10 - a syndicate-backed bill was submitted after securing 60 lawmakers' signatures; <a href="#">it would create an authority for the protection of freedom of information</a>.</p> <p>Two bills and a ministerial statement of intent, with no statute in force, is the position after a decade of the same commitment.</p>                                                                                                                                                              | Advanced                                                                                                                                  |
| Eritrea  | <p>No freedom of information law has been adopted, a UN review body states plainly (<a href="#">review contribution</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A formal contribution to Eritrea's universal periodic review states that no freedom of information law has been adopted, and that the constitutional guarantee of access to information sits in a 1997 constitution whose operative reality is the 1996 press proclamation (<a href="#">review contribution</a>).</p> <p>The 2026 world press freedom index places Eritrea last of 180 countries and territories for the third consecutive year (<a href="#">index</a>).</p> <p>The absence is legislative and practical at once: there is no statute, no request procedure and no appeal route, so nothing measures how much information is released.</p>                                                                                                                                                                            | No change                                                                                                                                 |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS                                                      |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Eswatini | <p>No access to information law exists. The ICT ministry's own <a href="#">report to Parliament</a> lists developing a Bill as a departmental action-plan item.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The ministry's annual performance report for 2024/25 lists 'Develop Access to Information Bill' among its departmental action-plan items; the Bill is not tabled and no text or timetable is held (<a href="#">report</a>).</p> <p>A regional media-freedom body met the ministry's principal secretary on 25 February 2026 and said it was on standby to support enactment; the ministry reaffirmed cooperation on media self-regulation and made no enactment commitment (<a href="#">communiqué</a>).</p> <p>Where the ministry has legislated on information it has legislated on publishing rather than access: online media publishing guidelines are complete on its own account.</p> <p>Without an access right, the data governance policy's sharing between institutions has no counterpart obliging disclosure to a citizen.</p> | No change, a Bill named as an action-plan item and not tabled |
| Ethiopia | <p>The state development bank adopted a policy <a href="#">classifying client credit information and four other categories as permanently non-disclosable</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The policy, reported in August 2026, exempts client credit information, legal case files, strategy papers, security protocols and third-party contracts from declassification where disclosure could cause substantial harm to the bank, its stakeholders or the national interest, and lets the bank decline requests that would require it to create records it does not hold (<a href="#">disclosure policy</a>).</p> <p>No instrument number, gazette reference or appeal mechanism is stated, and the base holds no general access-to-information statute against which to read it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Regressed                                                     |
| Gambia   | <p>The Act is in force but <a href="#">most public institutions have yet to appoint the information officers it requires</a>, and requests go unanswered.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Twenty-one-day statutory requests are going unanswered, on the press union's account of 7 August 2026 (<a href="#">union account</a>).</p> <p>No government response, compliance count or enforcement action is on record, so a statute that exists is being reported as unimplemented by the constituency that uses it, and by nobody else.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No change                                                     |
| Ghana    | <p>The information commission <a href="#">fined 254 public bodies GHS 20,000 each</a> in August 2026 for failing to file their mandatory annual reports.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The fines were imposed under section 77(1) of the 2019 Act after reminders published in the Gazette, and the sanction count is the commission's own (<a href="#">fines</a>).</p> <p>No collection figure, appeal outcome or compliance rate is published, so whether the fines were paid is not established, and the enforcement action itself is the only measure of the regime the base holds.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced                                                      |
| Guinea   | <p>The <a href="#">online legal gazette</a> is free and carries more than 1,100 journals and 6,000 texts, and its index stops in April 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The gazette has been online and free to access since at least June 2025 (<a href="#">gazette</a>).</p> <p>An acquisition attempt in August 2026 found the index carrying issues only to April 2025, so a publication channel that exists has stopped being current, and no access-to-information statute, request procedure or appeal route is held beside it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | No change                                                     |
| Kenya    | <p>An <a href="#">amendment bill would criminalise sharing classified information</a> through personal messaging or email, on four classification tiers.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>No sponsor, stage or timetable is on file (<a href="#">bill</a>).</p> <p>It is the only access-to-information instrument in the base, and it narrows rather than widens: the record holds no compliance figure, request statistic or enforcement action under the existing regime against which to read it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Regressed                                                     |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS  |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Lesotho    | <p>A 2021 capacity assessment found <a href="#">no access-to-information legislation in force</a>, and nothing since records one being enacted.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The assessment carried out for the Millennium Challenge Corporation and the Lesotho Millennium Development Agency found no access-to-information statute in force in September 2021 (<a href="#">assessment</a>).</p> <p>No bill, draft or commitment to one has appeared in the base in the five years since, so the absence is a searched one at that date and an unexamined one after it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | No change |
| Liberia    | <p>The telecommunications regulator continues to refuse to publish what the gateway monitoring system earns (<a href="#">report</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The telecommunications regulator's board chairman again declined to say what the international gateway monitoring system has earned, and the dispute has acquired a legal edge (<a href="#">report</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | No change |
| Madagascar | <p>The access to information bill was <a href="#">left off the extraordinary session</a> in August 2026, eight months after being presented to Parliament.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A decree of 3 December 2025 presented an 88-article bill on access to public information to Parliament; its blank adoption, review and promulgation fields confirm it is not enacted (<a href="#">decree</a>).</p> <p>The bill went to committee on 8 May 2026 with a plenary vote expected on 18 May (<a href="#">committee</a>).</p> <p>An extraordinary session opened on 25 August 2026 with seven bills, the access bill again absent despite a committee undertaking to reinscribe it (<a href="#">session</a>). No access to information law is in force.</p>                                                                                                                                                  | Regressed |
| Malawi     | <p>The <a href="#">High Court ruled on 6 March 2026 that the Act reaches private companies performing government contracts</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The statute's own text is now held: the <a href="#">Access to Information Act, Act 13 of 2017, assented 10 February 2017, commenced 30 September 2020 and is overseen by the Human Rights Commission</a>.</p> <p>2025-10 - the commission's own implementation report for 2024-2025 <a href="#">records 34 institutions trained and more than 36,000 requests processed, alongside a concept note proposing amendments for stronger enforcement</a>.</p> <p>2026-03 - the <a href="#">High Court held that the Act applies to private companies undertaking government contracts</a>, which extends its reach past the public body it was drafted around. The ruling is reported rather than held as a judgment, and no appeal is on record.</p> | Advanced  |
| Mauritius  | <p>A <a href="#">Freedom of Information Bill</a> was announced as in preparation in February 2026, and no draft, text or timetable has been published since.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The bill was announced by the data-protection commissioner at the launch of the national data strategy (<a href="#">announcement</a>).</p> <p>Six months on, nothing has followed. The country has a data-protection statute aligned to the European regulation and no statutory right of access to public information to sit beside it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Advanced  |
| Morocco    | <p><a href="#">Law 31-13</a> has been in force since 2018 and the commission it created publishes no annual reports, though its own article 22 requires them.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law was promulgated by dahir in February 2018 and created the access-to-information commission, with article 30 deferring entry into force by a year and proactive-publication duties by a further year (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>The commission publishes no annual reports despite the duty in article 22, so eight years on the base holds the statute, the institution and no measure of requests made, granted or refused under it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | No change |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PROGRESS                                                                                                                                   |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mozambique | <p><a href="#">Law 34/2014</a> remains the operative access-to-information statute, and the Constitutional Council struck down 18 provisions letting the regulator monitor traffic and suspend services. Full record</p> <p>2026-07-29 — the Constitutional Council <a href="#">declared unconstitutional 18 provisions of Decree 48/2025</a>, which had let the telecommunications regulator monitor traffic, collect user data and suspend services without parliamentary authorisation. It removes the main legal basis for communications restrictions.</p> <p>2026-05-27 — the President promulgated three laws, on social communication, broadcasting and a higher council for social communication, replacing the 1991 press framework and extending to internet-based publications.</p> <p>The statute itself is unmoved: <a href="#">Law 34/2014 on the right to information, implemented under Decree 35/2015, is still operative</a>. No count of requests, refusals or appeals is published, so what the right delivers in practice cannot be stated.</p> | Mixed, the founding statute is untouched while a court struck down surveillance powers and a new media package replaced the 1991 framework |
| Namibia    | <p>The <a href="#">Access to Information Act 8 of 2022</a> is gazetted and not commenced, and no Information Commissioner has been appointed. Full record</p> <p>Section 86 leaves commencement to a date determined by the minister, no commencement notice is held, and the Act runs to ten Parts and eighty-six sections whose compliance deadlines run from commencement (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>Appointment machinery for the Commissioner and Deputy was itself gazetted in December 2024, setting five-year selection committee terms and a five-member quorum, made ahead of the Act's own commencement, so the annual report the Act requires cannot yet exist (<a href="#">regulations</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Advanced, still not commenced                                                                                                              |
| Nigeria    | <p>The <a href="#">Freedom of Information Act 2011</a> is the standing access-to-information statute and nothing in the window touched it. Full record</p> <p>The <a href="#">Act was passed on 24 May 2011 and assented to on 28 May 2011</a> and remains in force. The base holds no compliance report, request-volume figure or refusal statistic under it, so how the right is exercised in practice is unestablished.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | No change                                                                                                                                  |
| Rwanda     | <p>The <a href="#">2013 access law</a> is in force and <a href="#">under revision</a>, on the government's own statement to an international review in March 2026. Full record</p> <p>The founding statute establishes the access right, information-officer duties and monitoring by the ombudsman (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>Rwanda confirmed at a pre-session ahead of its fourth periodic review that revision of the access law, alongside the media law, is ongoing (<a href="#">statement</a>).</p> <p>No draft text, timetable or direction of revision is published, so what the revision would change cannot be stated from the base.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Advanced                                                                                                                                   |
| Seychelles | <p>An <a href="#">access-to-information reform whitepaper</a> recommends a centralised access unit, alignment with the data-protection Act and open-reuse licensing, with drafting targeted for end-2025. Full record</p> <p>The whitepaper was published in November 2025 with drafting by the attorney-general targeted for the end of that year (<a href="#">whitepaper</a>).</p> <p>Nothing has entered the base since, so the drafting target has passed with no draft on record. The same body holds both the access and the protection mandates, which is why the whitepaper proposes aligning the two statutes rather than treating them separately.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Advanced                                                                                                                                   |

| COUNTRY             | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | PROGRESS  |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Somalia</b>      | <p>The constitution has required an access-to-information law <a href="#">since 2012</a>; the bill drafted in March 2024 was <a href="#">still before the lower house</a> in October 2025.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Article 32 of the Provisional Constitution guarantees access to state-held information and directs Parliament to enact an implementing law (<a href="#">constitution</a>). Fourteen years on, none is enacted.</p> <p>A ministry official told a September 2025 event that Cabinet had passed the law and it awaited presentation to the lower house (<a href="#">event</a>).</p> <p>A civil-society submission to an international review a month later recorded the March 2024 bill still before the house, criticising its broad national-security and confidentiality exemptions and its lack of independent oversight (<a href="#">submission</a>).</p>                                                           | Stalled   |
| <b>South Africa</b> | <p>The regulator issued a <a href="#">precedent-setting access-to-information enforcement notice against a private body in June 2026</a>, the first of its kind on the record.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-06 — the Information Regulator <a href="#">issued an enforcement notice against a mining company under the access-to-information Act</a>, which the account records as precedent-setting for private bodies. Before this window the base held no enforcement notice of any kind.</p> <p>It is one notice, not a series. The regulator publishes no enforcement register, and the base holds no figure for requests made, refused or appealed under the Act, so what can be said is that the power was used and not how often it is needed.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                | Advanced  |
| <b>South Sudan</b>  | <p>A <a href="#">technical committee was given fourteen days</a> in January 2026 to launch an Official Gazette and clear a publication backlog of every law since 2011, and no edition is on file.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The committee was formed by the President on 12 January 2026 (<a href="#">committee</a>).</p> <p>A protocol issued the week before classifies all documents bearing the President's signature as privileged executive communication that cannot be photographed, scanned or shared online.</p> <p>Those two facts together are the single most consequential entry in this ledger. A country with no operating gazette and a rule against reproducing signed instruments cannot have its laws read, which is why the ICT Authority's status is unresolvable and why the cybercrime Act's text is withheld.</p>                                                                                                 | Stalled   |
| <b>Sudan</b>        | <p>The <a href="#">Right to Access Information Law of 2015</a> is in force, and the commission it requires was never effectively established.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The law was ratified by the National Assembly on 27 January 2015 and signed on 22 February. It establishes a citizen right to obtain information from public institutions, and a commission with powers to compel publication (<a href="#">law</a>).</p> <p>Available reporting indicates the commission was never made operational, so the law's practical reach is unverified.</p> <p>Nothing later amends or replaces it, and no implementing regulation was located.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | No change |
| <b>Zambia</b>       | <p>The 2023 Act gained <a href="#">its first implementing regulations</a> and then <a href="#">commission guidelines translating its duties into operational guidance</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">Act No. 24 of 2023 came into force on 25 June 2024, granting a citizen or residence-permit holder the right to access information held by an information holder.</a></p> <p>2025-08-29 — <a href="#">Statutory Instrument No. 56 of 2025 supplied the request forms, fees and procedures needed to make the right operative</a> — the step without which an access statute is unusable.</p> <p>2025-12-05 — <a href="#">the rights commission issued guidelines as Government Notice No. 1624 of 2025, translating the Act's duties into operational guidance.</a></p> <p>Two years from enactment to a usable procedure is the shape of it. No count of requests made, granted or refused under the Act is published.</p> | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS                                                                                                                           |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Zimbabwe | <p>The <a href="#">Freedom of Information Act</a> is in force, and two 2026 High Court rulings pull in opposite directions on what the section 62 right reaches.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Act of 2020, commenced on 1 July 2020, implements the section 62 constitutional right of access to information and repealed the Access to Information and Protection of Privacy Act (<a href="#">Act</a>).</p> <p>On 24 December 2025 the High Court held that withholding the report of the commission of inquiry into urban state land sales violates section 62 and ordered its publication within 90 days (<a href="#">judgment</a>).</p> <p>On 17 August 2026 the same court dismissed an application to compel a bank to disclose foreign-currency allocation records, holding that banking secrecy under section 76 of the Banking Act barred disclosure without the central bank's authorisation (<a href="#">ruling</a>).</p> <p>Whether the commission report was published inside the 90 days is not held.</p> | Mixed, a court ordering publication under the constitutional right while another read a statutory secrecy provision as limiting it |

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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